

II. CARAVAN DOCUMENTS (7-53)

As pointed out long ago by Larsen in *OACP*, OA trade could only function with the help of what he called “caravan documents”. He distinguished three types: a) “transport-contracts”, b) “notifying messages”, and c) “caravan accounts”. Type a) records that amounts of silver were entrusted to a transporter to bring them to Assur. Contracts concluded with transporters leading donkeys loaded with merchandise to Kanesh are very rare and Elamma’s archive contained only one of them, text *15, in an un-opened envelope. Type b) are letters written to notify the traders on both ends of what is sent off. Those written from Kanesh essentially report that amounts of silver and gold are “being carried” (the stative of *našā’um*) to Assur and they may state which purchases, if possible, should be made in Assur. Those written in Assur tell that the merchandise bought in Assur is “being led” (present tense of *radā’um*, which implies transport on donkeys) to Kanesh. Type c) “caravan accounts” also comprises letters written in Assur or in Kanesh. The former report that the silver and gold sent from Kanesh have been delivered (the past tense of *wabālum* in the ventive) in Assur and that goods have been bought and a caravan equipped, which is now “being lead” to Kanesh. They provide important information on quantities, prices, the equipment of the caravan, personnel engaged, export tax, expenses incurred, etc. Those written in Kanesh report on the safe arrival of the caravan there, how much taxes were paid in the local palace to clear the goods and which sales had already been effectuated. Some were sold for cash (*ana itaṭlim tadānum*), many via credit sales, when merchandise was given in commission to (*qiāpum*) or “laid upon” (*nadā’um ina šēr*) traveling agents, and that some were still in store. Records that list the expenses incurred during the trip from Assur to Anatolia, which probably served to settle accounts with the harnessers who had received “loose tin” for meeting them, also belong to the caravan documents. But it is difficult to connect them with a caravan journey documented in the above mentioned texts, because they do not mention names. They have been treated separately in Ch. VII, where the geographical data they provide are summarily analyzed.

Elamma’s archive contains a number of these informative texts, which show that he was a trader of the “classical” type, like Pūšu-kēn and Imdīlum, for whom imports of textiles and tin from Assur were the basis of his business. These texts show the size of his trade, but only in general terms, since all these documents are undated and we do not know how many years they cover. The texts are also important in revealing who were Elamma’s main business associates: his “representatives” in Assur, who received the money arriving and carried out purchases for him, the men who transported the goods, who were the traders with whom E. cooperated in shipping silver and gold to Assur, and who were his friends and relatives in Assur.

There are interrelations between these various categories of records, because a shipment of silver sent to Assur and registered in a transport contract, may also be the subject of a “notifying letter”, reporting on its arrival and use. There are a few examples of this in the letters presented below, but in what follows these texts are presented in groups according to the classification proposed by Larsen; correlations are pointed out in the notes and comments accompanying the texts. We also have a number of letters written by and especially to Elamma (*19 and *20 written by Elamma, *21-*26 addressed to him by various persons), which provide information on the arrival and use

of shipments of silver and merchandise, whose content makes them somewhat similar to notifying messages, but they apparently deal with transactions inside Anatolia. I have added them as a separate category, B.1. "Letters sent inside Anatolia", at the end of the section devoted to "notifying messages". To category B.2. "Letters sent from Assur" I have added the short letters *31-*32, addressed to Elamma by a certain Iddin-Aššur, to whom merchandise was entrusted. They provide information common to "notifying letters" sent from Assur, but were probably sent when the transporter was already en route. A second addition is the memo *33, also dealing with a shipment of merchandise belonging to his brother, probably drawn up by Elamma in Kanesh rather than in Assur.

A. Transport contracts (7-15)

1. Shipment of silver and gold to Assur

The term "transport contract" is problematic, since the texts are not contracts made with the transporter to whom the silver and gold were entrusted, who would normally have sealed the contract, which should have stated his obligation to deliver the goods in Assur (*šēbulum*). One may compare Old Babylonian contracts about such "consignments", *šē/ūbultum*, to which even the Code of Hammurabi and a later royal decree¹ pays attention. Most texts state that a named transporter "has brought the silver (etc.) away", for which the past tense *ūbil* is used, which does not include the notion of "to deliver" at its destination, for which the ventive *ublam*, "he brought here", is used in letters from Assur that report on the safe arrival of the silver. One may compare *39:37, a "caravan account" sent from Assur, which does not write that the transporter "is leading it to you" (*iradde'akkum*), but uses the past tense, *irde'akkum*, apparently because he has already departed. Some contracts specify the goal of the shipment, "to the City" or "to my investors/representatives", some also its purpose, e.g. to buy tin and/or textiles (*9:5-9; 14: 8; cf. "to (buy and) stock barley", 13:5-7). A few also mention that for that purpose the silver etc. was entrusted (*paqādum*) to the transporter, which is the only verb used in *11. The end of the texts mention the witnesses in whose presence this had happened, but we have not a single "transport contract" from Kanesh preserved in a sealed envelope, only several memorandums with the texts of two or more such 'contracts' (e.g. *10). Most texts also mention that the excise (*nishatum*), to be levied in Assur, had been added to the silver shipped and that the transporter had been paid his fee (*šaddu'assu šabbû*).²

7. Kt 91/k 294 (1-151-91)

A memorandum listing two consignments of silver entrusted to Šu-Kūbum, one a single large sum (no doubt for making purchases) and the other consisting of various of small amounts. This must have happened at different moments, because the witnesses are different, but they could have made one single transport. That his wife Lamassutum, his

¹ See Veenhof, *JEOL* 35-36 (2001) 71-73.

² The possessive suffix added to the noun refers to the transporter who received the fee, cf. *39:5-6. The noun is also used for a tax paid to *kārum*, which I discussed in AKT 5, p. 85-87; see also *145:9-11.

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daughter Ummī-lšhara and his associate or investor Hinnāya are among the recipients, suggests that Elamma is the writer.

	30 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.°B. _z <i>ni-is-ha-sú</i> [DIRI] <i>ša-du-a-sú</i> š[a-bu] <i>ku-nu-ki-a : a-na *u[m-mi-a]-/n[i-a]</i>	30 minas of silver, its excise [added], its transport fee paid, under my seals, Šu-Kūbum
5	<i>ša ki-ma i-a-tí</i> <i>ù Hi-na-a</i> <i>Šu-Ku-bu-um ú-bi₄-il₅</i> IGI <i>A-mur</i> ^d UTU DUMU <i>Mi-šar-ra-bí</i>	brought to my investors(?) my representatives and to Hinnāya. (Entrusted to him) in the presence of Amur-Šamaš, son of Mīšar-rabi,
10	IGI <i>A-mur</i> ^d UTU	of Amur-Šamaš,
l.e.	DUMU <i>Ha-ri-im-tim</i>	son of Harimtum.
rev.	2 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>i-a-am</i> 1 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>ša Hi-na-a</i>	2 minas of silver belonging to me; 1 mina of silver belonging to Hinnāya, (sent)
15	<i>a-pá-ni</i> ILLAT- <i>tim</i> 1 ½ <i>ma-na</i> [KÙ].B. <i>ša Um-mi-š[š]-ha-ra</i> 15 GÍN KÙ.KI š[a Lá]- <i>ma-sí-[im]</i> <i>ú A-šur-iš-tí-°kál</i> Š:Ä.BA	to meet the caravan; 1 ½ mina of silver of Ummī-lšhara; 15 shekels of gold of Lamassutum and Aššuriš-tikal, thereof 35
20	½ <i>ma-na</i> 5 GÍN <i>ša Lá-ma-s[í-tim]</i> 1/3 <i>ma-na</i> 5 GÍN [KÙ.B.] <i>ša ik-ri-[bi-a?]</i> <i>mī-ma a-n[im]</i>	shekels of silver of Lamassutum (and?) 25 shekels of [silver] being [my?] temple funds - all this,
u.e	<i>ni-is-ha-[sú]</i> [DIRI]	its import tax [added],
25	<i>ša-du-a-[sú]</i> <i>ša-bu</i>	its transport fee [paid],
le.e.	<i>ku-nu-ki-a : a-ša ki-ma i-a-tí</i> <i>Šu-Ku-bu-um ú-bi₄-il₅</i> IGI <i>Lá-qé-/ep</i> DUMU <i>I-zi-za-am-i-lí</i> IGI <i>A-šur-na-da</i>	under my seals, Šu-Kūbum brought to my representatives. In the presence of Lā-qēp, son of Izzizam-ilī, of Aššur-nādā.

Notes

4. Reading suggested by the traces; there is no room for the names of Elamma's representatives.

9f. This man also occurs in Kt 91/k 140:53, and Kt n/k 402:13 (during the year REL 78). The name of his mother, "the prostitute", is remarkable, but was apparently not felt as insulting and may have been used because his father was unknown.

11-14. This silver sent off from Kanesh was to meet a caravan on its way from Assur that needed extra money.

16-19. *ša*, "of", is ambiguous. In 16 it indicates that the silver belongs to and is for Ummī-lšhara, who lived in Assur, perhaps as the yield of textiles she had produced. But Lamassutum, Elamma's wife, lived in Kanesh and here *ša* means "belonging to", coming from.

17-19. The amount of gold in Assur would have equaled ca. 2 minas of silver and I assume that "thereof" applies to the next two amounts of silver.

21. The space available does not allow any other restoration.

26f. The same man as witness also in *104, whose envelope carries his seal impression.

8. Kt 91/k 302 (1-159-91)

A record stating that four different transporters, Karwaya (l. 3), Aššur-mūtappil (l. 16), Šallim-Aššur (l. 30) and Aššur-nādā, (l. 34) had carried off amounts of silver. The main recipients are Elamma's investors (lines 3 and 24; they receive 16 minas) and Elamma's representatives, who receive in all ca. 35 minas and the gold, presumably for making purchases and equipping a caravan. Small amounts are for various persons, including Elamma's daughter Ummī-lšhara. This record partly overlaps with *17, which is shorter, does not mention witnesses and where lines 8-11 are erased.

15	<i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>ni-is-ha-sú</i> DIRI <i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu</i> <i>Kār-wa-a : a-na um-mi-a-ni-a</i> <i>ú-bi-il₅</i> IGI <i>A-ni-<ni>-im</i> DUMU [<i>Šu-Hu-l^obur₂</i>	15 minas of silver, its excise added, its transport fee paid, Karwaya brought to my investors, witnessed by Anīnum, son of [<i>Šu-Hubur,</i>
5	IGI <i>A-šur-iš-tí-kál</i> DUMU <i>A-šur-PA+/LU</i> 15' GÍN KÙ.GI <i>ni-is-ha-</i> DIRI <i>ša-du-a-sú °ša-bu₂ a-šé-er</i> <i>En-nam-A-šur A-šur-re-ší ú Da-dí-a</i> 2/3 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>ni-is-ha-sú</i>	by Aššuriš-tikal, son of Aššur-rē'ī. 15 shekels of gold, its excise added, its transport fee paid, to the address of Ennam-Aššur, Aššur-rēšī and Dadiya.
10	DIRI <i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu a-na</i> <i>A-šur-ta-ak-lá-ku</i> DUMU <i>Lu-ra-bi₄*-a-ku</i> 5 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>a-na Um-mi-lš-ha-ra</i> <i>šé-bu-ul-ta-ša'(ŠU)</i> 4 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>ša Lá-ma-sà-tim a-na Um-mi-lš-/ha-ra</i>	added, its transport fee paid, for Aššur-taklāku, son of Lū-rabiāku. 5 shekels of silver for Ummī-lšhara, her consignment; 4 shekels of silver of Lamassatum for Ummī-lšhara;
15	1 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>a-na Bu-šú-a</i> <i>mī-ma a-nim A-šur-mu-ta-/pī-/il₅</i> <i>ú-bi-il₅</i> 4 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>a-qá-/tí-šu</i> rev. 3 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>Sà-sí-a</i> 3 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>Lá-qé-pu-um</i>	1 shekel of silver for Bušua - All this Aššur-mūtappil brought; 4 shekels of silver for his use, 3 shekels of silver Sāsiya, 3 shekels of silver La-qēpum, son of
20	DUMU <i>I-tur₄-DINGIR a-na Um-mi-</i> [<i>Iš-ha-/ra</i> <i>ub-lu *kī^o-tí-am</i> DUMU <i>Ku-na-a</i> <i>ú-bi-il₅-ší-im</i> 1 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>ni-is-ha-sú</i> DIRI <i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu</i> <i>a-na um-mi-a-ni-a</i> 6 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B.	Itūr-ilī, brought to Ummī-lšhara; one the son of Kunnaya brought for her. 1 mina of silver, its excise added, its transport fee paid, for my investors; 6 minas of silver
25	<i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu a-na</i> <i>A-šur-i-mi-tí</i> DUMU <i>I-ku-a</i> 17 <i>ma-na</i> 8 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>ša-du-/a-sú</i> <i>ša-bu ša i-a-tí ú Kur-ub-/Ištar</i> <i>a-šé-er A-lá-hi-im ú Da-dí-a</i>	its transport fee added, for Aššur-imittī, son of Ikua; 17 minas 8 shekels of silver, its transport fee paid, belonging to me and Kurub-lštar
30	<i>mī-ma [a-nim] : Šál-ma-A-šur</i> <i>ú-bi-ī[₅ IGI] Šu-Ku-bi-im</i> DUMU <i>A-zu</i> IGI <i>Puzur₄-[SA.T]U</i> 17 ½ <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>ni-is-ha-sú</i> DIRI <i>ša-du-a-sú</i> <i>ša-bu ša i-a-tí ú Kur-ub-lštar</i>	to the address of Ali-ahum and Dadiya - all this Šallim-Aššur brought, in the presence of Šu-Kūbum, son of Azu, of Puzur-šadu'e. 17 ½ minas of silver, its excise added, its transport fee paid, belonging me and Kurub-lštar, Aššur-

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le.e. *a-šé-er A-lá-hi-im ú Da-dí-a A-šur-l-na-da* nādā brought to Ali-ahum and Dadiya.

36 *ú-bi-il₅ 2 GÍN KÙ.B. a-na Um-mì-l-lš-* 2 shekels of silver for Ummī-lšhara,
 IGI *lš-mi-id-DINGIR* [*ha-ra* in the presence of Išmid-ilī, of
 IGI *Šu-ma-bi-a DUMU Puzur₄-A-šur* Šumi-abiya, son of Puzur-Aššur.

Notes

3ff. The text uses *ana* to indicate the persons for whom the shipments of silver and gold are meant, such as Elamma's investors (lines 3, 24), his daughter Ummī-lštar and others, and *aššēr* with those to whom it is addressed and delivered and who would probably have to see to it that the former persons receive it. The latter are Elamma's investors, representatives in Assur, his brother Ali-ahum (l.29), his daughter Ummī-lšhara and several others.

5. The two components parts of SIPAD, PA and UDU, are written on two lines.

6. The figure 14 is emended to 15 on the basis of the parallel in *17:15.

9-11. Also listed in *17:11ff., but with added instructions. In line 11 the sign BE is written under RA, in *17:13 the name is written *Lu-ra-áb-a-ku*, in BIN 6, 251:21, *Lu-GAL-a-ku*; I assume it means *Lū-rabiāku*, "Let me be great!"

12-14. The first amount is a consignment (*šēbultum*) for Ummī-lšhara, presumably a payment for textiles sold for her (cf. AOATT 140ff.), the second is a gift to her from her mother Lamassutum.

21. The reading difficult, the sign seems to start with two Winkelhaken.

26. The identity of Aššur-imittī, who receives 6 minas of silver, is not easily established, since all occurrences of this name in the archive are without mentioning his father Ikua (which can be an abbreviation for Ikūn-pī-Aššur and Ikūn-pī-lštar), but he also occurs with this patronym in CCT 1, 32:11 and KTS 21b:26..

31. The same man in ICK 2, 343:9.

35. Another shipment of silver (16 2/3 minas) by Aššur-nādā for Elamma in *16:5-8.

9. Kt 91/k 316 (1-173-91)

A record stating that 15 minas of silver, meant for the writer's investors, and 4 packets with small amounts of silver for different persons (including two women), were entrusted for transport to Aššur-lamassī. The investors must use the silver to buy tin and textiles (lines 5-9).

<i>1 né-pí-šu-um 10 ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>ni-is-ha-sú DIRI</i> <i>ša-du-a-sú: ša-bu</i> <i>i-a-um a-na um-mì-a-ni-/a</i> 5 AN.NA <i>i-ša-ú-mu-nim</i> <i>5 ma-na KÙ.B. a-ha-ma</i> <i>ni-is-ha-sú DIRI</i> <i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu</i> l.e. <i>ša DAM.GÀR ku-ta-ni i-ša-/ú-mu-nim</i> rev. <i>1 ri-ik-sú-um</i> 11 <i>šf-im 2 ku-ta-ni-šu</i> <i>a-na Ha-ti*-a</i>	1 packet of 10 minas of silver, its excise added, its transport fee paid, belonging to me for my investors; they will buy (with it) tin for me. Separately 5 minas of silver, its excise added its transport fee paid, belonging to <i>tamkārum</i>. They will buy <i>kutānu</i>-textiles. for me. One bundle (of silver), the price paid for 2 <i>kutānu</i> of his, for Hatiya; one bundle
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	1 <i>ri-ik-súm</i> 1/2 <i>ma-na</i> 5 / GÍN	(containing) 35 shekels (of silver),
	<i>ší-im ku-ta-nim a-na</i>	the price paid for a <i>kutānum</i> , for
15	<i>l-li-a</i> 1 <i>ri-ik-súm</i>	Iliya; 1 bundle containing 1/3 mina
	1/3 <i>ma-na a-na Né-er-/am-tim</i>	for Ner'amtum;
	1 <i>ri-ik-súm</i>	one bundle containing
	1/3 <i>ma-na a-Ší-ma-at-/lštar</i>	1/3 mina for Šīmat-lštar;
	13 GÍN <i>a-na</i>	13 shekels (of silver) for
u.e.	<i>Kur-ub-lštar mi-ma a-nim</i>	Kurub-lštar. All this
21	<i>a-na A-šur-lá-ma-sí</i>	I entrusted to Aššur-lamassī,
le.e	<i>áp-qí-id</i> IGI <i>A-mur-lštar</i>	in the presence of Amur-lštar,
	IGI <i>A-šur-na-da</i>	(and) of Aššur-nādā.

Notes

Note the use of the signs TI₁ and SÚM in lines 12 and 15.

9. *Tamkārum* presumably not “the boss, the tractor”, but an owner who liked to keep his identity secret, perhaps to prevent claims.

12. The same man in *42:12, where one *kutānum* of his is mentioned.

16. This woman, who occurs also in *10:47 as recipient of 1 shekel of silver, writes in her letter *95 to Elamma, that a few textiles of hers and a *šitrum* for Elamma's wife are on its way “together with your merchandise”. The name is rare and *Ner'amtum* is a variant spelling of *Narāmtum* (spelled *Na-ra-am-tum* in ICK 1, 17:3, *Na-ar-am-tum* in *10:47 and Prag I 467:3), also attested in Kt v/k 52:9. The name of the week-eponym usually spelled *Narām-Suen* occurs in kt o/k 154:8 (*ArAn* 8/2, 8) as *Ni-ra-am-ZU*.

Comment

Note that two-thirds of this large shipment of silver has to be used for buying tin and one third for textiles.

10. Kt 91/k 353 (1-210-91)

This large memorandum (8.2 x 5.5 cm) lists, with verbal forms in the first person singular, that in all almost 80 minas of silver were entrusted to various transporters for shipment to Assur. It must be a compilation of a number of separate transport contracts, for lines 8-12 are identical to the contract *11. Although transport contracts are not dated, it seems likely that these shipments took place during a restricted period, perhaps of one year. The shipments of twice 30 and once 15 minas were entrusted to Ennam-Aššur, Adad-pilah and Aššur-rē'ī respectively, and the latter also took along a series of smaller packets for various persons (l. 50). That among the women mentioned as recipients of silver in the final part (lines 38ff.), Elamma's daughter Ummī-lšhara figures and that some of these amounts sent were supplied by Lamassutum (lines 39, 46) indicates that the person speaking is Elamma. Some payments of silver are also meant for his associates and representatives in Assur, Dadiya, Ennam-Aššur, Aššur-rēšī, who receive the yield of textiles they had sent to Elamma and which had sold for them (lines 29-33). These cases are exceptional in mentioning the origin of the silver (cf. *9:11-15).

30 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>ša-[ru-pá-am]</i>	30 minas of refined silver,
<i>ni-is-ha-sú</i> DIRI <i>ša-[du-a-sū]</i>	its excise added, its transport fee
<i>ša-bu ku-nu-ki-<a> a-na *E[n-um-A-šur]</i>	paid, under <my> seals, I entrusted to
DUMU <i>Ú-ša-ri-a áp-q[í-id]</i>	Ennam-Aššur, son of Ušariya, in the

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- 5 IGI *Puzur*₄-^dISKUR D[UMU x x x x] presence of Puzur-Adad, son of
 IGI *Kur-ub-lštar* 7 GÍN [KÙ.B.] and of Kurub-lštar. 7 shekels of silver
a-na qá-tí-šu a-dí-in : [Ø] I gave him for his expenses.
 15 *ma-na* KÙ.B. *ni-is-h[a-sú DIRI]* 15 minas of silver, its excise added,
ša-du-a-sú ša-bu ku-nu-[ki-a] its transport fee paid, under my seal,
- 10 *a-na* ^dISKUR-*pí-la-ah* DUMU A-^o*ni*₂-[*nim*] I entrusted to Adad-pilah, son of
 Anīnum,
áp-qí-id IGI *Šu-lštar* DUMU *Šu*-[*ki-tim*] before Šu-lštar, son of Šukutum,
 IGI A-*šur-ma-lik* DUMU *Ša-ba-ha-nī[m]* and Aššur-mālik, son of Šabahānum.
 30 *ma-na* KÙ.B. *ša-ru-pá-am* 30 minas of refined silver, its
ni-is-ha-sú DIRI ša-du-a-s[ū] excise added, its transport fee
 15 *ša-bu ku-nu-ki-a a-na A-šur-SI*[PA] paid, under my seal, I entrusted to
 DUMU *l-dí-lštar* *áp-qí-id* Aššur-rēṭī, son of Iddin-lštar, in the
 IGI *Šu-Ku-bi*₄-*im* DUMU *Ú-zu-^oa*₂ presence of Šu-Kūbum, son of Uzua,
 IGI DUMU *Kur-ub-lštar* DUMU and of the son of Kurub-lštar, son of
 [MAR.T[U-*ba-nī*]] [Amurru-bāni;
 3 GÍN KÙ.B. ^o*a*₂-*na qá-tí-šu a-[dī-in]* 3 shekels of tin I gave for his expenses.
 I.e. 1/3 *ma-na* 5 GÍN KÙ.B. [*be-ú-lá-sú*'] 25 shekels of silver [his working
 capital?],
 21 10 GÍN *ša da-[a-tim*'] 10 shekels for the road-tax
 rev. *ša šú-ha-ri-kà* : *a-x** [for your servant
 7 GÍN KÙ.B. *a-na* ^o*Šu-x*₂-*[x (x)] 7 shekels of silver for Šu-.....
a-na Ba-ra-nim : *iš-[ku-un/qú-ul]* he paid/provided it to/for Barānum.
 25 ŠUNIGIN₂ 2/3 *ma-na* 2 GÍN K[Ù.B.] In all 42 shekels of silver, its
*ni-is-ha-sú DIRI a-na *E[n-um-A-šur]* excise added, for En[nam-Aššur].
 10 GÍN KÙ.B. *ni-is-ha-sú DIR*[I] 10 shekels of silver, its excise added,
a-na Pí-la-ah-lštar DUMU ^o*l*₂-[*bi-sú-a*'] for Pilah-lštar, son of I[bi-su'a];
 1/3 *ma-na* 7 GÍN KÙ.B. *ší-[im 2 TÚG.* 27 shekels of silver, the price for 2
 [HI-*tí-šu*] [textiles of his
 30 *a-na Da-dí-a* 1/3 *ma-na* 7[GÍN KÙ.B.] for Dadiya; 27 shekels of silver, the
ší-im 2 TÚG.HI-tí-šu a-na E[n-um-A-šur] price of 2 texties of his for
 En[nam-Aššur];
 5/6 *ma-na* 2 GÍN KÙ.B. *ší-ī[m 4 TÚG.HI* 52 shekels of silver, the price of 4
 textiles
 [-*tí-šu*]
a-na A-šur-re-ší 1 *ri-ī[k-sú-um]* of his for Aššur-rēṣī; one bundle with
 1/3 *ma-na* 5 GÍN KÙ.B. *a-n[a]* 25 shekels of silver for
 35 *A-šur-kà-ší-id* *Šu-S[ú-en]* Aššur-kašid, Šu-Suen
ú A-šur-i-dí ú-[ra-dí / šé-bi-il₅] and Aššur-idī I [added/sent];
 1/3 *ma-na* LÁ 1 GÍN K[Ù.B. *a-na*] 19 shekels of silver for
A-šur-SIPA 1/2 *ma-na* KÙ.B. Aššur-rēṭī; 1/2 mina of silver
ša Lá-ma-sí-tim *^ox x x] of Lamassutum for....., being
 40 *ša ik-ri-bi ša* [x x (x)] temple property of [the god];
 10 GÍN KÙ.B. *šé-bu-[ul-tum]* 10 shekels of silver, consignment
a-na Um-mi-lš-h[a-ra x KÙ.B. ?] for Ummī-lšhara; [x silver?]
 u.e. *a-na l-lí-úš-[ra-nī]* for Ilī-ušranni;
 4 GÍN KÙ.B. *ša* [x x x (x)] 4 shekels of silver of [.....]
 45 *a-na Um-mi-lš-[ha-ra]* for Ummī-lšhara;
 I.e. 1 2/3 GÍN KÙ.B. *ša Lá-ma-sí-tim a-na* 1 2/3 shekel of silver of Lamassutum for

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	[<i>Um-mi-lš-ha-ra</i>	[<i>Ummī-lšhara</i> ;
1 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>a-na Be-lu-lu</i>	1 GÍN KÙ.B.	1 shekel of silver for Bēlulu; 1 shekel of
	[<i>a-na Na-ar-am-/tim</i>	[silver for Nar'amtum;
1 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>a-na Bu-šú-ú</i>	1/2 GÍN	1 shekel of silver for Bušū; ½ shekel of
	[KÙ.B. <i>a-na</i>	[silver for
ME- <i>la-áb-ra-at mi-ma a-nim ku-nu-ki-a</i>		ME-labrat. All this, under my seals,
50 <i>A-šur-SIPA áp-qí-id-ma a-na</i>	[<i>a-na</i>	I entrusted to Aššur-rē'ī and he brought
	[<i>a-lim^{ki} ú-bi-il₅</i>	it to the City.

Notes

3f. Cf. *15:2 and *298:16.

8-12. The tablet of the original debt-note (without its case) is preserved as *11.

19-26. The mount of l. 19 must be a payment to the last mentioned transporter, Aššur-rē'ī; those of lines 20-23, as the addition in l. 25 shows, were given to Ennum-Aššur,

24. A person named Barānum occurs in ATHE 60:20-37 and in TC 1, 81:27.

28. The only name beginning with *l-* attested as father of Pilah-lštar in the archive.

29-33. These are payments for Elamma's three representatives in Assur, who had given a few textiles along with his caravan traveling to Kanesh (see *12:17-20, *38:29-31, and *40:26-27), which he had sold for them there. Note that what they receive in each case is 27 shekels of silver for 2 textiles.

40. Hardly *ša ikribīša*, "her *ikribū*".

41-46. The "delivery" (l. 41, *šēbultum*) is a payment for textiles she had provided, the other two small amounts of silver are presumably gifts to her (the second by her mother).

44. *Ša* in such texts usually introduces the person who supplied the silver.

49. Cf. below *13:17.

11. Kt 91/k 444 (1-297-91)

A transport contract copied in the previous memorandum, *10:8-12.

	15 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B.	15 shekels of silver
	<i>ni-is-ha-sú</i> DIRI	its excise added,
	<i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu</i>	its transport fee paid,
	<i>ku-nu-ki-a a-na</i>	under my seal
5	^d IŠKUR- <i>pì-lá-ah</i>	I entrusted to
l.e	DUMU <i>A-ni-nim</i>	Adad-pilah,
	<i>áp-qí-id</i>	son of Aninum.
	IGI <i>Šu-lštar</i>	In the presence of
	DUMU <i>Šu-ki-tim</i>	Šukutum,
10	IGI <i>A-šur-ma-lik</i>	of Aššur-mālik,
	DUMU <i>Ša-ba-ha-nim</i>	son of Šabahānum.

12. Kt 91/k 481 (1-334-91)

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A transport contract in which Elamma seems to be the speaker and actor (l. 24, *apqid*), but all the silver shipped belongs to La-qēp (lines 16 and 23), also the packets listed in lines 17-22, where “of Elamma” in l. 22 may indicate that he prepared and sealed them to have them shipped by Šū-Bēlum, possibly his son.

	10 ma-na KÙ.B. <i>ša-ru-pu-um</i> <i>ni-is-ha-sú</i> DIRIG <i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu</i> <i>ša tá-m-kà-ri-im</i>	10 mina of refined silver, its excise added, its transport fee paid, belonging to the merchant, for Iliya and the representatives of Laqēp.
5	<i>a-na l-li-a</i> <i>ù ša ki-ma Lá-qé-ep</i> <i>a-ha-ma 1/3 ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>ša ta-ad-mi-iq-tí-šu</i> <i>ša l-li-a</i>	Separately 1/3 mina of silver from Iliya's <i>tadmiqtum</i> .
l.e.	1 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>šé-bu-ul-tù-šu</i>	1 shekel of silver,
11	<i>a-na Ir-ra-ili₅</i> (DAM)	his consignment for Irra-ilī.
rev.	1/3 ma-na KÙ.B. <i>ša 3 TÚG e-pí-šé-e</i> 3 GÍN <i>šé-bu-ul-ta-ša</i>	1/3 mina of silver for 3 <i>ēpišu</i> -textiles, 3 shekels of silver, her consignment for Šī-šarra
15	<i>a-na Šī-ša-ra</i> <i>mī-ma a-nim ša Lá-qé-ep</i> 2/3 ma-na KÙ.B. <i>a-na Da-dí-a</i> 1/3 ma-na <i>a-na En-nam-A-šur</i> 1/3 ma-na <i>a-na A-šur-re-ší</i>	all this of La-qēp. 2/3 mina of silver for Dadiya, 1/3 mina for Ennam-Aššur, 1/3 mina for Aššur-rēšī,
20	3 GÍN <i>a-na A-šur-re-ší</i> ŠUNIGÍN 4 <i>ri-ik-sú</i>	3 shekels for Aššur-rēšī, in all 4 bundles
u.e.	<i>ša E-lá-ma mī-ma</i> <i>a-nim ša Lá-qé-ep</i>	of Elamma all this belonging to La-qēp
le.e.	<i>a-na Šu-Be-lim á-p-qí-id</i>	I entrusted to Šu-Bēlum. In the
25	IGI <i>A-šur-na-da</i> DUMU <i>A-šur-i-dí</i> IGI <i>Šu-Sú-in</i> DUMU <i>Šu-Hu-bu-ur</i>	presence of Aššur-nādā, son of Aššur-idī, of Šu-Suen, son of Šu-Hubur.

Notes

11. The emendation is suggested by *14:6: *Ir-ra-ili₅*

15. *Šī-ša-ra* occurs also in AKT 6-a, 74:4, 163:4 and 164:1, where she figures as writer and recipient of letters in Assur.

17-19. These amounts must be the yield of textiles belonging to them, which they had sent to Kanesh, where they were sold; see the comment on *12:29-33.

13. Kt 91/k 309 (1-166-91)

A memorandum, with very cursive writing, on silver sent to Assur via Ē/Inah-ilī, presumably written by or for Elamma, since it mentions silver for his daughter Ummī-lšhara. We also know that transporter Ēnah-ilī worked for him (see *28), although we cannot exclude that it may date from after his death and was written for/by a son. The record does not list the witnesses, present when silver was entrusted, and therefore is a secondary copy.

15 ma-na KÙ.B.

15 minas of silver

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	<i>ni-is-°ha₂-sú</i> DIRI	the excise on it extra,
	<i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu</i>	his transport fee paid,
	<i>a-na l-na-ah-°DINGIR₂</i>	I gave to Inah-ilī.
5	<i>a-dí-in 2 ma-na KÙ.B.</i>	2 minas of silver
	<i>a-na ú-ťí-tim</i>	for storing
	<i>ša-pá'(BE)-ki-im</i>	barley
	<i>a-dí-šu-um</i>	I gave him.
l.e.	<i>1/2 ma-na KÙ.B.</i>	½ mina of silver (from)
10	<i>ta-ad-mi-iq-ta-ša</i>	her friendly loan,
rev.	<i>2 GÍN KÙ.B. šé-bu-ul-/ta-ša</i>	2 shekels of silver a shipment
	<i>ša Um-mi-lš-ha-ra</i>	for Ummī-lšhara.
	<i>13 1/2 GÍN KÙ.B.</i>	13 ½ shekels of silver,
	<i>ta-ad-mi-iq-tù-šu</i>	his trust,
15	<i>š[a] *[B]e-lá-nim</i>	for Bēlānum.
	<i>°2₂* [GÍN š]é-bu-ul-tum</i>	2 shekels a gift
	<i>ša *Puz<ur₄>?-lá-áb-ra-at</i>	for Puzur ² -llabrat.
	<i>mì-ma KÙ.B. a-nim</i>	All this silver,
l.e.	<i>ni-is-ha-sú</i> DIRIG	the excise on it extra,
le.e.	<i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu</i>	his transport-fee paid
21	<i>l-na-ah-DINGIR ú-bi₄-il₅</i>	Inah-ilī has taken along.

Notes

The sequence of lines 18-21 implies that line 1 is the beginning of the obverse (which starts with the biggest amounts), although the direction of the writing on the left edge suggests that the tablet started with line 11.

5-7. There are many references to silver sent for (buying and) stocking barley, frequently in letters to women.

10, 14. *Tadmiqtum* (also in *14:22, *79:19) is the name for merchandise (usually textiles) entrusted to a relative or partner, who will sell them “as well as he can” (*dammuqum*) and then also for the silver earned by this transaction sent to its owner, see AOATT 111. *Šēbultum*, lit. “what is sent”, “consignment”, may refer to many items, but in particular to the silver resulting from the sale of *tadmiqtum* goods, sent to its owner as its recipient, to whom the added possessive suffix refers (see below E, § 2). When very small amounts of silver as called *šēbultum* the meaning could be “gift”, as attested in Old Babylonian (see AOATT 140-143).

17. There is only one damaged sign before LÁ, presumably to be restored as KA<ŠA> = *Puzur₄*, cf. also 10*:48, ME-*lá-áb-ra-at*.

21. My translation expresses the fact that the verb implies that he has left Kanesh for Assur, not that he has already delivered the goods, which would be *ublam*.

14. Kt 91/k 409 (1-262-91)

Memorandum on two amounts of 10 minas of silver belonging to Elamma, both entrusted by Elamma's brother Ali-ahum to a transporter (l. 8, “to buy tin”) for shipment to Assur. In both cases (lines 7 and 14) the transporter also figures among the recipients, which suggest that he also played a role in handling the silver in Assur. The end records that Elamma “gave” 12 textiles (in commission?) to his brother as a friendly loan.

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	10 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B <i>ša-ru-pá-°am</i> ₂ <i>ni-is-ha-sú</i> DIRI <i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu</i> <i>ša E-lá-ma A-lá-hu-um</i>	10 minas of refined silver, its excise added, its transport fee paid for, belonging to Elamma, Ali-ahum
5	<i>a-na Ku-da-dim ip-qí-id-/ma</i> <i>a-na Ír-ra-ilí₅ ú</i> <i>Ku-da-dim a-ší-a-ma-tim</i> <i>a-na AN.NA ša-a-mi-im</i> <i>ú-(erasure)-bi₄-ilí₅ KÙ.B ša E-°lá-ma</i> ₂	has entrusted to Kudādum and he has brought it to Irra-ilī and Kudādum for making purchases, to buy tin. The silver belongs to Elamma.
10	10 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B l.e. <i>ni-is-ha-sú</i> DIRI rev. <i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu</i> <i>ša E-lá-ma A-lá-hu-um</i> <i>a-na A-lá-bi₄-im ip-qí-id-/ma</i>	10 minas of silver, its excise added, its transport fee paid for, belonging to Elamma, Ali-ahum entrusted to Ali-abum and
15	<i>a-na A-lá-bi(HI)-im Šu-lí</i> <i>ú Èr-ra-ilí₅ ú-bi₄-ilí₅</i> IGI <i>Šu-Ku-bi₄-im DUMU Qá-a-tim</i> IGI <i>A-šur-na-da</i> DUMU <i>A-šur-i-dí</i>	he brought it to Ali-abum ¹ , Šuli and Erra-ilī. In the presence of Šu-Kūbum, son of Qa'atum, of Aššur-nādā, son of Aššur-idī.
20	12 TÚG <i>E-lá-ma</i> <i>a-na A-lá-hi-im</i> <i>a-ta-ad-mi-iq-tim</i> l.e. <i>i-dí-in</i> IGI <i>A-šur-°na</i> ₂ [da] IGI <i>Lá-qé-ep</i>	12 textiles Elamma gave to Ali-ahum as a trust. In the presence of Aššur-nādā, of La-qēp.

Notes

5-8. Kudādum may be identical to the *kaššārum* of [Aššur[?]-m]ālik in *118:9f. (undated), or the son of Aššur-[...], witness in *204:29 (eponymy year REL 107). Irra-ilī occurs only here. Kudādum and Ali-abum (l. 14ff.) are mentioned twice, first because the silver is entrusted to them for transport, next as addressees in Assur, to whom the silver is to be brought. This implies that they have to make purchases with it there, together with Irra-ilī,

15. The name is emended, because I assume that the situation was the same as in lines 5-8.

22. Giving textiles *ana tadmiqtim* usually means that the recipient, as a friendly service (here between brothers) will sell them for the benefit of the owner, as well as he can. The handing over of the textiles probably took place in Kanesh, for sale in Anatolia.

Comment

The text provides further evidence of the cooperation and mutual help of the two brothers, whereby Ali-ahum arranges the transport to Assur of silver belonging to Elamma. The purpose of the transaction described in lines 20-23 is not stated. Ali-ahum may have acted in the absence of his brother, but fact that he operates with Elamma's silver may (the record is not dated) reflect the period not too long after their father's death, when the division of the inheritance was not yet complete and part of the capital managed by Ali-ahum belonged to Elamma, who was entitled to his share in its yield.

2. Shipment of tin and textiles to Kanesh

15. Kt 91/k 392 (1-246-91)

An unopened black case, with impressions of four different cylinder seals. Its presence in Elamma's archive in Kanesh implies that it was sent there, with or ahead of the caravan it describes. It would have allowed Elamma to check the shipment when delivered in Kanesh and one wonders whether the tablet inside contained more information than what is written on the envelope. Such contracts provide data that should also turn up in a "caravan account", which mentioned the arrival of silver in Assur and how it was spent on equipping a caravan, but no such letter was found in the archive.

	seal A	
1	KIŠIB <i>Šu-Ku-bi-im</i> DUMU <i>Qá-a-tim</i>	Seal of Šu-Kūbum, son of Qa'atum,
	KIŠIB <i>En-nam-A-šur</i> DUMU <i>Ú-ša-ri-/a</i>	seal of Ennam-Aššur, son of Ušariya,
	KIŠIB <i>Šu-lštar</i> DUMU <i>Da-da-/nim</i>	seal of Šu-lštar, son of Dadānum,
	seal B	
	KIŠIB <i>A-<lá>-šur-lá-ma-sí</i>	seal of Aššur-lamassī,
l.e.	seal B	
5	<i>ša 1 me-at 5 TÚG ku-ta-nu</i>	concerning 105 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles,
rev.	seal C (upside down)	
	4 GÚ 20 <i>ma-na</i> AN.NA	4 talents 20 minas of tin
	<i>ku-nu-ki 40 ma-na</i> AN.NA <i>qá-/tim</i>	under seals, 40 minas of loose tin,
	13 TÚG <i>šur-tum qá-dum</i>	13 dark textiles, including
	<i>ša li-wi-tim 6 ANŠE</i>	those for wrapping, 6 donkeys,
10	4 TÚG <i>ku-ta-ni ša kà-ša-re</i>	4 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles of the transporters,
	1 TÚG <i>ku-ta-nu ša l-lí-a</i>	1 <i>kutānu</i> -textile of Iliya -
	seal D (upside down)	
u.e.	<i>mì-ma a-nim a-na</i>	(that) we entrusted all this
	seal A	
13	<i>Lá-qé-pí-im ni-ip-qí-/id</i>	to Lā-qēpum.
le.e	seal C	
r.e..	seal D	

Seals

seal A = CS 88 = *113 seal A and Kt o/k 196b2D. It must be the seal of Šu-Kūbum, son of Qa'atum, witness in the first text and in *190:7 and *117:8-9.

seal B = CS 627 = Kt g/k 410 and Kt n/k 1844D. By elimination this must be the seal of Ennam-Aššur, son of Ušariya, but unfortunately, none of the five sealers of this last envelope (communicated to me by Ayse Karaduman) occurs on our envelope.

seal C = CS 1161 = *158B. Inscription written between the figures: *A-šur-lá-ma-sí / DUMU A- lá-hi-im*.

seal D = CS 1162 = ATHE 1 seal a = p. 110, 26 (drawing Teissier no. 391), the seal of Šu-lštar son of Dadānum.

Notes

9-10. For 6 donkeys two transporters were required, who each take along 2 textiles. It is not clear whether Lā-qēpum was one of them. It is possible that this shipment is also mentioned in *24:4-10: 4 talents of tin and a number of *kutānū* (broken).

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Comment

The persons listed in lines 1-3 lived in Assur, cf. *3:16ff., and the "we" who entrusted the merchandise to La-qēpum to be transported by two transporters, probably were Elamma representatives in Assur. Note that La-qēpum did not seal the case as proof of having accepted the load.

B. Notifying messages (16-33)

Notifying messages sent by Elamma from Kanesh to Assur are addressed to his investors (*ummiānū*), his representatives, especially Dadiya, Ennam-Aššur and Aššur-rēšī, and to his business associate Hinnāya and his brother Ali-ahum. We also meet the representatives as writers of notifying messages and caravan accounts sent from Assur to Kanesh. A few other notifying messages that also report on the shipment and arrival of silver, were sent inside Anatolia: *19 by Elamma and Aššur-dān, *20 by Elamma to La-qēp, and *21 by Hinnāya to Elamma and Aššur-šulūlī. A few of them seem to have been sent from somewhere in Anatolia to Elamma in Kanesh

1. Letters sent from Kanesh to Assur**16. Kt 91/k 350 (1-207-91)**

A letter of Elamma to his principals and representatives, among them his elder brother Ali-ahum, in which he announces the arrival of silver with Aššur-nādā and asks to pay back a loan of 30 minas of silver if, as he had asked earlier, it had been contracted. If not, the silver must be used to buy *kutānu*-textiles. *38 is an answer to this letter and shows that Elamma's requests were carried out: the textiles are on their way with the same Aššur-nādā.

a-na um-mi-a-ni-a
A-la₁-hi-im A-šur-re-°šī₂
Da-dí-a : ù En-nam-A-šur*
qí-bi₄-ma um-ma E-la-ma-<ma>
 5 *16 2/3 ma-na KÙ.B. ša-ru-pá-am*
ku-nu-ki-a : ni-is-ha-sú DIRI
ša-du-a-sú ša-bu
A-šur-na-da : na-áš-a-ku-nu-tí
šu-ma : a-na ma-la
 10 *té-er-tí : i-li-kà-ku-nu-tí-ni*
 l.e. *30 ma-na KÙ.B.*
a-na ší-ib-tim
 rev. *ta-al-qé-a-nim*
ù ší-ma-am ta-áš-a-ma-/nim
 15 *KÙ.B. a-šar ta-al-qé-a-ni*
ta-e-ra : šu-ma
la ta-al-qé-a-nim (erasure)
a-na KÙ.B. ša A-šur-na-da
na-áš-a-ku-nu-tí-ni ku-ta-ni(m)

To my principals,
 Ali-ahum, Aššur-rēšī,
 Dadiya and Ennam-Aššur,
 thus Elamma:
 "16 2/3 minas of refined silver,
 under my seals, its excise
 added, its transport fee paid,
 Aššur-nādā is bringing to you (plur.).
 If, following my instruction
 that reached you
 you have indeed borrowed
 30 minas of silver
 at interest and you have made
 purchases (with it) for me.
 then pay back the silver where
 you have borrowed it. If
 you have not borrowed it,
 then buy for me *kutānu*'s for the silver
 which Aššur-nādā

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- 20 *ša-ma-ni-ma* is bringing you and
*ih-da-ma : a-na *ba-ra-im* take care that they reach me
li-°ik₂-šu-du-nim before the winter (?)."

Notes

1. 'My principals' (*ummiānia*) are the persons who had invested in his joint-stock society (*2), who by this letter are informed about Elamma's financial transactions. The address singles out his brother Ali-ahum, who belonged to them, but who may also have acted as Elamma's representative, together with the three other men, known from many letters. Together they wrote the reaction to this letter, *38, where the "investors" are not mentioned.

9-13. The letter in which the instruction to take out this loan was first given is not preserved, but letter *27: 4-6 mentions that the silver was borrowed from a "merchant" and its l. 13 implies that it was used for making purchases. The loan is also mentioned in Elamma's letter *17:23-25, where he mentions "my previous instruction" to contract it. The "merchant" could in fact be Elamma's brother Ali-ahum, if the 30 minas of silver paid back to him with interest according to letter *38:9-12 are this same loan. This shows that a "merchant" extending loans was not necessarily a professional money-lender, but could be an active trader who at some point had silver available. The loan probably was a short-term one, when there was a temporary shortage of silver, perhaps due to the fact that a house had been bought in Assur (see *26:7-10). That our letter mentions the possibility that the loan had not yet been contracted shows that the financial problems were not urgent.

21. *ana barā'im kašādum* occurs also in *82:15, OAA 1 45 (CCT 3,8b):9 and 62 (BIN 5, 52). Larsen doubts a connection with the verb *barā'um*, "to inspect", suggested by K. Hecker, KUG 80 ad 33:22. CAD B is of no help, since it registers these occurrences neither under *barû* B, nor under *barû* C, nor under *kašādum*, 1, a. Larsen suggests an idiom, which could mean something like "very soon"; it may be related to the expression *ana nabrītīm*, which can mean "before the winter" (see Veenhof, *Lex.*, s.v. *barā'um*). This would fit OAA 1, 45:4ff., where Aššur-nādā asks for silver and merchandise to be sent to Kanish without delay, to reach the writer *ina barā'im*, en route. Our letter too may ask for quick action, if (lines 16f.) the earlier request had not been met. The fixed combination with *kašādum* is understandable, because this verb may have the notion of "to meet, to catch up with", as in the circular letter BIN 6, 8, sent "to every single colony, wherever you (the messenger sent) meet/catch up with PN" (*alē PN takaššadāni*).

17. Kt 91/k 352 (1-209-91)

A letter of Elamma to two of his representatives in Assur to notify them of the arrival of two shipments of silver and gold, to be delivered by Karwaya (l. 4) and Aššur-mūtappil (l. 7), and to give instructions on how to use them. This letter overlaps with the transport memorandum *8.

- | | |
|--|--|
| <p><i>a-na En-nam-A-šūr ù Da-dí-a</i>
 <i>qí-bi₄-ma um-ma E-la-ma-ma</i>
 15 <i>ma-na KÙ.B. ni-is-ha-sú</i>
 DIRI : <i>Kà-ar-wa-a na-áš-a-ku-nu-tí</i>
 5 15 GÍN KÙ.GI <i>ni-is-ha-sú</i> DIRI</p> | <p>Say to Ennam-Aššur and Dadiya,
 thus Elamma:
 "15 minas of silver, its excise
 added, Karwaya is bring to you.
 15 shekels of gold, its excise added,</p> |
|--|--|

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- 2/3 *ma-na* KÙ.B. *ni-is-ha-sú* DIRI 2/3 mina of silver, its excise added,
A-šur-mu-ta-bi₄-il₅ na-áš-a-ku-nu-tí Aššur-mutappil is bringing you.
 (erased; still visible: *A-šur-i-mi-tí*)
 (erased)
 10 (erased)
 (erased; at end still visible: *ku-um*)
 2/3 *ma-na* KÙ.B. *a-na A-šur-ta-ak-/lá-ku* Give 2/3 mina of silver to Aššur-
 DUMU *Lu-ra-áb-a-ku dí-na-ma* taklāku, son of Lu-rab'āku, and
ṭup-pá-am ša hu-bu-li-a er-ša-šu ask him for my debt-note.
 15 *šu-ma šu-ut lá-šu-ú E-lá-íl'(MA)* If he is not present, Elalī', son of
 DUMU *Zu-a-a ša-zu-uz-tù-šu* Zu'aya is his representative.
2/3 ma-na KÙ.B. *a-na A-lá-hi-/im* Pay 2/3 mina of silver to Ali-ahum,
 DUMU *E-na-ah-DINGIR šu-uq-lá-šu-ma* son of Ēnah-ilī, and ask him
1 ma-na KÙ.B. *er-ša-šu-ma ša li-/bi₄-šu* for the 1 mina of silver he still owes
 20 *a-na li-bi₄ ša <É> A.BA ša ba-ri-/ni* and add it to that of the paternal estate
*ša A-lá-hi-im ú i-a-tí i-dá-šu** that belongs to Ali-ahum and me jointly
ú té-er-ta-ku-nu li-li-kam and then report to me.
šu-ma a-ma-lá té-er-tí pá-ni-tim If, following my earlier instruction that
ša °áš-pu₂-ra-ku-nu-<tí>-ni 30 *ma-na* I sent to you, you have already
 25 KÙ.B. *ší-ma-am ta-áš-a-ma-nim* purchased 30 minas of silver,
 ŠĀ.BA *ša 1 ma-na ší-ma-am* then use 1 mina of this amount
 u.e. *ša A-ki-dí-é ša-ma-nim* for buying Akkadian textiles.
a-na a-ni-im KÙ.B. AN.NA Buy for the present
 le.e. *ša-ma-nim* silver tin."

Notes

8-11. The four erased lines mentioned another shipment of silver which a transporter "[is bringing to] you" (end line 11), presumably meant for Aššur-imitī (end of l. 8), perhaps the same man who receives 6 minas of silver in *8:26, which a transporter was bringing to "you", Elamma (end l. 11).

11f. This 2/3 mina of silver is also mentioned in the transport contract *8:9-11; it has to be used to pay a debt of Elamma.

15. Since a further unknown namesake of Elamma is very unlikely, I assume an understandable mistake in the last sign; *E-lá-ni*, son of Zu'a, occurs in LB 1245:6.

20. Another indication that not all of the inheritance of Elamma's father had been divided. See also texts *3:24 and *6:7.

23-25. See for this loan the note on *15:9-13. Note that borrowing silver at a merchant's house (see *27:5-6) is called here "purchasing silver". There are more cases where OA texts speak of buying gold or silver, e.g. Kt 94/k 465:8, *šumma kaspam watram ašta'am*. It shows that our distinction between silver as money for buying merchandise and merchandise which is bought and sold is practical, but terminologically too modern. Silver itself can even occasionally be designated as *luqūtum*, "merchandise" (lit. "what one acquires").

26-28. The 1 mina is the silver to be obtained from Ali-ahum (lines 17ff.), "this (silver)" are the 15 minas (plus what the gold yielded) of lines 3-5 of the present letter.

18. Kt 91/k 530 (1-383-91)

A letter of sent to Assur to announce the arrival of 24 minas of silver and to give instruction about what has to be purchased: for ca. 8 minas tin, unless it is too expensive, and for 11 2/3 minas a variety of fine textiles or garments. It also instructs the addressees to see to it that Abu-šalim, Elamma's presumably youngest son, should only travel to Anatolia when it is not hot and in the company of "our brothers".

	<i>a-na A-šur-re-ší Da-dí-a</i>	Say to Aššur-rēšī, Dadiya
	<i>ù En-nam-A-šur qí-bi₄-ma</i>	and Ennam-Aššur,
	<i>um-ma E-la-ma-ma</i>	thus Elamma:
	<i>24 ma-na KÙ.B. ša-ru-pá-am</i>	"Dan-Assur is on his way to you
5	<i>ni-is-ha-sú : DIRI</i>	with 24 minas of refined silver.
	<i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu ku-nu-ki-a</i>	its excise added,
	<i>Dan-A-šur : na-[*]áš¹-a-ku-nu-tí</i>	its transport fee paid.
	<i>šu-ma : AN.NA 15 GÍN.TA</i>	If the rate of the tin is 15:1
	<i>ù e-li-iš : 2 GÚ</i>	or even more, then buy
10	<i>AN.NA ša-ma-nim</i>	2 talents of tin.
	<i>šu-ma la ki-a-am</i>	If not, then
l.e.	<i>ku-ta-ni(m) ša-ma-ni-im</i>	buy <i>kutānu</i> -textiles
	<i>11 2/3* ma-na KÙ.B.</i>	Use 11 2/3 minas of silver
rev.	<i>TÚG lu-bu-šé ra-qá-tim</i>	to buy <i>lubūšu</i> -garments, thin textiles
15	<i>ù šu-lu-up-ki-e : ša¹(AD)-ma-/nim/-ma</i>	and Šulupkian ones and
	<i>iš-tí pá-ni-^oe-ma₂</i>	send them with the next
	<i>šé-bi₄-lá-ni₂ 1/2₂ ma-na</i>	caravan. Half a mina of
	<i>KÙ.B. be-ú-la-at : Be-lúm-ba-ni</i>	silver, the working capital of Bēlum-
	<i>šu-ut-ma : na-ší : šu-ma</i>	bāni, he himself has with him.
20	<i>i-nu-mi : lu-qú-tum a-ri₂-tu₂m</i>	If, when this merchandise leaves,
	<i>ú-ší-a-ni : u₄-mu-ú kà-/šú</i>	the weather is cool, then entrust Abu-
	<i>A-bu-ša-lim : iš-tí ma-^oma-an₂</i>	-šalim to the care of one of our
	<i>i-na a-he-ni : ša ú-ša-lá-ma-/šu-nu</i>	brothers who will bring them ¹ here
	<i>pì-iq-da-šu-^oma₂ : lu-ša-am</i>	safely, then he can leave.
25	<i>šu-ma u₄-mu-ú e-mu-ú</i>	If the weather is hot he must
u.e.	<i>la ú-ší-a-am 5 GÍN KÙ.B.</i>	not leave. I gave 5 shekels of silver
	<i>ša ik-ri-bi₄-a a-na Dan-A-šur</i>	of my <i>ikribū</i> to Dān-Aššur."
	<i>a-dí-in</i>	

Notes

This must be an archive copy of a letter sent to Assur, kept by Elamma for reference. The writer uses the sign LA₁ except in the long line 23, where there was little room. Note the writing of the long -ū in lines 21 and 24 and the distinction between the present tense with ventive, *uššiam* (lines 21 and 26), and the precative *lūšām* < *lūšiam* (l. 24).

8-10. The purchase of tin at the favourable exchange rate mentioned would have cost 8 minas of silver. With 11 2/3 minas spent on buying various fine garments (enough for at least hundred at 7 shekels apiece) there would have remained more than 4 minas for covering the other expenses of the caravan: four or five donkeys with their harness, fodder, export tax, personnel, and tin for expenses, taxes and tolls en route.

12. The writing *ku-ta-nim* for *kutānī* also occurs in Elamma's letter *16:19.

13-15. The sign 2/3 is written over an erasure. See for the textiles the note on *80:19-20.

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15. AD is a mistake for ŠA, for the verb *adānum*, normally used in the stative, means "to be entitled to", "to have a share in" (especially in a joint-stock capital), which is impossible here.

22. Abu-šalim must be a son of Elamma (see AO 11218 = *Appendix* text 2:13-14, 32), possibly his youngest son, who at first still stayed in Assur. Elamma shows concern for his safe journey to Anatolia, under guidance of "one of our brothers" and not in the summer. According to *41:10, *169:22ff. and *170:15 he served as transporter and he may have received a *be'ulātu*-loan, which he used to buy a few textiles, which he could sell with profit in Anatolia.

21, 25. The meaning "weather" for *umū* is not recorded in *AHW* s.v., but note *EA* 7:54, *u₄-mu em-[mu]*.

2. Letters sent inside Anatolia

19. Kt 91/k 357 (1-214-91)

A letter by Elamma and Aššur-dān about the arrival in Kanesh, presumably from somewhere in Anatolia, of a shipment of silver, with information on how it was used. Many smaller amounts were sent to provide silver to transporters on their way from Assur, who served Hinnāya, Kūnīlum, an anonymous *tamkārum*, and Karwaya. Also mentioned are payments in connection with caravan traffic, most for the benefit of Hinnāya.

<i>um-ma E-la-ma ù A-šur-dan-ma</i> <i>a-na A-mur-lštar A-šur-na-da</i> <i>ù Ku-ni-lim qí-bi₄-ma</i> <i>7 ma-na 12 GÍN KÙ.B. I-dí-lštar</i> 5 <i>ub-lam nu-sà-ni-iq-šu-ma 7 GÍN</i> <i>im-ťí 13 GÍN i-ma-sà-im im-ťí</i>	Thus Elamma and Aššur-dān, say to Amur-lštar, Aššur-nādā, and Kūnīlum: "7 minas 12 shekels of silver Iddin-lštar brought here. We checked it and it was 7 shekels less, 13 shekels loss by purifying.
<i>1½ ma-na KÙ.B. a-pá-ni lštar-pi-lá-ah</i> <i>ra-dí ú-nu-tim ša Hi-na-a</i> <i>nu-šé-bi₄-il₅ 1½ ma-na KÙ.B. a-na</i> 10 <i>DUMU A-ha-tim ra-dí ú-nu-tim ša</i> <i>[Ku-ni-lim</i>	We sent 1½ mina silver to meet lštar-pilah, the transporter of Hinnāya; 1½ mina of silver we sent for the son of Ahatum, the transporter of [Kūn-illum.
<i>nu-šé-bi₄-il₅ 1 ma-na a-na Bur*-Sú-in</i> <i>ra-dí ú-nu-tim ša DAM.GÀR-ri-im</i> <i>E-lá-ma ú-šé-bi₄-il₅ 1/2 ma-na</i> <i>a-na A-šur-dan ra-dí ú-nu-tim</i>	Elamma sent 1 mina for Būr-Suen, the transporter of the <i>tamkārum</i>; ½ mina of silver for Aššur-dān, the transporter of Hinnāya
15 <i>ša Hi-na-a E-lá-ma-ma</i> <i>ú-šé-bi₄-il₅ 1/2 ma-na 3 GÍN</i> <i>KÙ.B. a-na I-dí-Sú-in kà-ša-ar</i> <i>Kār-wa-a i-na a-wa-tim</i> <i>i-bu-ni-a-tí-ma ni-dí-šum</i>	Elamma also sent; 33 shekels of silver for Iddin-Suen, the harnessor of Karwaya - we gave it to him because he prevailed over us in the lawsuit, -
20 <i>ša ni-ip-lá-tim ša ILLAT-at</i> i.e. <i>A-šur-iš-ta-kál DUMU Sú-kà-li/a</i> rev. <i>ù 10 GÍN KÙ.B. ša li-bi₄-šu</i> <i>a-ni-pi-il₅-tí-šu-ma e-ta-kál</i> <i>kà-ša-ru-um ša Hi-na-a</i>	from the balance payment of the caravan of Aššuriš-tikal, son of Sukkaliya, and 10 shekels of silver he owes, he has also used for his balance payment. As for Hinnāya's harnessor

- 25 *ša iš-tù a-lim^{ki}*
is-ri-da-ni 3 TÚG-tí-šu
a-na bé-ú-lá-tí-šu
ú-ša-qí-il₅-ni-a-tí-ma
 4 GÍN 22 1/2 ŠE KÙ.B. *ni-pu-ul-šum*
 30 *1/3 ma-na 1/2 GÍN KÙ.B. a-na*
ú-kū-ul-tí ANŠE.HI.A ša Hi-na-/a
ú-kū-ul-tí nu-ša-ki-il₅
 11 GÍN KÙ.B. 1 *ma-na AN.NA*
a-na °qá_j-tí Ì-lí-uš-ra-ni
 35 *ni-dí-in 8 GÍN KÙ.B. a-na*
Bur-Sú-in ni-kà-sí iš-tí-šu
ni-sí-ma a-šu-mì Hi-na-a
ú DAM.GÀR ni-dí-šu-um
 5 GÍN KÙ.B. *a-sí-pá-ra-tim*
 40 *a-na Ištar-pì-lá-ah ra-dí ú-nu-tim*
 u.e. *ša Hi-na-a nu-šé-bi-il₅*
 5/6 *ma-na LÁ 1 GÍN KÙ.B. ša Hi-na-a*
E-lá-ma iš-qúl 11 GÍN
 l.e. *i-ra-mì-ni-šu iš-qúl-ma 1 ma-na KÙ.B.*
 45 *a-na I-dí-Sú-in ra-dí ú-nu-tim ša*
 [*Hi-na-a ik-nu-uk-/ma*
ú-šé-bi₄-il₅ 3 GÍN KÙ.B. a-ha-ma ša iš-
i-li-bi₄ Hi-na-a E-lá-ma i-šu [ra-/tim
 who took care of the transport from
 the City, he (Hinnāya) paid
 us (for) his 3 textiles, his working
 capital, and we balanced him
 him 4½ shekels of silver.
 20 ½ shekels of silver for fodder
 for Hinnāya's donkeys,
 we fed? (them) this fodder.
 11 shekels of silver (and) 1 mina of tin
 we gave to Ilī-uṣranni for his
 expenses. 8 shekels of silver for
 Būr-Suen, we settled accounts with
 him and gave it to him in the name
 of Hinnāya and the tamkārum.
 5 shekels of silver for siparātum
 we sent to Ištar-pilah,
 the transporter of Hinnāya.
 49 shekels of silver of Hinnāya
 Elamma paid; 11 shekels he paid
 with his own means and 1 mina of silver
 he sent under his seal to Iddin-Suen, the
 [transporter of Hinnāya.
 Separately 3 shekels of silver of the tithe
 Hinnāya owes to Elamma.”

Notes

7ff. Many entries concern men designated as *rādi luqūtim*, “the one who leads (donkeys loaded with) merchandise”, which I translate as “transporter”. Amounts of silver were sent to them during their trip, en route (*ana pāni* PN *šēbulum*, also in *42:30f.). The status of these men is not clear and they seem to be distinguished from *kaššārum*, “harnesser”, the normal term for caravan personnel engaged by means of a contract that grants them a working capital (*be’ulātum*). Hinnāya’s “transporters” are Ištār-pilah (lines 7f., 40f.), Iddin-Suen (l. 45; different from his namesake who served as *kaššārum* of Karwaya, l. 17f.?), and Aššur-dān (l. 14f.). Perhaps the persons called *rādi luqūtim* traveled in Anatolia, while a *kaššārum*, as is stated of the anonymous one in l. 24f., had packed and led a caravan from Assur (the one in line 17 appears in a judicial context, not in the framework of transport).

11. See for this transporter also *47:4.26f.

19. The meaning of *i-bu-ni-a-ti* has been misunderstood in the past, but it is now clear that the verb is *bu'ā'um*, construed with a personal accusative object, frequently in combination with *ina awātim*, “by means of words, in a conflict”. It means “to intimidate, to trump, to defeat”. See Veenhof *Lex.*, s.v.

21. The man is also known as *hamuštu*-eponym, in function during REL 103 (Kt c/k 623+:29ff., courtesy of Dercksen), 106 and 109. I give the second part of his name in its usual spelling as *tikal*, the expected form of the imperative of *takālum*, of which *takal* (e.g. in *41:25) is a much rarer by-form (cf. *Grammar* § 16.23). The spellings alternate, even in the name of the *hamuštu*-eponym (cf. *353A:10 with TPAK 1, 89:7; –*takal* also in Kt f/k 13:8).

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20-23. I assume that these lines also deal with Iddin-Suen's claims, but the wording "he consumed it *ana nipiltišuma*", which implies settling accounts, is too laconic to understand and the possessive suffix may express that the *nipiltum* was owed to or by him; the *-ma* after *nipiltišu* means "also, again" after the *niplātum* mentioned in l. 20.

24-28. I assume that Hinnāya supplied the writers of the letter with the textiles meant as the harnessor's working capital and that, since it was more than he was entitled to, they paid Hinnāya some silver back.

32. The absence of a personal suffix favors *ušākil*, "I fed", over *ušaqqil*, "I paid".

39. *sib/pārātum* are small metal objects that served as a kind of concrete money, cf. Garelli 1963, 278 note, and CAD § 154, s.v. *šibārātum*. The transporter would buy them for the silver given him, probably to cover expenses en route. Cf. VS 26, 27:10-14, "I gave 2 1/3 mina of copper and 10 s. *ana qatē* PN".

42. The 49 shekels are the sum of the payment mentioned in lines 29-41 (actually 48 3/4 shekels). 44-46. This transaction is recorded, before witnesses, in *112.

20. Kt 92/k 145 (1-105-92)

In this damaged letter Elamma informs La-qēp that silver and gold is on his way to him. The request to entrust it to an affiliated trader to have it shipped to Assur, shows that Lā-qēp is in a colony where he can deposit textiles or silver for Elamma (lines 31ff. and from where he might travel to Burušhattum, l. 35), presumably in Kanesh. If so, Lā-qēp must have deposited the letter in Elamma's archive; if not it must be an archive copy of Elamma himself. The presence and use in Assur of the amounts of silver and gold mentioned in lines 3-4 is mentioned in *37, a letter of Elamma's representatives in Assur sent to Kanesh, where l. 8 states that the gold was brought by Aššur-ṭāb.

um-ma E-la-ma-ma
a-na La-qé-ep qí-bi-ma
 24 1/3 ma-na 5 GÍN KÙ.B.
 ù 1/2 ma-na 3 GÍN KÙ./GI
 5 *i-na pá-ni né-pí-ší-im*
na-dí: ku-nu-ki-a
Šu-Ku-bu-um DUMU Šu-Sú-in
na-áš-a-kum: KI a-li-ki-im
pá-ni-im-ma a-na
 10 DUMU *um-me-a-nim* (erasure)
pí-qí-id-ma a-na šé-er
um-me-a-ni-a ú a-na
ša ki-ma i-a-tí a-na a-lim^{ki}
lu-ub-lu 15 GÍN KÙ.B.
 15 *a-na l-li-a 2 1/3 ma-na*
a-na En-um-A-šur
1/3 ma-na a-na [D]a-dí-a
 [K]Ù.B.
 l.e. [áš]-qúl
 20 []
 rev. a- x [i-na hu-ur-š]í-a-nim*
*kà-an-k[u Šu-Ku-bu₂-um **

Thus Elamma,
 say to Laqēpum:
 "24 mina 25 shekels of silver,
 with 33 shekels of gold
 placed at the top of the packet,
 under my seals,
 Šu-Kūbum, son of Šu-Suen, is
 bringing to you. Entrust it
 to an affiliated trader so that
 one may bring it with the next
 caravan to my investors and
 representatives
 to the City.
 15 shekels of silver
 for Iliya, 2 1/3 minas
 for Ennam-Aššur,
 1/3 mina for Dadiya
 [.....] of silver
 [for/to] paid
 [.....]
 [that?] are under seal in a *huršiānu*-
 container, [Šu-Kū]bum

- na-áš-a-kum* is bringing you;
a-na še-er Da-dí-a send them to Dadiya
 25 *ú En-nam-A-šur* and Ennam-Aššur.
°šé₂-bi-il₅-šu-nu 5 ma-na 5 minas (of silver) under my seal
ku-nu-ki-a ^dUTU-*ba-ni* DUMU A-^{*o}kl₂- Šamaš-bāni, son of Akutum,
ub-lá-kum : ša Ša-lim-a-/hi-im [*l*tim brought you, satisfy with that
 KÙ.B. *ša-bi-ma* silver the claim of Šalim-ahum
 30 *ší-tí* KÙ.B. *iš-tí-kà* and keep the rest with you.
li-ib-ší šu-ma TÚG.HI.A-tí If there is a possibility
ší-tap-ku-um i-ba-ší to deposit textiles
ú-ul KÙ.B. *ší-tap-kum* or to deposit silver,
i-ba-ší ŠÀ.BA qá-tí deposit my share by taking it from
 35 *i-ta-<dí>-a : šu-ma* (this shipment). Should
ha-ra-kà a-na Bu-ru-uš-/ha-tim your trip to Buruṣhattum,
i-ba-ší take place,
 u.e. *šú-ha-ru-um iš-tí-kà-ma* the let the boy go with you,
li-li-ik do not leave
 le.e.lá *té-zi-ib-šu A-mur-A-šur* DUMU him behind. Seize Amur-Aššur, son of
[l-lí-ba-ni [*l*lī-bāni,
 41 *ša-ba-at-ma* KÙ.B. (4 signs erased) and make him pay the silver.”
ša-áš-qí-il₅-šu

Notes

8-14. *Išti ālikim paqādum* is short for to entrust to somebody who travels with a caravan that will bring (*lublū* with *ālikum* as a logical plural subject) the goods to Assur.

14-17. Amounts of silver meant for Elamma's representatives in Assur, presumably the yield of textiles he had sold for them (cf. *39:26f.).

21-22. The remains of the sign before *a-nim* exclude [*mī-m*] *annīm*; see for *huršiānum* *21:6 and 11, and the observations in AKT 5, p.175f. Reading the name of transporter in l. 22 as Šu-Kūbum, although the traces of BU are not convincing, is suggested by his mention in l. 7.

27. There is a Šamaš-bāni, son of Ahatum (Ka 970:24, witness); the damaged sign looks like KI, but a son of Akitum is, as far as I know, not attested elsewhere.

32-35. See for the system of collecting funds for collective enterprises by depositing silver or textiles in the colonial office, called *šitapkum*, “communal pouring”, see OAI 132-147.

37. The name of the *šuhārum* is not given, but it might be Elamma's youngest son Abu-šalim, for which he cared much, cf. *18:20-26.

21. Kt 92/k 148 (1-108-92)

A “notifying message” (a black tablet, whose edges are damaged) sent to Elamma in Kanesh (by Hinnāya from somewhere in Anatolia (a town with a colony, see l. 29), to inform him about a substantial shipment of silver and gold that Aššur-ṭāb is bringing him.

- um-ma Hi-na-a-ma a-na* Thus Hinnāya, say to
E-lá-ma ú A-šur-šú-lu-[l] Elamma and Aššur-šulūlī:
qí-bi-ma 3 né-pí-šu-ú KÙ.B. “3 packets with silver,

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- 40 *ma-na šu-qú-ul-ta-šu-nu* weighing 40 minas,
 5 *ù 2 ma-na GUŠKIN* and 2 minas of gold – it is in a
i-hu-ur-ší-a-ni *h.* container that has been
*ša a-na i-lim : e-ru-ba-at-ni / *na-°dí-i₂* placed inside the bag -
ku-nu-ki-a : A-šur-DÙG DUMU A-šur-l Aššur-ṭāb, son of Aššur-karwa, is bringing
na-áš-a-ku-nu-tí : ku-nu-ki-a [*kar-wa* you under my seal.
 Aššur-ṭāb must
 10 *A-šur-DÙG li-ip-qí-da-ku-nu-tí-/ma* hand it over to you under my seal
i-lúm ša hu-ur-ší-a-num and the bag in which the *huršiānum*
ša-ak-na-at-ni is placed must
 l.e. *i-na ku-nu-ki-[a²]* remain in Elamma's house
 14 *É E-*[lā]-m[a lī]-bi₄-ší* under [my] seal.
 rev. 1½ DUG *a-lá-ni* *°x (x) x₂ 1½ jar of acorns
DUG ra-bi-tim of a big jar, with
ù 22 ma-na URUDU SIG₅ 22 minas of refined copper,
i-li-bi a-lá-ni na-dí-i placed in the acorns,
[k]u-nu-ki-a l-lá-li-ú-ma-/an Ilaliuman is bringing to you
 20 *[n]a-áš-a-ku-um : DUG a-ha-ma* under my seal. Separately a jar with
a-lá-ni ku-nu-ki Ša-ak-tù-nu-a acorns with the seals of Šaktunua
na-áš-a-ku-um : a-lá-ni he is bringing you. The acorns he
ku-nu-ki-a li-ip-qí-du-ni-/ku-m[a] must entrust to you under my seal
i-na ku-nu-ki-a and they must remain
 25 *li-bi-ší šu-ma* (erasure) under my seal. Should the
ELLAT-tám e-ta-ar-ba-a-/am* caravan have already arrived ,
 u.e. °x x x x *[]²-li-kà-nim the must come here.
 °a-n]a-kam iš²-tí *kà-ri-im₂ Here I have reached an agreement with
na-am-gu₅-ra-ku šu-ma with the colony. If the textiles
 l.e.e. [T]ÚG.HI.A *i-š[é-ru²-n]im °šé-bi₄-lá-nim are right to you, send them here
 31 *ù °šu-m₂[a² lá-ma] sú-<ku>-ur-/tim* and if they arrive [before] the
*e-ru-bu-nim *[x x x] x* suspension of traffic"

Notes

7-12. I follow the suggestion of Kouwenberg to take *e-ru-ba-at-ni* as stative of the D-stem of *erābum* with *huršiānum* (fem.) as subject, although this particular meaning of the D-stem is as yet unattested. The female stative *šaknat* in l. 12 must have *illum* (plur. *illātum*) as subject, a large bag in which one “places” items and which can be sealed (*ana illim šakānum*, cf. TC 3, 273:11ff., packets with silver *ana illim iškunūšunuma* u S. *iknuk*). The final *na-dí-i* written between the ends of l. 7 and 8 is difficult; one expects *nad'ū* with the packets of silver and gold as subject.

8. See for Aššur-karwa as son of Aššur-ṭāb, Kt 91/k 153:21 (witness) and *129:6 (a joint caravan of him and Aššur-imittī).

15-16. In l. 15 DUG = *karputum* is a measure of capacity of ca. 30 litres; the “big jar” in l. 16 is simply a storage jar available.

22. A plural form, *lipqidū*, with unknown subject, or a mistake for *lipqidakkuma* (cf. l. 10)? Note the shift from the plural suffix in l. 10 to the singular (probably referring to Elamma) in lines 20 and 22.

32. Cf. Kt 91/k 147:11-13, 7 TÚG *ku[tānē] / lama sú-k[u-ur-tim] / talqe*. Kouwenberg suggests [*i-na*] *pá-zu-ur-tim*, cf. TPAK 1, 50:19f..

22. Kt 91/k 303 (1-160-91)

This letter and *23 were apparently sent to Elamma when he was elsewhere in Anatolia by Aššur-mālik and he must have taken them back to Kanesh. This letter reports on what Aššur-mālik did with the silver Elamma had sent to him in Kanesh, the second on the arrival of a load of textiles, the bulk of which he sent on to Elamma. Aššur-mālik may be identical to the writer of *24 and to the trader who figures in the texts 23, c) and d) in the Appendix.

	<i>a-na E-lá-ma qí-bi₄-ma</i>	Say to Elamma,
	<i>um-ma A-šùr-ma-lik-ma</i>	thus Aššur-mālik:
	KÙ.B. <i>ša tù-šé-bi₄-lá-ni</i>	"The silver you sent me
	<i>ù tup-pè-kà a-na ma-lá</i>	and your tablets I have now sent
5	<i>té-er-tí-°kà₂ a-na A-lim^{ki}</i>	to the City following your
	<i>uš-té-bi₄-il₅ a-šu-mi *K[Ù.B.]</i>	instruction. As for the silver
	<i>ša É kà-ri-im ša °a₂-[na]</i>	of the colonial office that
	<i>Lá-qé-pi-im tù-šé-bi₄-[u]</i>	you sent for La-qēpum,
	KÙ.B. <i>a-na Lá-li-im a-[dí-]n?</i>	I gave that silver to Lalum
10	<i>a-šé-er KÙ.B. ù 5 TÚG š[a]</i>	In addition to that silver and the 5
	<i>[a]*-°di₂-ú-ma i-na KÙ.B.-áp</i>	textiles that I deposited silver has
	<i>[Lá-qé]-pi-im-ma i-ší-qí-il₅</i>	been paid from La-qēpum's silver.
	<i>[K]Ù.B.-°kà a-na Lá-qé-pi-im</i>	Let your silver go to Lā-qēpum
14	<i>[lⁱ]-[i]-ik-ma i-na</i>	and then, when the silver is spent
l.e.	<i>[ga?]-ma-ar KÙ.B. šu-um-kà</i>	we will register it in your name
rev.	<i>i-na É kà-ri-im</i>	in the colonial office.
	<i>lu ni-il₅-pu-ut a-šu-mi</i>	As for the silver of Amur-lštar,
	KÙ.B. <i>ša A-mur-lštar ša a-na Lá-qé-</i>	which he owes to Lā-qēpum
	<i>ù ku-a-tí ha-bu-lu [pi-/im</i>	and to you,
20	<i>té-er-tí Lá-qé-pi-im a-šé-er</i>	there came a message of La-qēpum,
	<i>Lá-li-im ù ku-a-tí i-li-kam-/ma</i>	addressed to Lalum and you, in which
	<i>[u]m-ma šu-ut-ma u₄-me : ša-áb-ta-ma</i>	he said: 'Seize (him for) the days
	<i>ma-°lá₂ e-tí-qú-ni 1 GÍN.TA</i>	he is overdue and claim (an interest of)
	<i>°a₂-ma-na-im ší-sí-a-ma KÙ.B.</i>	1 shekel per mina and make him pay
25	<i>[ù š]i-ba-sú ša-áš-qí-lá-šu a-wa-[ám]</i>	the silver and the interest on it'.
	<i>[a?]-šu-mi ni-a-tí mi-li-ik</i>	As for the matter, decide on behalf
	<i>[KÙ].B.-pi-kà mi-li-ik TÚG.HI.A</i>	of us what to do with your silver.
	<i>[ma]-lá Be-lúm-ba-ni e-zí-ba-ku-ni</i>	Sell all the textiles that Bēlum-bāni
	<i>[ba]-tí-iq ù wa-tù-ur</i>	left behind for you at any price,
30	<i>°i-na₂ ni-a-ú-tim-ma : ma-na-im</i>	for copper (weighed) by our
	<i>[x-x₂*-us-ma dí-in [URUDU</i>	own 1-mina-weight. It must
	<i>lá i-na-dí-ú KÙ.B.</i>	not be stocked; the silver"
le.e	(uninscribed)	

Notes

11. Sign before *ú* could be rest of TI or NU, hence *[a-d]i-ú-ma* or, less likely, *[am-n]u-ú-ma*.

15. Since in OA *gamrum* is not used for "the total", *gamār* must be the infinitive of the verb

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22. Since an expression *ūmē šabātum* is unknown, I assume that the writer had in mind either *šabtāšuma* "seize him and claim for all the days", or "seize (the silver) and claim" ; in both cases 1 GÍN.TA it interest due per mina.

25. The accusative *awātam* is difficult, also syntactically and the translation is just an attempt.

30-31. Since l. 30 (where the plural *nia'ūtīm* with *mana'im* is a mistake for *ni'ā'im*) deals with the 1-mina weight to be used, the verb at the beginning of l. 31 should mean something like "to establish / fix" the (amount of) copper, scil. to be paid for the textiles, but a reading *[ku-b]u-us*, "reduce, deduct", is unlikely because it would make the trader receive less copper!

32. The word order is strange, perhaps KÙ.B. as logical object of the verb was meant to be read at the end of line 31. Instructions not "to deposit/stock silver", because it then would remain unproductive, are found more often, e.g. in BIN 6, 25:15-22, "You wrote me: 'B. has paid us the silver and it is now in deposit'. The silver must not be in deposit (*nadi* ¹⁸ *kaspum la nadi*). If l. needs it, let him take it and if not, lend it out at interest".

23. Kt 91/k 354 (1-211-91)

This letter was written by Aššur-mālik when he had arrived with a caravan in Kanesh, where he paid taxes in the palace, Elamma's wife took one textile, and he deposited a textile for Elamma in the colonial office (lines 7-15). He reports on expenses and payments for the caravan in Kanesh and tells him that the remaining 52 textiles are on their way to him with Bēlum-bāni, who is also mentioned in *22:28 and according to *18:18 had received a "working capital" (*be'ulātum*) and thus was as "harnesser" (*kaššārum*) in the service of Elamma. He could be the son of Kaziya, who figures as witness for Elamma in *300:18.

[a]-na E-la-ma qí-bi ₄ -ma (erasure)	Say to Elamma,
[u]m-ma A-šur-ma-lik-ma	thus Aššur-mālik:
a-na ma-lá ṭup-pí-im ša a-lim ^{ki}	"Compared with the tablet from the City
[1 k]u-ta-nu-um ba-tí-iq um-ma Ú-zu-a-ma	1 <i>kutānum</i> is missing. Uzua said:
5 [TÚ]G.HI.A i-na a-lim ^{ki} ú-lá im-nu-ú-nim	'They did not count the textiles in the City.
[n]a-ru-qá-tim ip-qí-du-nim	they simply entrusted the bags to me'.
[1 TÚ]G i-na ni-is-ha-tim il ₅ -qé-ú	They took 1 textile when levying the
2 TÚG.HI.A i-na e-kál-lim	import tax, 2 textiles got lost in the
palace	
i-na sá-i-tí-kà ih-li-qú-ma	from/at the time of your and
10 1 TÚG a-ta tū-ma-li	you made good 1 textile and
1 TÚG Ú-šú-ur-ša-lštar DUMU A-šur-i-mi-tí	1 textile Ušur-ša-Aššur, Aššur-imittī's
son	
i-na pá-al: a-ma-kam ša-ba-sú-ma	will compensate. Seize him there and
ku-ta-nam li-dí-na-kum	let him give you the <i>kutānu</i> -textile.
TÚG a-na É kà-ri-im a-qá-tí-kà	I deposited a textile in the colonial office
15 a-dí 1 TÚG Lá-ma-sà-tum tal-qé	as your share, 1 textile Lamassutum
took.	
2 TÚG-tí-šu kà-ša-ru-um il ₅ -qé	The harnesser took his 2 textiles,

31	<i>ku-ta-ni Be-lúm-ba-ni</i>	31 textiles Bēlum-bāni brought you.
l.e.	<i>ub-la-kum i-na 25 TÚG šu-ru-tim</i>	Of the 25 dark textiles they took
rev.	<i>3 TÚG a-na ni-is-ha-tim</i>	3 textiles as import-tax,
20	<i>il₅-qé-ú : 1 TÚG Lá-ma-sà-tum tal-qé</i>	Lamassutum took 1 textile,
	<i>21 TÚG šu-ru-tim e-zi-ib ša li-wi-/tim</i>	21 dark textiles, apart those for wrapping
	<i>Be-lúm-ba-ni ub-la-kum</i>	Bēlum-bāni brought you.
	<i>mì-šu ša i-na TÚG.HI.A 2 TÚG tal-qé-ú</i>	Why did you take 2 of the textiles?
	<i>šf-im-šu-nu : a-na Be-lúm-ba-ni dí-in</i>	Give their price to Bēlum-bāni.
25	<i>iš-tù AN.NA-ak qā-tí-šu</i>	After Uzua's tin for expenses
	<i>ša Ū-zu-a : ga-am-ru : 17 ma-na / AN.NA</i>	had been spent they took 17 minas
	<i>i-na ha-ra-nim il₅-qé-ú</i>	of tin during the journey.
	<i>½ ma-na KÙ bé-ú-lá-tù-šu ⅓ ma-na</i>	His working capital was ⅓ mina of silver,
	<i>a-pá-ni-šu ú-šé-bi₄-il₅ ANŠE</i>	I sent ⅓ mina to him en route. A donkey
30	<i>i-ha-ra-nim i-mu-ut-ma</i>	died during the journey and they
	<i>1 ma-na AN.NA ú-ma-li-ú-šu-um</i>	compensated him 1 mina of tin.
	<i>ù ⅓ ma-na AN.NA a-pu-ul-šu-um</i>	and I balanced him ⅓ mina of tin.
	<i>*5² ma-na.TA °da₂-tum ik-šu-dam</i>	The road-tax amounted to 5 ² minas per
	<i>[x GÍ]N.TA °qā-qā₂-da-tum</i>	talent, the head-tax to [x] shekels each.
35	<i>[x m]a-na 5 GÍN.TA ú-ku-ul-tám</i>	The food cost [x] minas 5 shekels per
(per-	<i>[iš]-ku-nam 8⅓ ma-na 7 GÍN KÙ</i>	son/donkey. 8 minas 27 shekels of silver
	<i>[pá²]-ni-um ⅓ ma-<na> 5 GÍN KÙ</i>	the first ² (shipment?), 3 minas 25
shekels of	<i>[š]a Lá-lu-um i-dí-ú</i>	silver is what Lalum deposited.
	<i>[x+] 1 TÚG ku-ta-nu 4 TÚG šu-ru-tum</i>	2 (or: 11) ² kutānu-textiles, 4 dark textiles
l.e.	<i>[x x x x-m]u² 1 TÚG ku-ta-nam¹(NIM)</i>	[.....]; (for) 1 kutānu-textile
41	<i>[ša a-qā-tl]-kà a-dí-ú</i>	that I deposited as your share (and)
	<i>[1 ku-ta-na]-am ša a-na-ku °a-dí-ú₂</i>	[1 kutā]nu-textile that I myself
deposited,	<i>[x x xx +] 3½ GÍN KÙ °DAM₂.GÀR-ri-im</i>	[, x]+3½ shekels of silver of the
	<i>[i-na tup-pl]²-kà lá-pi-it</i>	trader are booked on your [tablet]."

Notes

1. At the end of the erasure one can still read *-bu-ma*.
4. Uzua, the harnesser mentioned in l. 16, also occurs in *37:31-32. After he had spent his "loose tin" (lines 15-24) he was sent additional money to cover his expenses en route.
5. The harnesser received the sealed bags with textiles to load them on the donkeys, but they had been filled by others, presumably Elamma's representatives in Assur.
7. Since there must have been in all ca. 35 kutānu-textiles a tax of 1 textile is too little and one would expect an additional balancing payment (*nipiltum*).
8. Note the phonetic spelling with E instead of É (*e-gal-lim*).
9. The meaning of *sa'utum* is still not clear.
- 10-12. These lines mention how the loss of 2 textiles has to be compensated, one has to be supplied by Elamma, the other Ušur-ša-lštar has to compensate. This arrangement suggests that the donkeys + merchandise of Elamma were part of a larger caravan.

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19. An import-tax of 3 textiles on a load of 25 is unexplainably heavy. Note here *laqā'um ana nishatim*, "to take as import-tax", but in l. 7 *ina nishatim*, "when the import-tax was levied".

26f. The additional tin for the transporter must have been taken out of a sealed *šūqlum*.

29-32. The replacement of the dead donkey would have cost ca. 2 minas of tin of which "they/one" – probably the other participants of the joint caravan - compensated him 1 mina.

33. Presumably 5 (the heads of the three upper wedges are preserved) minas per (talent of tin), which would mean an acceptable $8 \frac{1}{3}$ % of the calculated value (*awītum*) of the load (cf. the table in AOATT 238).

36-38. I assume that the substantial amounts of silver are those spent to equip the caravan; the uncertain restoration *[pa]nium* fits the room available and the fact that a second amount follows. *Lalum* also occurs in *22:9 as recipient of silver Elamma had sent to La-qēpum and in l. 21 together with Elamma; was he an investor in the business?

40. Beginning unclear, perhaps a stative, followed by two deposits of textiles, cf. lines 14f.

24. Kt 92/k 156 (1-116-92)

This small, brittle and damaged tablet contains a letter sent to Elamma by two writers, the name of the first is missing, that of the second broken (perhaps Aššur-[mālik?]). It deals with the arrival of merchandise in a town with a palace (l.10). If this was Kanesh, Elamma would have been staying elsewhere in Anatolia and must have taken this letter along to deposit it in his archive in Kanesh.

	<i>a-na E-lá-[ma]</i>	To Elamma,
	<i>qí-bi-m[a um-ma x x x]</i>	say, thus [.....]
	<i>ù A-šur-^oma²-[lik-ma]</i>	and Aššur-m[ālik?]:
	4 GÚ AN.NA <i>[ku-nu-ki ša]</i>	"4 talents of tin [with seals applied]
5	<i>a-lim^{ki} ^oú₂ [x ku-ta-ni ELLAT]?</i>	in the City and [x <i>kutānu</i> -textiles]?
	<i>La-qé-pí-im [ub-lam]</i>	Lā-qēpum's [<i>caravan brought here</i>].
	<i>ŠÀ.BA 17½ m[a-na]</i>	Thereof: 17½ minas of
l.e.	AN.NA <i>lá [ku-nu-ki² (ù)]</i>	tin without [<i>seals (and)</i>]
rev.	5 <i>ku-ta-nu ^oi-na]</i>	5 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles
10	É.GAL- <i>lim lá-qé-[ú]</i>	were taken in the palace.
	<i>ki-ma té-er-[a-kà lá-šu-ni²]</i>	<i>For lack of a written instruction of yours</i>
	<i>i-pì-kà a-na *x / x x</i>	on the basis of what
	<i>um-ma a-ta-ma</i>	you said to:
	AN.NA <i>i-šé-er</i>	"Let him entrust it
15	DAM.GÀR- <i>ri-im</i>	to an agent
	<i>li-dí-šu a *^ox₂ [x x]</i>	"
u.e.	not inscribed	

Notes

4-5. See for this meaning of the words "seals of the City", OAI, 91-93.

5-6. The restoration of l. 5 is required by lines 9-10 and at the end of the line we need a noun on

which the genitive Lā-qēpim depends and a verb. Lā-qēp(um) occurs in *15*:13 and *322:3 as a man to whom merchandise is entrusted for transport and his “caravan” features in *5:9, *68A:18-19, and in many other texts, see *OAI*, 165.

11. Not *kīma te’ertika*, so that *te’ertum* must be subject.

Comment

It is possible that this shipment, transported by Lā-qēp, is also mentioned in the transport contract *15, where 6 donkeys carry 4 1/3 talents of tin and in all 123 textiles.

25. Kt 92/k 160A/B (1-120-92)

A letter to Elamma by Aššur-mūtappil on what happened with the tin that had been “given”, i.e. sold on credit to him and Ahu-waqar, when it could not be shipped to Burušhattum. He entrusted it to Aššur-ṭāb, who would send him textiles (for it) in Wahšušana.

A. Envelope (half of it preserved), with only two identical seal impressions.

Seal: CS 739 = *312A = Kt n/k 1906A. The inscription is difficult to read, it looks like [A]-°šur-lá-ma-s₂[f] / DUMU A¹-da-[....], but was owned by Aššur-mūtappil, the writer of the letter, who figures with the same seal as witness and sealer in *312:2, where his patronym is not given.

B. Tablet

	<i>a-na E-lá-ma qí-bi-ma</i>	Say to Elamma,
	<i>um-ma A-šūr-mu-ta-pi-il₅-ma</i>	thus Aššur-mūtappil:
	<i>3 GÚ AN.NA ú šú-ba-tí</i>	“As for the 3 talents of tin and
	<i>ša ta-dí-na-ni</i>	the textiles you gave me with
5	<i>um-ma a-ta-ma 1 GÚ AN.NA</i>	the instruction: ‘You and Ahu-waqar
	<i>a-ta ù A-hu-qar</i>	must take (each) 1 talent of tin’ -
	<i>liq-a ki-ma šé-pu-um</i>	since the traffic is
	<i>na-ak-ša-at-ni a-na</i>	is interrupted
	<i>Bu-ru-uš-ha-tim</i>	I brought it to
10	<i>a-šé-er A-šur-DÙG</i>	Burušhattum,
i.e.	<i>ú-bi-il₅-ma</i>	to Aššur-ṭāb and
	<i>3 GÚ AN.NA</i>	I gave Aššur-ṭāb
rev.	<i>a-na A-šūr-DÙG</i>	the 3 talents of tin.
	<i>a-dí-in TÚG.HI.A</i>	The textiles
15	<i>a-na Úh-šu-ša-na</i>	he brought back to
	<i>ú-ta-e-ra-am</i>	Wahšušana.
	<i>35½ GÚ URUDU</i>	He shipped to you 35½
	<i>i-šé-ep A-šūr-DÙG</i>	talents of copper under Aššur-ṭāb’s
	<i>ú i-šé-pi-a e-bu-kam</i>	and my responsibility.”

Notes

5. The original instruction to take each 1 talent (what happened with the third talent is unclear) could not be carried out.

7-8. The expression *šēpum nakšat* is new, but the context shows that its meaning must be identical to *šēpī ana parsat*, “my access to ... is cut off”, attested in VS 26, 71:14-15 and in “Ankara 9”:6-7. This shows that the verb *nakāšum* is a phonetic variant

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of *nakāsum*, “to cut off” just like (information Kouwenberg) *parāsum*, “to separate”, appears in OA also as *parāšum*. See Veenhof *Lex*, s.v

16-19. Because of *ēbukam* the verb should have a 3rd person subject, although the context seems to favor the first person. This amount of copper in l. 17 may have been acquired by selling the tin and textiles elsewhere.

26. Kt 91/k 356 (1-213-91)

A long letter by Elamma's business associate Hinnāya, which deals with a variety of issues. He tells what happened with a substantial shipment of textiles sent to him and of problems concerning a donkey. He next reports on the payment for textiles taken as tax and on problems with a donkey, asks for specific textiles to be sent to him, and mentions his intention to sell textiles of Elamma in Zimišhuna. Finally how Ištar-pilah, “our little brother”, acquired gold that belongs to the *tamkārum*.

<i>um-ma Hi-na-a-ma a-na E-lá-ma</i> <i>qí-bi₄-ma 1 me-at 8 ku-ta-ni</i> <i>qá-dum ša kà-ša-re ša a-na</i> <i>A-ku ta-áp-qí-du ŠÀ.BA</i> 5 <i>75 ku-ta-ni ub-lu-nim um-ma</i> <i>kà-ša-ru-ma i-ba-a-ba-at</i>	Thus Hinnāya, say to Elamma: “Of the 108 <i>kutānu</i>-textiles, including those of the harnessors, which you entrusted to Aku, they brought me 75 <i>kutānu</i>-textiles. The harnesser declared: ‘In the outskirts
of <i>A-lim^{ki} na-ru-qú-um ma-a-tum</i> <i>°ih₂-li-iq-ma a-k[u]-a-tim</i> <i>iš-ta-kà-an ù ANŠE i-na ANŠE-lri-a</i> 10 <i>uš-ta-ba ù um-ma DUMU Ša-lá-mi-/im-ma</i> said:	the city one large bag (with textiles) got lost’, and he reckoned it as yours. He also wanted to recoup a donkey from my donkeys, but the son of Blacky
<i>a-na ANŠE ša ut-ha-ra-am</i> <i>ša-ak-nu ša Hi-na-a šu-ut ANŠE</i> <i>e-mu-qá-tám-ma i-tù-ru</i> <i>ù pu-ùh-šu ANŠE ša i-dí-nu</i> 15 <i>me-et TÚG.HI.A wa-at-ru-tim</i> were <i>ša i-ni-is-ha-tim i-li-qí-ú</i> l.e. <i>šu-ma 16 GÍN.TA KÙ.B.</i> silver	‘Look, the donkey that is provided with a mark belongs to Hinnāya!’ The donkey he took along by force, but the donkey he gave in its place is dead. As for the additional textiles that taken when the import-tax was levied, if they will take them for 16 shekels of
<i>i-ta-bu-lu KÙ.B. le-pu-/lá-ku-[nu]-/tí</i> <i>šu-ma 16 GÍN.TA ba-tí-iq</i> rev. <i>ša ki-ma TÚG.HI-tí-a ša i-ni-is-/ha-tim</i> 21 <i>i-li-qí-ú-ni i-TÚG-ba-tí-/šu</i> <i>li-qé-a-ma šé-bi₄-lá-/nim</i> <i>té-er-tí a-šé-er A-šur-na-da</i> <i>ù A-šur-šú-lu-li i-li-ik</i> 25 <i>a-ša-sà-im iš-tí-šu 1 šu-lu-up-kà-/am</i> <i>ù ku-sí-tám ša A-ki-dí-e</i> <i>ù 2 ku-ta-ni ša hu-BA-°x₂-ri</i> <i>qá-at-nu-tim ú er-qú-tim</i> <i>šé-bi₄-lam TÚG.HI.A ša áš-pu-ra-ku-ni</i>	apiece, let him pay you that silver. If it is less than 16 shekels apiece take as many of my textiles as were taken at the levying of the import-tax from his textiles and send them to me. An instruction of mine went to Aššur-nādā and Aššur-šulūlī. to settle accounts with him. Send me 1 Šulupkian textil with an Akkadian <i>kusītu</i>-garment and 2 <i>kutānu</i>'s of that are thin and yellowish. Send me (also) the textiles I wrote you about,

- 30 *šé-bi₄-lá-ma Šu-Bé-lam lu-kà-li-im-ma* so that I can show them to Šu-Bēlum(?)
ší-im ANŠE.HI.A ù ší-im and realize(?) the sale price of the
 donkeys,
TÚG.HI.A šu-lu-up-ki-im ú ku-sí-tim the Šulupkian textiles and the *kusītu*-
ki-ma ú-bu-lu-ni e-pá-áš garment according to what they are
 worth.
TÚG.HI-tí-kà ša i-Zi-mi-iš-hu-na As for your textiles that are in
 Zimišhuna,
 35 *i-ba-ší-ú-ní* *TÚG.HI.A ma-lá* I will sell as many of them
ta-da-nim lá-dí-šu-ma ú[?] (erasure) as I can and, moreover,
 u.e. *a-na lštar-pi-lá-ah¹* 2 minas of gold have been given
2 ma-na KÙ.GI na-dí-in-šum to lštar-pilah;
KÙ.B. 1 GÍN every shekel of silver he carries with him
 le.e *ša DAM.GÀR na-ší lá a-hu-ni* belongs to the *tamkārum*. Is he not our
 little
 41 *ša-ah-ru-um šu-ma té-er-tí lu ša A-lá-/* brother? If you have with you an order of
*lu ša *NI[?]-ŠÍ-x-x na-áš-a-tí* [hi/- im] Ali-ahum or of
té-er-ta-kà li-li-kam send me a message about it".

Notes

4. *A-ku* not attested elsewhere.

6. The normal meaning of *ba'abtum*, "outstanding claim", does not make sense here, hence my attempt to take it as referring to a locale. This meaning also fits in Kt g/k 220:26 (*ArAn* 5 [2002] 81), "6 shekels of tin, transport costs in the outskirts of the City" (*taššiātum* / *i-ba-a-ba-at a-lim^k*), among a few specific expenses mentioned at the end of a record of payments for tolls and head-tax of a caravan starting in Assur and ending in Tegarama.

10. *šallāmum*, "blacky", must be a nickname. The name occurs also in AKT 4, 32:13-14, as father of Ikuppiya, and a "son of Blacky" in *89:20 and 29, who is probably identical to the one in this letter and involved in the transport of gold. Persons called "Blacky" are Pilah-lštar (*Pi-la-ah-lštar ša-lá-mi-im* in a Kültepe tablet I know from a photo in the possession of B. Landsberger, "Photo F", l. 18') and the week-eponym Aššur-mālik, in *98:11, which makes it impossible to know who is meant in our text.

13. *i-tù-ru*, must a perfect of *tarā'um*, "to take along".

18. I take *i-ta-BU-lu* as *itabbulū*, a present tense of *tabālum*, "to take away, appropriate", although the wording reminds one (as Kouwenberg observes) of the expression "(sell the textiles) if they yield x shekels apiece", which requires the G-stem (*ubbulū*) or the Gtn-stem (*ittanabbulū* and not the preterite *ittabbulū*). The following *lēpul* has a different, singular subject.

20. *ša kīma* means "as many as", cf. AKT 3, 102:7, *luqūtam ša kīma tamkārū iš'umūnim*.

27. The noun *hu-ba²-x-ri* occurs only here and its meaning is unknown.

38-42. These lines present many difficulties. The clear *nadinšum* in l. 38 is strange, because the stative should be *tadin*. The tentative translation of lines 39-40 takes into account that *našī* is not in the subjunctive. In l. 41 *tērtum* could be "instruction", but also "order" in the sense of "goods ordered". lštar-pilah, who corresponds with Elamma (*93:2, cf. the bulla *365?), is known as a transporter (*rādi luqūtīm*) in the service of Hinnāya, *19:7, 40. Is he "our young brother / junior colleague" of lines 40-41 and did he receive the 2 minas of gold (as payment for) a share in a joint-stock company, which

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frequently had that size? The same 2 minas of gold are probably mentioned in *89:28-31, where “the son of Blacky” (see l. 10 of the present letter) has to bring them to Elamma.

42. Difficult to read, but the signs should refer to a person, perhaps IR PN or *Ir-mā-lštar*?

3. Letters sent from Assur

Most of the next letters were sent to Elamma by his business associates or representatives in Assur, Aššur-rēšī, Ennam-Aššur and Dadiya, to whom Elamma sent his notifying messages from Kanesh. Among their writers we also meet his brother Ali-ahum, Elamma's business associates Hinnāya and Iliya, and there is one letter (*30) which Elamma must have sent to Kanesh when he was in Assur.

27. Kt 91/k 307 (1-164-91)

Elamma's representatives and his brother inform him on the loan they took out for him for making purchases (l.13), to be shipped to him by Aššur-mūtappil, and how a small part of it was used to pay for a houseplot in Assur. They also mention a decision of the judges “to set Elamma a term of two years”, lest his tablets become invalid or will be removed, but what is at stake remains unclear.

um-ma A-lá-hi-im-ma
A-šur-re-šī En-um-A-šur
ù Da-dí-a a-na E-lá-ma
qí-bi-ma a-ma-lá té-er-tí-kà
 5 *30 ma-na KÙ.B. É tám-kà-ri-im*
a-na ší-ib-tim ni-il₅-qé-a-ku-um
a-šé-er É ša ta-am-gu₅-ru
mì-ša-al : šu-ub¹-tí-im
nu-ťá-hi-ma 3 ma-na KÙ.B.
 10 *ni-iš-qú-ul i-hi-id-ma*
 l.e. *KÙ.B. a-na ší-ib-tim*
 rev. *i-lá-ak : KÙ.B. šé-bi₄-lá-am*
ší-mu-um ša-i-im
A-šur-mu-ta-pì-il₅ i-na
 15 *pá-ni-ú-tim ni-ťá-ra-dá-am*
da-a-nu u₄-me ŠÈ.2.MU
iš-ku-na-ku-um u₄-mu-ú
e im-lu-ú-ma i-na
ťup-pì-kà e ú-ki-šu-kà
 20 *i-hi-id ťup-pá-am ša me-ra*
A-zu-a šé-bi₄-lam

Thus Ali-ahum,
 Aššur-rēšī, Ennam-Aššur
 and Dadiya, say to Elamma:
 “In accordance with your instruction
 we borrowed for you at interest
 30 minas of silver with a money-lender.
 We added a surface of half a *šubtum* to the
 houseplot about which you had reached
 an agreement and paid 3 minas of
 silver. Note well that
 the silver is interest bearing,
 so send the silver.
 The purchases have been made,
 we will send Aššur-mūtappil off
 to you with the next opportunity.
 The judges have set you a term
 of two years, don't exceed
 that term lest they declare
 your tablets invalid.
 Take care to send the tablet of
 of the son of Azua.”

Notes

1. The genitive form *A-lá-hi-im* must be a mistake, hardly a genitive caused by *umma*.

4-6. See for this loan the comments on *16:9-13.

8. Half a *šubtum* is ca. 18 m². We do not know which purchase is meant.

14. Aššur-mūtappil occurs as transporter of merchandise also in *34:27.

16f. We do not know which affair is meant. The verbal form is singular, but the subject looks plural; note the strange writing ŠÈ.2.MU instead of MU.2.ŠÈ. These lines were quoted in *OALP* 335, note 1056, where the incongruence between the plural *dayyānū* and the verb in the singular is noted.

19. *CAD A/I*, 264, 3, lists only two OA occurrences of the D-stem of *akāšum*, which would mean “to move” (object: feet) and “to mislay” (object: tablets).³ Most of the ca. 20 occurrences now known are statives or verbal adjective (written *akkuš*, *ekkuš* and *ukkuš*), with tablets as objects, and “removed” frequently means “cancelled”, “made invalid”. See Veenhof *Lex.*, s.v.

28. Kt 91/k 315 (1-172-91)

Ēnah-ilī reports to Elamma and Kurub-lštar on a caravan he is leading to them, consisting of four donkey loads owned jointly by Elamma and Kurub-lštar and one owned by Elamma alone.

	°a-na ₂ E-lá-ma	Say to Elamma
	ù Kur-ub-lštar qí-bi ₄ -ma	and Kurub-lštar,
	um-ma E-na-ah-DINGIR-ma	thus Ēnah-ilī:
	4 GÚ 20 ma-na AN.NA ku-nu-/ku	“4 talents 20 minas of tin under seals,
5	72 ku-ta-nu	72 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles,
	qá-dum ša li-wi-/tim	including those for wrapping,
	4 ANŠE ša-lá-mu	4 black donkeys,
	30 LÁ ⅔ ma-na	29⅓ minas of
9	AN.NA qá-tim	loose tin -
l.e.	mi-ma a-nim	all this I am
rev.	a-ra-dí-a-ku-nu-tí	leading to you.
	14 LÁ ⅓ GÍN.<TA> AN.NA-ku-nu	Your tin was bought at a rate of
	ša-im AN.NA-ku wa-aq-/ru	13⅔ (shekels) per (shekel silver). Tin
	2 ma-na KÙ.B. a-pá-/ni-a	is expensive (therefore) send 2 minas silver
15	šé-bi ₄ -lá-nim	to reach me en route”.
	a-na E-lá-ma qí-bi ₄ -ma	Say to Elamma:
	1 me-at 60 ku-ta-nu	“160 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles,
	7 ANŠE ša-lá-mu	7 black donkeys,
	a-ra-dí-a-kum	I will lead to you;
u.e.	A-bu-ša-lim iš-tí-a	Abu-šalim travels
21	i-lá-ak	with me.
le.e	[ú] sà-he-er-tám	Send me also
	°ša ₂ KÙ.B. 10 GÍN	small wares for a value of
	°šé ₂ -bi ₄ -lá-nim	10 shekels of silver.

Notes

1-3. Elamma and Kurub-lštar were partners, who jointly sent silver to Assur (*8:27-29) and jointly wrote caravan letters to Assur, such as *82 addressed to Dadiya and Enah-ilī. The latter figures as transporter of a shipment of silver to Assur (*13:21), and

³ The rare G-stem is attested in BIN 4, 58:14, *šiprū e-ku-šu-nim*, and in Kt 94/k 772:21, *rābišum e-ku-ša-ku-nu-tí*.

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according to *31:9 and *32:6 (letters addressed to Elamma - referred to as the *tamkārum* in the second - and Kurub-lštar) he entrusted merchandise of Elamma and Kurub-lštar to Iddin-Aššur for transport to Kanesh. Ali-ahum could be his son, as mentioned in *17(a letter by Elamma).

4. The scribe forgot to write AN.NA and added it between lines 4 and 5.

8-9. The investments in this caravan must have amounted to at least 26 minas of silver, which fits the amount of “loose tin” provided to cover expenses en route, nearly 30 minas, which equals 2 minas 12 shekels of tin, or a little more than 8,6 % of the value of the load. The amount is sufficient for a caravan with 4 donkey loads half tin half textiles, see AOATT 263.

12-15. The exchange rate of silver : tin in Assur fluctuated between 12,5 and 16,5:1. The price in our text was not very high, but a rate of less than 14:1 was considered expensive, see Veenhof 1988, 253. The request to send 2 minas of silver suggests that Ēnah-ilī himself had spent more silver on buying merchandise than was available and *82 indeed shows that had to buy merchandise for the two addressees of our letter (see Introduction p. xxxvii).

17-18. In summarizing the load the writer uses nominatives, although the nouns are the object of *araddiakkum*. In l. 18 the 160 textiles on 7 donkeys make rather small loads (ca. 23 per donkeys), while 2 donkeys of the first caravan each carried at least 30 pieces (8 textiles were used for wrapping the tin, carried on 2 donkeys).

20-21. See for Abu-šalim the note on *18:22 and *Appendix* text 2

29. Kt 92/k 153 (1-113-92)

A small tablet, of which only the obverse is inscribed, with a short piece of information, probably sent by the writer when he was on the way with a caravan (see l. 6), to inform Elamma of what was coming.

<i>a-na E-lá-ma qí-bi₄-ma</i>	Say to Elamma,
<i>um-ma A-šur-SIPAD-ma</i>	thus Aššur-rē'ī:
4 <i>GÚ 20 ma-na AN.NA</i>	“4 talent 20 minas of tin
<i>ku-nu-ki 1 me-at 21 TÚG</i>	under seals (and) 121 textiles,
5 <i>mi-ma a-ni-im</i>	all this I am
<i>a-ra-dí-a-a-kum</i>	leading to you.”

Comment

The caravan must have comprised at least 6 donkeys, 2 loaded with tin, packed in 8 “wrapping textiles”, and 4 donkeys carrying each almost 30 textiles.

30. Kt 91/k 349 (1-206-91)

This letter (a rather worn tablet) must have been written by Elamma to his associates in Kanesh when he was for some time in Assur, as shown by the fact that the shipment includes a gift for his wife Lamassutum (17).

1 <i>a-na A-lá-hi-im</i>	To Ali-ahum
<i>ù Hi-na-a</i>	and Hinnāya,
<i>qí-bi-ma um-ma</i>	thus

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	<i>E-lá-ma-<ma> iš-té-en</i>	Elamma: "One
5	<i>šu-qú-ul : 1 GÚ 5 ma-na</i>	packet of 1 talent 5 minas,
	<i>iš-té-en 1 GÚ</i>	one of 1 talent
	<i>ŠU.NIGIN₂ 2 GÚ 5 ma-na AN.NA</i>	in all 2 talents 5 minas of tin
	<i>ku-nu-ku 25 ma-na</i>	under seals. 25
	<i>[A]N.NA qá-tim</i>	minas loose tin,
10	<i>[50]+12 ku-ta-nu</i>	[6]2 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles
	<i>[4] TÚG šu-ru-tum ša li-wi-/tim</i>	[4] black textiles for wrapping
	<i>[2]5 TÚG šu-ru-tum</i>	[2]5 dark textiles,
l.e.	<i>[ŠU.NIGIN₂] 91 TÚG.HI.A</i>	in all 91 textiles.
rev.	<i>[4] ANŠE.HI.A ša-lá-mu</i>	Four black donkeys
15	<i>[1] °ku₂-sī-tum : i-a-tum</i>	one <i>kusītu</i> -garment of myself
	<i>°ū₂ ša-nu-um ša Ta-ah-/sī</i>	and a kettle of Tahsi
	<i>a-na Lá-ma-sà-tim</i>	for Lamassutum.
	<i>°2₂ ku-ta-nu ša bé-ú-lá-at</i>	2 <i>kutānū</i> being the working capital
	<i>Ma-nu-ki-li-a 2 ku-ta-nu</i>	of Mannu-kī-iliya, 2 <i>kutānu</i> 's being the
20	<i>ša bé-ú-lá-at En-nam-A-/šūr</i>	working capital of Ennam-Aššur.
	<i>mī-ma a-nim En-nam-A-/šūr</i>	All this Ennam-Aššur,
	<i>DUMU Dī-dī-a i-ra-dī-a-[ku-nu-tī]</i>	son of Didiya is bringing to you (plur.).
	<i>2 GÚ 10 ma-na AN.NA ku-/nu-ku</i>	2 talents 10 minas of tin under seals,
	<i>4'(2) TÚG šu-ru-tum li-wi-tum</i>	4 dark textiles for wrapping,
25	<i>5 TÚG ku-ta-nu 2 ma-na</i>	5 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles, 2 minas of
	<i>AN.NA qá-tim 1 ANŠE</i>	loose tin, one black
	<i>[ša]-lá-mu-um</i>	donkey
u.e.	<i>[x x x x x x x]-ma-hi-im</i>	<i>[belonging to Ša]im-ahum?</i>
l.e	<i>[x+]60 ku-ta-nu 2 1/3 °ma-na 10 GÍN₂</i>	60+x <i>kutānu</i> -textiles, 2 1/3 minas 10?
		[[AN.NA] [shekels of
tin		
30	<i>°a₂-na qá-tī-šu a-dī-[in</i>	] I gave in his hand.
	<i>[x ma-n]a URUDU 3 ku-ta-nu [</i>	] [x] minas of copper, 3 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles
	<i>[x x₂*-BA mī-ma a-nim [</i>	] , all this [PN is bringing you?]."

Notes

10-14. The tentative restoration of the figures is based on the total of line 13, the fact that 4 textiles must have been used for wrapping one donkey load of tin, the traces visible and the size of the gaps.

16. The clear *Ta-ah-si* must be the name of a person in Assur, but I know no other attestations.

18-20. Both "harnessors" had apparently used the "working capital" they had received to buy a few textiles to be sold with profit in Anatolia.

21. The transporter also occurs as such in *88:12-13.

23-32. The end of the letter seems mentions two additional, separate lots of merchandise, the first perhaps belonging to [Ša]im-ahum, the second, consisting of textiles only, remains undefined, but much information is lost in the gaps of ca. 3 cms. at the end of lines 30-33

24. The emendation of 2 into 4 is suggested by the system of wrapping, cf. line 11.

30. The end must have been as lines 21-22, perhaps mentioning the same transporter. Cf. *28, where Ēnah-ilī leads two shipments on 11 donkeys to Kanesh.

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31. Kt 91/k 445 (1-298-91)

The next two letters were sent to Elamma (designated as *tamkārum* in *32) and his partner Kurub-lštar by Iddin-Aššur to inform them on forthcoming arrival of a load of merchandise, which has been entrusted to him (for transport) by Ēnah-ilī, known as a business associate of Elamma, who also serves as a transporter (*13:21; *28:3, 11). Both letters must have been sent to enable the recipients to take a decision (*milkam malākum*) about how to sell the merchandise that is coming. They may have been sent ahead off the caravan and perhaps from somewhere en route, because in *32:10-12 Iddin-Aššur asks to send him some money en route (*ana pānia*).

	<i>a-na E-lá-ma ù</i>	Say to Elamma and
	<i>Kur-ub-lštar qí-bi-ma</i>	to Kurub-lštar,
	<i>um-ma l-dí-A-šur-ma</i>	thus Iddin-Aššur:
	<i>2 GÚ 10 ma-na AN.NA</i>	“2 talents 10 minas of tin
5	<i>ku-nu-ki 50 TÚG ku-ta-ni</i>	under seals, 50 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles,
	<i>qá-de₈ ša li-wi-tim</i>	including those for wrapping (the tin),
	<i>3 ANŠE ša-lá-me-e</i>	3 black donkeys -
	<i>mì-ma a-nim</i>	all this Enah-ilī
l.e.	<i>E-na-ah-DINGIR</i>	entrusted to me (for transport).
rev.	<i>ip-qí-dam mì-li-ik</i>	Consider
11	<i>lu-qú-tí-ku-nu</i>	what to do
	<i>mì-il-kà</i>	with your merchandise.”

32. Kt 91/k 448 (1-301-91)

1	<i>a-na Kur-ub-lštar</i>	Say to Kurub-lštar
	<i>ù tám-kà-ri-im</i>	and the merchant,
	<i>qí-bi-ma um-ma l-dí-A-šur-<ma></i>	thus Iddin-Aššur:
	<i>50 TÚG ku-ta-ni 2 ANŠE</i>	“50 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles, 2 donkeys
5	<i>ša tám-kà-ri-im</i>	belonging to the trader
	<i>E-na-ah-ì-lí</i>	Enah-ilī
	<i>ip-qí-dam</i>	entrusted to me (for transport).
l.e.	<i>mì-li-ik</i>	Consider
rev.	<i>lu-qú-tí-ku-nu</i>	what to do with your
10	<i>mì-il₅-kà 1/3 ma-na</i>	merchandise. Send me
	<i>KÙ.B. a-na pá-ni-a</i>	en route 1/3 mina
	<i>šé-bi-lam</i>	of silver.”

Comment

The comparison between these two letters suggests that *tamkārum*, “the trader”, means Elamma (who in the address of the first letter precedes Kurub-lštar, but follows him in the second!), but it is not clear why this designation was used; perhaps it meant in this letter simply “the boss”. Letter *31 was probably sent to Kanesh ahead of the caravan, when he was leaving Assur, and *32 probably when he was on his way and discovered that he needed additional money (lines 10-13) for the expenses of the trip.

33. Kt 91/k 337 (1-194-91)

II. CARAVAN DOCUMENTS (7-53)

A short memo (written on a small, oblong tablet) about entrusting a shipment of two donkey-loads of textiles and tin belonging to Ali-ahum to a transporter. It is inserted here on the assumption that Ali-ahum is the brother of Elamma and it seems very likely that the anonymous writer is Elamma himself. The transaction could have taken place in Assur and then might be compared with letter *26, written by Elamma from Assur, but Kanesh seems more likely. In that case Elamma would have made a note of the fact that he had entrusted part of a larger caravan, after its arrival in Kanesh, on behalf of his brother to an agent or transporter for sale or shipment inside Anatolia.

	18 TÚG šu-ru-tim	18 dark textiles
	ù 10 TÚG ku-ta-ni	and 10 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles,
	2 GÚ AN.NA ù	2 talents of tin
	li-wi-sú	with it wrapping, under
5	ku-nu-ki-šu ša A-lim ^{ki}	his seals applied in the City,
i.e.	2 ANŠE ša-lá-me	2 black donkeys
rev.	ú ú-nu-sú-/nu	with their harness
	ša A-lá-hi-im	belonging to Ali-ahum,
	a-na A-šur-iš-l	I entrusted to
10	tí-kál	Aššuriš-tikal
	áp-qí-id	

Notes

5. “Seals of the City” usually mean sealings applied in Assur, but a shipment of only two donkeys could be entrusted in Kanesh, without opening the packets sealed in Assur, for further transport in Anatolia (cf. the introductory remarks to *42). This might explain the unusual formulation with a possessive suffix, “(still) under his seals applied in the City” (which, by the way, shows that such sealings were not applied *by* the authorities of the City of Assur, but *in* Assur, by its owner; cf. *OAI*, 91-93). The person speaking could be Elamma, when he was in Assur (see the comment on *30) or Ēnah-iltī, who in 31:9-10 also entrusted merchandise for transport to Kanesh.

9-10. He could be the man whose caravan (*ellutum*) is mentioned in *19:21 and *5:20.

C. Caravan accounts (34-48)

1. Sent from Assur

34. Kt 91/k 358 (1-215-91)

A damaged tablet that seems to have been varnished, coarse writing. The brother and representatives of Elamma inform him and Kurub-lštar about how they used 17 minas of silver delivered to them for equipping a caravan consisting of 4½ (sic) donkey load of textiles. accompanied by two “harnessers”, led by Aššur-mutappil.

°um-m ₂ a A-lá-hu-um	Thus Ali-ahum,
[D]a-dí-a Da-°x ₂ -[x –ma ²]	Dadiya, Da.....
°a ₂ -na E-lá-ma ù K[ur-u]b-[lštar]	say to Elamma and Kurub-lštar:
[q]í-bi ₄ -ma 17 ma-na K[Ü.B.]	“17 minas of silver

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- 5 Šál-ma-A-šur ub-lam
ni-is-ha-[sū]
ù-lá w[a-a]t-ra
ŠÀ.BA $\frac{2}{3}$ ma-na a-n[a]
ni-is-ha-tim ni-dí-[n]
- 10 3 GÍN i-ma-sà-im
im-tí ší-tí KÙ.B.-pi-[ku-nu]
16 ma-na 10 $\frac{1}{3}$ GÍN
l.e. ŠÀ 1 me-at 2°6 $\frac{1}{2}$ / ku-[ta-nu]
rev. 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ ma-na [3 GÍN KÙ.B.]
- 15 it-bu-lu 4 A[NŠE.HI.A]
°1 $\frac{1}{2}$ ma-na LÁ 2 G[ÍN]
it-bu-lu 7 $\frac{1}{2}$ G[ÍN]
 $\frac{1}{2}$ ANŠE 5/6 °ma-na; / 4 GÍN
be-ú-lá-at 2 kà-[ša-re]
- 20 qá-dum lu-bu-[ší-šu-nu]
20 ma-na AN.NA
13 GÍN.TA
1 $\frac{1}{2}$ ma-na 2 G[ÍN KÙ.B.]
u.e. °10 + x *GÍN $\frac{1}{2}$ ú-nu-ut
l.e. [ANŠ]E *[x+] 1 $\frac{1}{4}$ GÍN té-sú-/bu
- 26 2° GÍN °ša; sà-a-d/tim 8 $\frac{1}{4}$ GÍN
wa-ší-tum A-šur-mu-ta-pi-il $\frac{1}{5}$
i-ra-dí-a-ku-nu-tí
- Šallim-Aššur brought us,
without its excise
having been added.
Thereof we gave $\frac{2}{3}$ mina
as excise (and)
it became 3 shekels less due to
purifying, (so that) the rest of your silver
is 16 minas 10 $\frac{1}{3}$ shekels.
Thereof: 126 *kutānu*-textiles
cost 11 $\frac{1}{2}$ minas [3 shekels],
[of silver], 4 donkeys
cost 78 shekels (of silver),
7 $\frac{1}{2}$ shekels (of silver) for
half a donkey, 54 shekels of silver
the working capitals of 2 harnessers,
including their clothing allowance.
20 minas of tin at a rate of
13 shekels for (1 shekel of silver)
(cost) 92 shekels [of silver],
10[+x] shekels the harness of the
donkeys, [x]+ 1 $\frac{1}{4}$ shekels additions,
2 shekels for, 8 $\frac{1}{4}$ shekels the
export tax. Aššur-mūtappil is leading
this to you".

Notes

1-5. The second name in l. 2 is not clear and *ù*, normally written before the last writer, is missing. According to *8:27-31 this shipment was delivered to our first two addressees, Ali-ahum and Dadiya and comprised 17 minas 8 shekels.

6-9. Not adding the amount of silver to be paid in Assur as excise (text *8: 27f. only mentions that the *šaddu'utu*-fee has been paid) is unusual and in such cases its payment in Assur is specified, because it reduces the amount of silver freely available. The same happens in *37:5-6 and there, in our letter and in *39:7-8 and 11-12 it amounts to ca. 4% of the silver delivered.

13f. The restored figures match if the textiles cost 5 $\frac{1}{2}$ shekels apiece; the first signs of l. 13 are now (2012) missing.

23. The figure is rounded off, it should be 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ mina 2 $\frac{1}{3}$ shekels (of silver).

26. See for *sa'ad/tum* Veenhof *Lex*, s.v. The figure of the export tax (*wašītum*) at the rate of 1/120 of the value of the load, implies a value of 16 $\frac{1}{2}$ minas of silver, which is more than was actually available (l. 12), and the latter is also less than the total of the silver spent (ca. 16 minas 50 shekels) is also higher than what was available.

35. Kt 91/k 418 (1-271-91)

Letter to Elamma by two of his representatives in Assur about the use of silver that accrued to him from his participation in a caravan of his brother Ali-ahum and as yield of an investment in his brother's capital. He is informed about payments made and the

use of the remaining silver for a new caravan, which consists of four donkeys loaded with textiles and is on his way to him.

- | | |
|---|---|
| <p>1 <i>um-ma En-nam-A-šūr</i>
 <i>ù Da-dí-a-ma a-na E-lá-ma qí-bi-ma</i>
 <i>i-na 1 GÚ 5 ma-na KÙ.B.-pí-kà</i>
 <i>ša ILLAT-at A-lá-hi-im</i></p> <p>5 <i>i-li-kà-ni 10$\frac{1}{3}$ ma-na KÙ.B</i>
 <i>i-ri-ha-am 5$\frac{1}{3}$ ma-na KÙ.B</i>
 <i>[šl]-ip-kà-tí-kà iš-tí A-lá-hi-im</i></p> <p>[n]-il₅-qé ŠÀ.BA °1$\frac{1}{3}$? <i>ma-na 8 GÍN</i>
 <i>KÙ.B. Lá-qé-e[p il₅-q]é</i></p> <p>10 [1]$\frac{1}{2}$ <i>ma-na LÁ 1 GÍN té-šú-°bu₂</i>
 <i>ša 1 GÚ 5 ma-na KÙ.B.-p[i-kà]</i>
 <i>5/6 ma-na LÁ 2 GÍN A-šūr-i-mi-[l]</i>
 <i>il₅-qé 1/2 ma-na 5 GÍN KÙ.B.</i>
 <i>[A]-ta-a-a il₅-qé 6 GÍN KÙ.B.</i></p> <p>15 [šú-ha₂-ar-tum [al-qé a-na]
 l.e. [ší-tí K]Ù.B.-pí-kà [80[?]]*16 TÚG.HI.A
 <i>[a-na 8[?] m]a-na [ni-]š-a-ma-[kum]?</i>
 rev. [16$\frac{2}{3}$ m]a-na °AN.NA₂ qá-[im]
 <i>12$\frac{1}{2}$ GÍN.TA 1$\frac{1}{2}$ ma-na LÁ 2/GÍN</i></p> <p>20 KÙ.B. <i>it-ba-al</i>
 <i>[4] ANŠE ša-lá-mu 1 ma-na 15 GÍN</i>
 <i>KÙ.B. it-bu-lu 1/2 ma-na KÙ.B.</i>
 <i>bé-ú-lá-at A-šūr-lá-ma-sí</i>
 <i>[DU]MU En-um-a-a 2 GÍN lu-bu-šu</i></p> <p>25 [10[?]] GÍN KÙ.B. <i>ú-nu-ut ANŠE</i>
 <i>°i₂-na NÍG.KA-sí 15 GÍN</i>
 surplus of
 <i>[KÙ].B. i-té-ra-ma 2 GÍN KÙ.B</i>
 <i>[ú]-ku-ul-tí ANŠE ni-dí-in</i>
 <i>[ša[?]] 11 GÍN KÙ.B. 1/2 ma-na</i></p> <p>30 [AN.N]A <i>ni-iš-a-ma-kum</i>
 <i>[2[?]T]ÚG.HI.A bé-ú-lá-at A-šūr-lá-ma-/s</i>
 <i>[da]-ar-ku mi-ma a-nim</i>
 <i>°A-šūr₂-[lá-ma-sí na-áš]-a-kum</i>
 <i>2 ma-n[a x GÍN KÙ].B. ša A-ta-a</i>
 l.e. <i>il₅-qé-ú ip-qí-[id-ni-a-t[?]]</i>
 (1 or 2 lines missing)</p> | <p>Thus Ennam-Aššur and
 Dadiya, say to Elamma:
 “Of the 65 minas of your silver
 deriving from Ali-ahum’s caravan
 that arrived here 10$\frac{1}{3}$ minas
 remained. We received 5$\frac{1}{3}$ minas
 from what you invested with Ali-ahum.</p> <p>Thereof: 1$\frac{1}{3}$? mina 8 shekels
 Lā-qēp took;
 1 mina 29 shekels additional payment
 for your 65 minas of silver;
 48 shekels of silver Aššur-imittī
 took; 35 shekels of silver
 Ataya took; 6 shekels
 the girl took. [For the rest?] of
 your silver we bought [9]6[?] textiles
 [for x mi]nas (of silver);
 [x]minas of loose tin at
 12$\frac{1}{2}$: 1 cost 1 mina 28
 shekels of silver;
 [4] black donkeys cost 75 shekels
 of silver; 1/2 mina the working capital
 for Aššur-lamassī, son of Ennumāya,
 2 shekels his clothing allowance;
 [10] shekels of silver for donkey harness.
 When at the accounting there was a</p> <p>15 shekels of silver we paid 2 shekels
 of silver for food for the donkeys (and)
 [for] 11 shekels of silver we bought
 for you (an additional) 2$\frac{1}{2}$ minas of tin.
 Two textiles from Aššur-lamassī’s
 working capital are packed. With all this
 Aššur-lamassī is on his way to you.
 2 minas [x] shekels of silver that Atāya
 took he entrusted [to us[?]].”</p> |
|---|---|

Notes

The restoration of the missing or damaged figures (which take into account remaining traces and available room) is based on the fact that there were 15 $\frac{2}{3}$ minas of silver available (lines 5-6) and after the expenses of lines 8-15 enough remained to buy textiles for which 4 donkeys (this figure is required by their price of 75 shekels) were needed, which required harness, l. 25, which would have required ca. 10-12 shekels (see OACP 150f.). The figure of l. 18 is demanded by l. 19 and the figure for the “additions” in line 10 fits the space available, while a percentage of ca. 2,3% is

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acceptable (the same as the rate mentioned in *40:19-21). Assuming that the words [...] 16 TÚG.HI.A, preserved on a tiny fragment, belong to line 16, the damaged number of textiles bought probably was 96 (it begins with a Winkelhaken, hence less than 100), which would mean 24 pieces per donkey and at 5 shekels apiece they would have cost 8 minas of silver.

15. The “girl” probably was Elamma’s daughter Ummī-lšhara, an *ugbaltu*-priestess in Assur.

26-27. The extra amount probably was the result of a (final) settlement of the accounts of the caravan, as described in *OAI* 175f.

31. The “harnessers” frequently used part of their “working capital” (1/2 mina of silver in l. 23) to buy textiles in Assur, which they could sell with a profit in Anatolia.

Comments

The letter gives a good picture of what happened in Assur and how a trader acquired the silver needed to make purchases there. A large amount of silver derived from Elamma’s participation in a caravan (*ellutum*), described in *OAI* 168 as “groups formed on an ad hoc basis for the joint transport of merchandise in a caravan. The group consists of a ‘leader’ and of individuals known to him”. In our case the leader was Elamma’s brother, but Elamma also participated in caravans led by various other persons, as is clear from *5. That the silver available was what “remained” (l. 6) from a much bigger amount, could mean that for equipping an earlier caravan silver was borrowed (as was the case in *27:5f. and *41:5f.), which had to be repaid. A second source was Elamma’s investment in his brother’s joint-stock capital (also mentioned in *4), which here yielded 5 1/3 minas of silver, called “your dividends” (*šipkātum*), paid out by its manager, the tractator (see Larsen 1977:137); the can be said to “accrue to” (*kašādum*) somebody.

36. Kt 91/k 419 (1-271-91)

A letter about the arrival of 20 minas of silver, used for buying and loading two donkeys, one with tin, the other with textiles, which Šu-Kūbum will lead to Elamma.

	<i>um-ma En-um-A-šur-ma Da-/dī-a</i>	Thus Ennam-Aššur, Dadiya
	<i>ù Hi-na-a-ma a-na</i>	and Hinnāya, say to
	<i>E-la-ma qí-bi-ma</i>	Elamma:
	<i>20 ma-na KÙ.B ni-is-ha-sú</i>	“20 minas of silver, its excise
5	<i>DIRI Ir-ma-A-šūr ub-lam</i>	added, Ir’am-Aššur delivered.
	<i>2 GÚ 10 ma-n[a A]N.NA</i>	2 talents 10 minas of tin under
	<i>ku-nu-ki-ni [Šu-Ku-b]u-um</i>	our seals [Šu-Kūb]um
	<i>na-áš-a-k[u-um 14] 1/3 GÍN.TA</i>	is bringing to you. At 14 1/3 shekels : 1
	<i>KÙ.BI₄ 9[ma-na] 4 1/6 GÍN</i>	it cost 9 minas 4 1/6 shekels of silver.
10	<i>it-ba-al 15 ma-na AN.NA</i>	15 minas of tin for expenses,
	<i>qá-tim 14 1/4 GÍN.TA</i>	at 14 1/4 shekels : 1 it cost
	<i>KÙ.BI₄ 1 ma-na 3 GÍN KÙ.B</i>	1 mina 3 shekels of silver.
	<i>it-ba-al 36 TÚG.HI.A</i>	36 textiles,
l.e.	<i>qá-dum : ša li-wi-/tim</i>	including those for wrapping
15	<i>2 1/3 ma-na KÙ.B</i>	cost 2 1/3 minas of silver.
rev.	<i>it-bu-lu 1/3 ma-na 2 / GÍN</i>	22 shekels (of silver)
	<i>be-ú-la-at</i>	the working capital of

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	<i>Ša-lim-A-šūr</i>	Šallim-Aššur,
	<i>kà-ša-ri-im</i>	the harnessor, 2 shekels
20	2 GÍN KÙ.B. 1 <i>lu-bu-šu</i>	of silver one garment for him.
	2 ANŠE.HI.A	Two black donkeys
	<i>ša-lá-ma-an</i> $\frac{2}{3}$ <i>ma-na</i> LÁ 2 GÍN	cost 38 shekels
	KÙ.B. <i>it-bu-lu</i>	of silver.
	3 TÚG.HI.A <i>ša kà-ša-ri-im</i>	3 textiles of the harnessor,
25	4½ GÍN KÙ.B. : <i>ú-nu-ut</i> ANŠE	4½ shekels of silver donkey harness.
	<i>mī-ma a-nim Šu-Ku-bu-um</i>	All this Šu-Kūbum
	<i>na-áš-a-kum : i-na</i>	is bringing you. Later
	<i>wa-ar-ki-ú-tim : nu-za-kà-/ma</i>	we will clear accounts and then
29	<i>lu-qú-ut-kà : iš-tí</i>	send your merchandise
u.e.	<< <i>iš-tí</i> >> : <i>pá-ni-im-ma</i>	to you with the next
	<i>nu-šé-ba-la₁-kum</i>	opportunity.”

Notes

Note that the scribe always uses LA₁ and note BE=BI₄ instead of normal BI in the Sumerian expression KÙ.BABBAR.BI, “its silver”

6-14. The two donkeys were heavily loaded, carrying 145 pounds of tin and 36 textiles.

17. This payment probably was contemporaneous with, but not related to the shipment described, which was transported by Šu-Kūbum.

27-31. Since only ca. 13½ of the 20 minas of silver delivered were used and no export tax is mentioned, a final “clearing” (*zakku’um*) still had to take place. The writers may have had to settle certain accounts before being able to spend the remaining silver for buying more merchandise, which probably would be sent with a next caravan.

37. Kt 91/k 484 (1-337-91)

A letter by Elamma’s representatives in Assur on the arrival of silver and gold with a total value, after some deductions and payments and the conversion of the gold into silver, of 26 minas 9 shekels of silver. It then reports how this sum was used to buy merchandise and to equip a caravan of five donkeys loaded with 5 talents of tin and 69 textiles, accompanied by two harnessers. The silver and gold mention here as having arrived in Assur if the same same shipment that, according to *20 was sent by Elamma, from somewhere in Anatolia, to Lā-qēp in Kanesh, with the request to send it to Assur.

	<i>[um-ma] A-la-hu-um</i>	[Thus] Ali-ahum,
	<i>[A-šūr]-re-ší En-nam-A-šūr</i>	[Aššur]-rēšī, Ennam-Aššur,
	<i>[ú D]a-dí-a-ma a-na E-la-ma</i>	[and] Dadiya say to Elamma:
	<i>[qí-b]i₄-ma 24½ ma-na 4[?] GÍN KÙ.B.</i>	“24 minas 24 [?] shekels of silver,
5	<i>[ŠÀ] 1 ma-na 1 GÍN KÙ.B. ni-is-ha-tim</i>	[thereof] we gave 61 shekels of silver
	<i>[nī]-dī-in : ší-tí KÙ.B.-pí-kà</i>	as excise; the rest of your silver is
	<i>23¹ ½ ma-na 4 GÍN</i>	23 ¹ minas and 24 shekels.
	<i>1/2 ma-na 3 GÍN GUŠKIN A-šūr-DÙG</i>	33 shekels of gold Aššur-ṭāb brought
	<i>ub-lam ŠÀ 1½ GÍN ½ ŠE</i>	us, thereof we gave as excise
10	<i>ni-is-ha-tim ni-dī-in</i>	1 3/8 shekel. It was
	<i>½ GÍN i-na sà-na-qí-ni</i>	½ shekel less when we checked it, (so)

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	l[m]-tí ší-ti GUŠKIN ½ ma-na 1⅓ GÍN	the rest of the gold is 31⅓ shekels,
	5¼ GÍN.TA KÙ.B.-áp-šu	its equivalent in silver at 1: 5¼ is
	2⅔ ma-na 5 GÍN ŠUNIGIN ₂ KÙ.B.-áp-kà	2¾ minas. Total of your silver,
15	ù ší-im GUŠKIN	including the yield of the gold:
	26 ma-na 9 GÍN KÙ.B.	26 minas 9 shekels of silver.
	4 GÚ 20 ma-na 8 GÍN AN.[NA]	4 talents 20 minas 8 shekels of tin
	ku-nu-ku 30 ma-na [AN.NA]-lak	under seals, 30 minas hand tin,
l.e.	qá-tim 17¼ G[ÍN.TA]	at 17¼ : 1 shekel
20	KÙ.B.-áp-šu	its (price in) silver,
	16⅔ ma-[na 9 GÍN]	16 minas 4[9 shekels];
rev.	36 TÚG ku-ta-n[u 5 5/6 GÍN.TA]	36 kutānu-textiles, [at 5 5/6 shekels
	apiece],	
	3½ ma-na KÙ.B.-šu-nu	their (price in) silver: 3½ minas;
	33 šu-ru-tum qá-dé ša li-w[ī]-tim	33 dark textiles including those for
25	1⅔ ma-na 4 GÍN KÙ.B.-áp-šu-nu	wrapping, their silver 1 mina 44 shekels.
	1 ma-na LÁ 5 GÍN i-ma-sà-im	The silver became 55 shekels less by
	im-tí 5 ANŠE.HI.A ša-lá-mu-ú	washing. 5 black donkeys
	1 ma-na 17 GÍN : it-bu-lu	cost 1 mina 17 shekels;
	1 ANŠE im-ra-aš-ma wa-at-ra-am	1 donkey became ill and we bought
30	ni-iš-a-ma i-lá-kà-kum	an extra one and it is coming to you.
	1 ma-na bé-ú-lá-at Ú-zu-a	1 mina, the working capitals of Uzua
	ù Šu-mi-a-bi-a 4 GÍN KÙ.B. lu-bu-šu-nu	and Šumi-abiya, 4 shekels their
	clothing,	
	12 GÍN tē-šú-bi a-na A-šūr-DÙG	12 shekels additional payment to
	né-pu-ul 3 GÍN ša sà-e-d/tim	Aššur-ṭāb, 3 shekels for,
35	9 GÍN ú-nu-ut ANŠE.HI.A	9 shekels donkey harness,
	12½ GÍN wa-ší-tum	12½ shekels export tax,
	14 GÍN ú-ku-ul-tí ANŠE.HI.A	14 shekels donkey fodder."

Notes

6. See on the paying of *nishatum* in Assur the note on text *34:6-9.

8. In letter *20 Elamma instructs Lā-qēp to send the silver and gold to Assur with an "affiliated trader" (*mer'a ummiānim*) and our letter shows that Aššur-ṭāb was such a man. If he was not identical to Aššur-ṭāb, son of Aššur- karwa, who brought the silver and gold in *21 to Elamma, he might be the son of Elamma's brother Ali-ahum.

8-15. The unusual words "the price of the gold" (l. 5) confirm that it was not used to buy merchandise, but was somehow sold for or converted into silver in Assur. Its price, 5 ¼ shekels of silver for 1 shekel of gold, is extremely low. The amount proved to be 1/100 less than recorded and the excise claimed exactly 1/24 or ca. 4% of it, as did the excise on silver, see the reference in the note on l. 6.

19-20. The tin was extremely cheap, presumably due to an abundant supply.

Comment

The figure for the amount of tin in l. 17 is unusually detailed (and odd), other figures do not match exactly or are rounded off. In line 7 we have to read 23 in stead of 22 minas on the basis of the figures of lines 4 and 16. The export tax (*wašitum*; 1/120 of the value of the caravan) apparently starts from a value of 25 minas of silver, which must be the 26 minas 9 shekels of l. 16 minus the loss of 55 shekels mentioned in l. 26f. Expenses plus the loss (lines 17ff.) add up to 26 minas 9½ shekels, which matches the capital available according to line 16 almost exactly. Other letters in such a case would

write “all your silver has been spent” (*kasapka gamrakkum*). The low rate at which gold is converted into silver, the low price of the donkeys (at 15 2/5 shekels apiece) and of the tin (17¼ shekels for 1 shekel of silver) point to a temporary low in the market. The loss of ca. 4% due to refining the silver (line 26f.) is high (Veenhof 1972: 46f.). The amount of “loose tin”, 30 minas, fits the value of the load, e.g. nearly 5 talents of tin (with 8 textiles for wrapping) and 61 textiles, which required 4 donkeys (the additional one, bought because one got ill, is included in the 5 mentioned in line 27) and two transporters, Uzua and Šumi-abiya, who are mentioned with their interest-free working capital in lines 31f.

38. Kt 91/k 532 (1-385-91)

Letter by Elamma’s representatives in Assur on the arrival of two shipments of in all 40 1/3 minas of silver. After an earlier loan of 30 minas by Elamma’s brother Ali-ahum has been paid back, 8⅔ minas are spent on the purchase of three donkey-loads of textiles, shipped back by Aššur-nādā, who had just delivered one of the shipments of silver. The letter is an answer to letter *16, addressed to the wilters of our letter, in which Elamma asks them to do what they now report to have carried out. They must have done so fairly quickly, considering Elamma’s urgent request (lines 20-23) to let the *kutānu*-textiles he orders arrive in Kanesh before the winter(?).

1	<i>um-ma A-la-hu-um-ma A-šur-re-ší</i> <i>En-nam-A-šur ú Da-dí-a</i> <i>a-na E-lá-ma qí-bí₄-ma</i> 24 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>Dan-A-šur</i>	Thus Ali-ahum, Aššur-rēšī, Ennam-Aššur and Dadiya, say to Elamma: “24 minas of silver Dān-Aššur, son of Šalim-ahum, has brought us.
5	DUMU <i>Ša-lim-a-hi-im ub-lam</i> 16⅔ <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>A-šur-na-da</i> DUMU <i>A-šur-i-dí ub-lam</i> ŠUNIGIN ₂ 40⅓ <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. ŠÀ.BA 30 <i>ma-na iš-tí</i>	16⅔ minas of silver Aššur-nādā, son of Aššur-idī, has brought us. In all 40⅓ minas of silver. Thereof (we paid) 30 minas we had borrowed from Ali-ahum and
10	<i>A-lá-hi-im ni-il₅-qé-ma</i> 1⅔ <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>ší-ib-tám</i> <i>nu-ší-ib: ší-tí</i> KÙ.B. <i>-pí-kà</i> 8⅔ <i>ma-na</i> 76 TÚG <i>k[u-ta-n]u</i>	we added to it 1⅔ mina of silver as interest. There remains of your silver 8⅔ minas. 76 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles cost
15	6 <i>ma-na</i> [40 [?] GÍN] KÙ.B. <i>it-b[u-lu 3] ANŠE</i>	6 minas [40 [?] shekels] of silver, 3 black donkeys
l.e.	<i>ša-lá-[mu ⅔ ma-na y GÍN]</i> KÙ.B. <i>[t-bu-lu]</i>	cost [40+x shekels] of silver.
rev.	15 <i>ma-na</i> [AN.NA <i>qá-tim</i>]	15 minas of [tin for expenses]
20	13 GÍN.T[A KÙ.B.] <i>-áp-šu</i> 1 <i>ma-na</i> 9 [GÍN] <i>ú-nu-ut A[NŠE.H]I.A <ù></i> <i>na-<nu>-ru-°qá₂-tim</i> 9½ GÍN KÙ.B. <i>it-bu-lu: 3⅔ GÍN</i> KÙ.B.	at 13 shekels :1, its price in silver 1 mina 9 shekels. The harness of the donkeys <and> the (leather) bags cost
25	<i>té-šú-bé [nu]-ší-ib</i> 4⅓ GÍN <i>wa-ší-tum</i> 2 GÍN <i>Be-lúm-ba-ni il₅-qé</i> 4 <i>ku(TÚG)-ta-nu ša A-bu-ša-lim</i>	9½ shekels of silver. 3⅔ shekels of silver we added as additions, 4⅓ shekels the export tax; 2 shekels Bēlum-bāni took. 4 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles of Abu-šalim,

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	1 TÚG <i>ša A-šur-re-ší</i>	1 textile of Aššur-rēšī,
30	1 TÚG <i>ša Da-dí-a</i>	1 textile of Dadiya,
	1 TÚG <i>ša Be-lúm-ba-ni</i>	1 textile of Bēlum-bāni.
u.e.	<i>mi-ma a-nim</i>	All this
	<i>A-šur-na-da</i>	Aššur-nādā
34	<i>i-ra-dí-a-kum</i>	leads to you. Make Bēlum-bāni
le.e.	KÙ.B. <i>Be-lúm-ba-ni a-ma-kam</i>	pay the silver over there."
	<i>ša-dí-in</i>	

Notes

4. The same figure in *18:5.

8. The total in l. 8, 40⅓ minas, suggests considering 16⅔ in l. 5 a mistake, but this same figure is mentioned as transported by Aššur-nādā in *16:5, so that the figure of l. 8 might be a mistake, but damage of the list of expenses does not allow to choose.

9-12. At the usual rate of interest of 30% per year the loan of 30 minas would have been for nine weeks, but it is likely that the creditor, Elamma's brother, had charged less. See for this loan contracted with Elamma's brother the note on *16:9-13, a letter in which Elamma announces the arrival of the silver with Aššur-nādā and asks his addressees to do what they have carried out according to the present letter.

15. I restore [40 GÍN], which yields a price of ca. 5¼ shekels apiece, because the export tax of 4 1/3 shekels of silver implies a total value of the caravan of 8 minas 40 shekels of silver.

16. The number of three donkeys is derived from the number of textiles; they may have cost, without the harness mentioned in lines 22-24, 17 or 18 shekels of silver apiece.

19f. These lines must mention the "hand tin" given to the transporter and 15 minas at a rate of 13 shekels to 1 would make 1 mina 9 3/13 shekels of silver, which was rounded off.

23. The first sign is a broad NA, also used in line 6, rather than *maš-ki*. The mistaken NU was not erased, but followed by the correct RU. Leather bags were used for packing textiles.

27-28. Bēlum-bāni was a freighter (*kaššārum*) who had received a *be'ulātu*-loan, mentioned in *18:18. The single textile of his probably was bought with this money and in addition he had borrowed a few shekels, which he has to pay back in Kanesh (lines 35f.). See for Abu-šalim the note on *18:19-26.

29f. Two of Elamma's representatives in Assur also gave each one textile along with the caravan, to be sold for them by Elamma. Some caravan documents mention that small amounts of silver were sent back to them, apparently the yield of their sale (see the note on *10:29-33).

39. Kt 92/k 142 (1-102-92)

Letter to Elamma by his representatives in Assur on the arrival there of three shipments of silver, of which eventually a little more than 20 minas were available for making purchases, which made up two donkey loads, consisting of 4 talents 40 minas of tin and 10 *kutānu*-textiles. The donkeys were lead to Anatolia by Dān-Aššur, who also delivered the silver.

um-ma I-li-a-ma*

Thus Iliya,

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- A-šur-re-ší En-nam-A-šur* Aššur-rēšī, Ennam-Aššur,
ù Da-dí-a a-na E-lá-ma and Dadiya, say to Elamma:
qí-bi₄-ma 4 1/3 ma-na 2 1/2 GÍN KÙ.B. "4 1/3 mina 2 1/2 shekels of silver.
5 *Dan-A-šur ub-lam 4 1/3 GÍN ša-du-a-/tám* Dān-Aššur brought. We gave 4 1/3 shekels
a-na Dan-A-šur ni-dí-in 1 1/3 GÍN té-š[ú-be] as transport fee to Dān-Aššur, paid
1 1/3
né-pu-ul 11 GÍN a-na ni-is-h[a-tim] shekel as addition and 11 gave as excise
ni-dí-in ší-tí KÙ.B.-pì-kà so that of your silver there remain 4 minas
4 ma-na 6 LÁ 1/6² GÍN 17 m[a-na]/ °4₂ 5 5/6² shekels. 17 minas and 4 shekels
- 10 *KÙ.B. A-ni-nu-um ub-lam [GÍN* of silver Aninum brought here.
ŠÀ.BA 2/3 ma-na 2 1/2 GÍN a-na Thereof we paid 42 1/2 shekels as
ni-is-ha-tim ni-dí-in excise. There remain of
ší-tí KÙ.B.-pì-kà 16 1/3 ma-na LÁ 1/2 GÍN your silver 16 minas 19 1/2 shekels.
ŠUNIGIN₂ KÙ.B.-pì-kà 20 1/3 ma-na The total of your silver amounts to 20
[5 1/3 / GÍN [minas 25 1/3 shekels.
15 *4 GÚ 20 ma-na AN.NA ku/-nu-ku* 4 talents 20 mina of tin under seals,
15 1/3 GÍN 15 ŠE.TA at a rate of 15 5/12 shekels : 1
i.e. *KÙ.B.-áp-šu 17 5/6 ma-na / 2 GÍN* the silver for it was 17 minas 52 shekels.
rev. *20 ma-na AN.NA-ak qá-/tim* 20 minas tin for expenses, at a rate
15 GÍN.TA 1 1/3 ma-na KÙ.B. of 15 shekels : 1 makes 1 1/3 mina of silver.
20 *10 ku-ta-nu 2/3 ma-na 6 1/2 GÍN* 10 *kutānu*-textiles cost 46 1/2
it-bu-lu shekels (of silver);
8 šu-ru-tum ša li-wi-tim 8 dark textiles for wrapping, their
1/3 ma-na 8 GÍN KÙ.B.-šu-nu price in silver 28 shekels;
2 ANŠE.HI.A ša-lá-mu 2/3 ma-na / 2 black donkeys cost 40 [minus x]
[LÁ x] GÍN [shekels of silver.
25 *KÙ.B.-šu-nu 1/3 mana *7² GÍ[N KÙ.B.]* 27² shekels of silver loss due to
i-ma-sá-im im-ťí 1/2 [ma-na KÙ.B.] washing; 1/2 [mina of silver], the
be-ú-lá-at Ma-ši-°i-lí] working capital of Maši-ilī;
2 GÍN lu-bu-šu 1 GÍ[N KÙ.B.] 2 shekels his clothing allowance; 1 shekel
ša sà-e-d/tim 10 GÍN 20[+2 1/2 ŠE] the cost of ; 10 1/8 shekels
30 *wa-ší-tum 3 GÍN KÙ.B. i-na* the export tax; when checking 3 shekels
of
sà-na-qí-im : im-ťí 3 1/2 GÍN silver proved to be missing; 3 1/2 shekels
ú-nu-ut ANŠE.HI.A 1 GÍN the harness of the donkeys; 1 shekel
ú-kúl-ťí ANŠE.HI.A fodder for the donkeys.
u.e. *a-na mu-lá ANŠE.HI.A* To complete (the load of) the donkeys
35 *1 ma-na LÁ 1 1/6 GÍN KÙ.B.* we added 58 5/6 shekels of silver
le.e. *i-na ša ú-ťí-tim : nu-ra-dí mī-ma a-nim* from that of the barley. All this
Dan-A-šur ir-dí-a-ku-um Dān-Aššur has led to you."

Notes

1. A is written over an erased MA

5-6. These lines show that *šaddu'utum*, at a rate of 1/60 of the value of the shipment, was a fee paid to the transporter. This is also clear from CCT 1, 16a:3-12, where for 2 transporters we read *šaddu'assu ša-bu-ú-ú*, "they are satisfied with the š.-fee on it". A transporter occasionally received an "additional payment" (*tēšubū*), presumably for

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expenses made en route, specified in *40:18-21 per mina of silver delivered and in *350:2 per talent.

24. Considering the normal price of a donkey, without its harness (l. 32), the end of the line must have read “[minus x] shekels”, with x ranging from 2 to 4.

24-26. *Mulā’um* is what is needed to complement something, in this case presumably silver needed to pay merchandise to complete the donkey loads. The damaged number in l. 25 could perhaps also be 8.

29. *sa’ad/tum*, meaning unknown, see Veenhof *Lex*, s.v.

36. “Silver of the barley”, either what its sale (in Assur) yielded or what was originally meant for bying barley.

37. *Irde*, from the point of view of the writers: he has started his journey, just like letters from Kanesh use *ūbil* to state that the transporter with the silver has left.

Comment

The load, 260 minas of tin, 8 textiles for wrapping and 10 *kutānū*, is fairly big for two donkeys. The total amount of silver available after some deductions is 20 minas 25 1/3 shekels (l. 14), or 19 minas 56 2/3 shekel(if we also deduct the loss due to washing and checking mentioned in lines 25f., 30f.) The amounts paid according to lines 15-25, are a 21 minas 4 1/2 shekels and to that we have to add the payments made in lines 26-33, amounting to 50 1/2 shekels. I assume that the statement of lines 34-36, that 58 5/6 shekels of silver were added to “complement the donkeys”, means that this silver was needed to pay for all the expenses. This additional silver was derived from the sale of barley, which is not surprising since merchants had large quantities of it in stock, which could be considered cash (cf. *2:27f.). The export tax of 1/120 on 21 minas and 4 shekels should be a little more than 10 1/2 shekels and at the end of l. 29 one reads 10 shekels 20 [+x ŠE].

40. Kt 92/k 143 (1-103-92)

The letter from Assur reports the arrival of 30 minas of silver, delivered by Aššur-rē’ī, and the use of ca. 18 minas of it to buy 2 talents 35 minas of tin, 85 textiles and 4 donkeys, which are lead back to Anatolia by the same Aššur-rē’ī. The remainder of the silver, minus 1 mina (lines 17-24), will be used for a next caravan (lines 30-32).

	<i>um-ma En-nam-A-šur-ma</i>	Thus Ennam-Aššur and Dadiya,
	<i>ù Da-dí-a-ma a-na E-lá-ma</i>	say to Elamma:
	<i>qí-bi₄-ma 30 ma-na KÙ.B.</i>	“30 minas of silver that
	<i>ša^d A-šur-SIPAD ub-lá-ni</i>	Aššur-rē’ī brought here,
5	<i>ni-is-ha-sú DIRIG</i>	its excise added. (Thereof):
	<i>2 GÚ 10 ma-na AN.NA ku-nu-ki</i>	2 talents 10 minas of tin under seals
	<i>25 ma-na AN.NA qá-tim</i>	(and) 25 minas of tin for expenses
	<i>14 1/4 GÍN.TA 10 5/6 ma-na / 3 GÍN</i>	at 14 1/4 shekels to 1 cost 10 minas and
	<i>KÙ.B. it-ba-al</i>	53 shekels of silver.
10	<i>85 TÚG.HI.A 5 5/6 ma-na</i>	85 textiles cost 5 minas
	<i>ù 7 GÍN KÙ.B.</i>	and 57 shekels of silver.
	<i>it-bu-lu 4 ANŠE</i>	4 black donkeys
	<i>ša-la-mu 1 ma-na 13 GÍN</i>	cost 1 mina and
14	<i>KÙ.B. it-bu-lu</i>	13 shekels of silver,
l.e.	<i>1 1/3 GÍN KÙ.B. ú-nu-ut</i>	1 1/3 shekel of silver the harness of a (per?)
rev.	<i>ANŠE 9 GÍN KÙ.B. wa-ší-/tám</i>	donkey, 9 shekels of silver export tax,

	3 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>ša sá-e-d/tim</i>	3 shekels of silver for
	30 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>ša A-šur-PA-/LU</i>	The 30 minas of silver that Aššur-rē'ī
	<i>ub-lá-ni</i> 1½ GÍN ù / 3 ŠE.TA	brought entailed additions of
20	<i>té-šú-bu</i> ⅔ <i>ma-na</i> ½ GÍN	1 shekel 63 grains per (mina, so that)
	KÙ.B. <i>ni-dí-in</i>	we paid 40½ shekels of silver.
	⅓ <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>be-ú-lá-at</i>	20 shekels of silver the working capital
	<i>Kur-ub-lštar</i> 2 GÍN KÙ.B.	of Kurub-lštar, 2 shekels his clothing
	<i>lu-bu-šu</i> 3 TÚG.HI.A	allowance; 3 textiles
25	<i>ša Kur-ub-lštar</i>	of Kurub-lštar,
	1 TÚG <i>ša Da-dí-a</i>	1 textile of Dadiya,
	1 TÚG <i>ša En-nam-A-šur</i>	1 textile of Ennam-Aššur.
	<i>mì-ma a-nim A-šur-SIPAD</i>	All this Aššur-rē'ī
	<i>na-áš-a-ku-um</i>	is bringing to you.
30	<i>ší-tí</i> KÙ.B. <i>iš-tí</i>	(What we will buy with) the rest
u.e.	<i>wa-ar-ki-ú-tim</i>	of the silver we will send you
le.e.	<i>nu-šé-ba-lá-kum</i>	with a later caravan."

Notes

6. The letter reports immediately about the purchases made, without introducing them by ŠÀ.BA, "thereof" and the mention of the purchase (*niš'am*).

16. Of the silver brought 18 minas 4 shekels were spent on purchases and the amount of the export tax is exactly 1/120 of that amount.

18. SIPAD is broken up into its two components, with the second element on the next line.

18-21. Here the tariff or rate of the still rather mysterious "additions" (*tēšubū*) is for the first time specified: "1 shekel and 63 grains", apparently per mina of silver, which means 2,3%, the same rate I assumed for *35:10. The remarkably detailed figure of "243 grains per mina" shows that it was the result of accounting. In *350 the rate of the "additions" was specified per talent (of silver or of the "declared value" of the shipment?).

25-27. The 3 textiles of Kurub-lštar must be those bought with his working capital. See for the textiles of Elamma's representatives the note on *10:29-33.

41. Kt 91/k 487 (1-340-91)

A letter on a large tablet (9.4 x 5.8 cm) from eponymy year 90 (lines 32ff.), with the names of the addressees missing through damage. Not a "caravan account", but inserted here because it was sent from Assur and deals with the use of a large shipment of silver which had arrived there to pay a substantial debt contracted there. The names of only two of the presumably four writers, Pūšu-kēn and probably Aššur-r[ēšī] (perhaps one of Elamma's representatives in Assur) are preserved. Since they had informed the unknown addressees about a debt of and a payment by Elamma (lines 14-19), it seems unlikely he was one of the two addressees, but how and why this letter ended up in his archive is unclear.

a-na [x x x u x x x]

qí-bi₄-m[*a um-ma* x x x x]

Pu-šu-ki-[*in* x x x x]

ù *A-šur-r*[*e-ší-ma*²]

To [..... and]

say, thus [.....]

Pūšu-kēn, [.....],

and Aššur- r[ēšī?]:

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5	51 ma-na KÙ.B. [B. ša É DAM.GÀR]	"On the 51 minas of silver that we borrowed
	ni-il ₅ -qé-a-ku-n[u-tí-ni 4 ma-na]	for you with a money-lender, the interest
has	15 GÍN KÙ.B. š[í-]b-tum	amounted to 4 minas and 15 shekels of
	i-li-ik ŠUNIGIN ₂ 55 ma-na 15 / GÍN	silver. Total: 55 minas 15 shekels,
	qá-dum ší-ib-ti-šu 46½ ma-na	including its interest. Abu-šalim has
10	KÙ.B. A-bu-ša-lim ub-lam	brought 4 ½ minas of silver,
	12 GÍN i-na i-ší-ra-tim	it became 12 shekels less by / than the
	im-ťí 18 GÍN a-ma-sú-hu-tim	išerātum, 18 shekels we deducted for
	ni-ik-bu-ús 46 ma-na KÙ.B.	dirty, so that 46 minas of silver
	iz-ku-am ta-áš-pu-ra-nim	became available. You wrote us
15	um-ma a-tù-nu-ma 4 ma-na	as follows: 'Elamma has a debt
	KÙ.B. E-lá-ma ha-bu-ul	of 4 minas of silver'. He retained
	3 ma-na KÙ.B. ša ha-bu-lá-tù-/nu-ni	in his possession 3 minas
l.e.	i-li-bi ₄ -šu ik-lá	of silver that you owe (him and)
	° 1 ₂ ma-na KÙ.B. iš-qú-ul	therefore he paid 1 mina of silver.
rev.	i-té-er-tí-ku-nu um-ma	In your instruction you write:
21	a-tù-nu-ma 4 ma-na KÙ.B.	'Let Karwaya pay
	Kâr-wa-a li-iš-qú-ul	4 minas of silver' -
	3 ma-na iš-qú-ul 1 ma-na	he paid 3 minas; 1 mina
	l-dí-a-bu-um iš-qú-ul	Iddin-abum paid.
25	1 ma-na A-šur-iš-ta-kál	Aššuriš-tikal refused to
	ša-qá-lam lá i-mu-a	pay 1 mina of silver. Since your own
	4 ma-na 15 GÍN KÙ.B. -ku-/nu	silver is 4 minas 15 shekels short, we
	ba-ti-iq É né-ru-ub-ma	entered (a money-lender's) house (to bor-
	4 ma-na 15 GÍN-ku-nu	row it) and your 4 minas 15 shekels,
30	a-na 5 ma-na 10½ GÍN KÙ.B.	together with the interest on it
	qá-dum ší-ib-tí-šu i-tù-/ar	have now become 5 minas 10½ shekels,
	iš-tù ha-muš-tim ša MAR.TU-/ba-ni	reckoning from the week eponymy of
	ù A-š[ur-n]a-°da ₂ ITI.KAM	Amurru-bāni and Aššur-nādā,
	a-lá-°na-t ₂ [im ū ² * t ₂ p-pi-ni	in month XII. And ² our tablet of
35	š[a 51 ma- n]a KÙ.B. ú ší-ba-/ti-šu	[51 min]as of silver plus interest on it
	t ₂ [p-pi-ni-ma] 5[m]a-na 10½ GÍN	remains our tablet. Send the 5 minas 10½
	KÙ.B. [ú ší-ba]-sú	shekels of silver plus interest on it,
	šé-bi ₄ -[lá-nim ū ₂ t ₂ p-pi-ni	so that our tablet
u.e.	li-°m ₂ [u-ut x x x x]	can be cancelled?]
40	°x x ₂ * [x x x x x x]	[.....]
le.e	a-ba-ú-ni a-hu-ni a-tù-nu ih-da-ma	Please, our fathers and brothers, take care
to	KÙ.B. šé-bi ₄ -lá-nim ú KÙ.B. lá i-ma-	send the silver and let the silver not get
	ú t ₂ p-pi-ni lá ú-kà-lu [i-/l]d	much and let them not retain our tablet!"

Notes

5-8. At the normal rate of interest the debt would have been contracted more than three months ago..

11-12. *Išertum*, usually in the plural, is probably derived from *išarum*, "correct, right", cf. *AHw* 394b, "normale Menge"(?), accepted by Larsen 1967, 118. *CAD* E and I/J do not know the word, but *CAD* M/1, 429, s.v. *maṭṭu*, 1, 2', translates 5 GÍN *ina išerātum imṭi* in TC 2,

14:23 by ‘5 shekels were missing from the “normal amounts”. This translation takes *ina* as partitive, but *ina* could also be instrumental, which would make *išerātum* refer to a specific procedure or treatment of the metal, for which I suggested long ago (AOAT note 88) the normalizing and finishing of the cast silver, which would entail some loss of weight. A third possibility is to take *maṭā’um ina* as “being less than, fall short of”, just like its opposite, *watārum ina*, can mean “be in excess of, more than”.⁴ “Being less than the normal amounts” could mean that the weight of the purified silver fell short of what it should be or of the weight mentioned in the accompanying letter. The opposite is the case in AKT 6, 4:13f., where a shipment of tin transported to Anatolia “proved to be 2 1/3 minas in excess of the *iširātum* of the City Hall”. This suggests that the exact weight of the tin was assessed in the City Hall by means of its weights and Dercksen, OAI 17, even suggests that the tin was melted there and cast into ingots of standard size and weight, which might be the meaning of *išerātum*. Nevertheless, I have my doubts about a meaning “normal weight/quantity”, since loss of weight *ina išerātum* is similar to and mentioned alongside losses *ina ša’udim*, “by melting” and *ina masā’im*, by washing”, where *ina* + infinitive is certainly instrumental. See now my analysis of the terminology and procedures in Veenhof 2014a.

12-13. A second reason for loss of weight is *kabāsum ana massuhūtum*. *Kabāsum* means “to reduce, to deduct”, not as the physical result of a metallurgical treatment, but as an administrative measure: the loss of weight is accepted and written off in the accounts. The abstract noun *massuhuttum*, “dirtiness, bad quality”, is derived from the adjective *massuhum*, frequently used of metals, cf. Kt n/k 492:25-29 (courtesy of Günbatti): “We checked the silver under your seal and we deducted 2 shekels each (mina?) for/as refining” (l. 29, 2 GÍN.TA *ana ša-ra-pu-tim nikbus*). In both cases *ana* + abstract does not refer to a particular treatment, but to its effects, which can be quantified, “loss of volume as (result of the) refining”. In CCT 3, 41a:3f. *šarrupūtum* is quantified at 1 mina 6 shekels of silver. See also Veenhof 2014a.

14-19. I assume that the quote from the letter the writers had received ended with line 16 and that the next lines report on Elamma’s reaction. But how could the 1 mina he paid be used to pay the debt in Assur if Elamma was Anatolia? Did he give them permission to take it from his assets in Assur?

28. I take É *nērubma* as short for *ana bēt tamkārim nērubma kaspam ana šibtim nilqe*; see for examples Veenhof 1999: 66f. and *27:5f.

29. The *-um* added to GÍN is common as locative ending, to express the rate of interest, “per shekel”, but here, with the amount of silver as subject of *ittuar*, it should be the nominative ending, which is strange since it is added to 15 GÍN.

32-34. A pair of week eponyms attested during the same month in eponymy year REL 91, in ICK 1, 104:8 and ICK 2, 11A:4 // B:8, but there is no room to insert the name of the eponym in line 34. Larsen observes that it is remarkable to find a loan contracted in Assur dated by *hamuštu*-eponyms, which are a typical “colonial feature”; it suggests that the people in Assur were informed about the succession of week eponyms.

41-43. The end of the letter phrases the well-known concern to prevent the interest from increasing and to get the original debt-note back.

Comment

Of the original debt of 51 minas of silver, plus its accumulated interests (plural) - 4 minas 15 shekels (at the normal rate of interest this means a period of ca. 3 1/3

⁴ See for the construction *watārum ina*, “to be in excess of”, “more than”, TC 14, 11:12, if a house *ina šalāš (šubātum) ītir*, “it(s) surface) is more than 3 *šubtum*”.

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months) - after the payment of the 46 minas delivered by Abu-šalim and the collection of some outstanding debts (apparently owed to the addressees; lines 19-24) 4 1/4 minas remained (l. 27). With the interest due (apparently for 9 months) this has now become 5 minas 10 1/2 shekels. The mention of interest, together with the wish to obtain the release of their debt-note (line 43), implies that this amount was again borrowed, presumably from the same money-lender, and that he drew up a dated, new debt-note for this amount, after which the debtors would have got back their original debt-note for 51 minas of silver. My interpretation of the damaged lines 34-40 is tentative. The writers seem to say that for the time being the original debt-note remains in their possession. But when they receive the amount due to them – the new loan plus its interest – it will be cancelled (by them; *limūt*). What they add in l. 40 is lost.

2. Accounts and memorandums about caravans inside Anatolia

I present here a few letters, dealing with the arrival of a caravan in Kanesh, addressed to Elamma, apparently when he was staying elsewhere in Anatolia and had to be informed on what happened in Kanesh. He must have taken them home when returning to Kanesh, where they ended up in his archives. I add some memorandums that use the first personal singular and of which he could well be the writer, although this is not completely certain. But the fact that *46: 11-13 his wife Lamassutum is said to have taken some of the *kutānu*-textiles that had been cleared in the palace supports this interpretation. Moreover, the trader Iliya, the arrival of whose caravan is reported in *43 (see line 6), appears as the first writer of the caravan account *39, sent from Assur to Elamma.

42. Kt 92/k 144 (1-104-92)

A big (9.4 x 6.3 cm) letter in which La-qēp and Šu-Aššur inform Elamma, who is apparently staying elsewhere in Anatolia, on the safe arrival of large amounts of textiles shipped under the responsibility (*šēp*) of various transporters from Assur to Anatolia, in lines 31f. on a shipment of tin that has arrived and which they checked and from which the colonial office “held back” a packet of tin as *nishatum*, and in lines 36f. on 6 donkeys loaded with tin and textiles, which two men are leading to him. The colonial office probably is that of Kanesh, certainly if Elamma’s wife Lamassutum is indeed mentioned in l. 20. From there shipments were (l. 16) and will be (l. 40) sent on to Elamma, both in their original packing (with “seals of the City”) and in packets composed by the writers (“with our seals”, l. 37).

	<i>a-na E-lá-ma qí-bí-ma</i>	To Elamma say,
	<i>um-ma Lá-qé-pu-um ù Šu-A-šur-<ma></i>	thus Laqēpum and Šu-Aššur:
	72 <i>ku-ta-nu ku-wa-ú-tum</i>	72 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles belonging to you,
	26 <i>ku-ta-nu ša DAM.GÀR</i>	26 belonging to <i>tamkārum</i> ,
5	1 <i>ku-ta-num ša ik-ri-bi₄-kà</i>	1 <i>kutānum</i> of your <i>ikribū</i> ,
	1 <i>ku-ta-num ša A-ta-a-a</i>	1 <i>kutānum</i> of Atāya -
	ŠUNIGIN ₂ 1 <i>me-at ku-ta-nu ša šé-ep</i>	in all 100 <i>kutānu</i> shipped under
	<i>A-šur-mu-ta-pí-il₅ 71 ku-ta-nu</i>	Aššur-mūtappil; 71 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles
	<i>ša šé-ep DUMU Ú-ša-ri-a</i>	shipped under Ušariya’s son;
10	31 <i>ku-ta-nu ša šé-ep A-šur-lá-ma-/sí</i>	31 <i>kutānu</i> shipped under Aššur-lamassī;
	3 <i>ku-ta-nu a-ha-ma : pá-ni-ú-tum</i>	separately 3 <i>kutānu</i> shipped earlier;

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	1 <i>ku-ta-num ša Ha-ti-a</i>	1 <i>kutānum</i> of Hatiya -
	ŠUNIGIN ₂ 2 <i>me-at</i> 26 <i>ku-ta-nu</i>	in all 226 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles.
	ŠÀ.BA 1 <i>me-at</i> 81 <i>ku-ta-ni</i>	Thereof 181 <i>kutānu</i> and
15	25 <i>ša A-ki-dí-e</i>	25 Akkadian textiles
	<i>Zi-kur</i> ^d IŠKUR : <i>ir-di-a-ku-um</i>	Zikur-Adad led to you.
	3½ GÍN 15 ŠE KÙ.B. <i>a-na sà-he-/er-tim</i>	paid 3 5/9 shekels for small wares,
	<i>áš-qúl</i> 1 <i>ta-ku-uš-ta-am</i>	1 Takuštaean textile
l.e.	<i>ù 2 °šu-ri-in₂ : pá-ni-°ú-tim</i>	and 2 dark textiles (sent) earlier
20	[L]a ² -ma-*s[á ² -tu]m ² <i>ḫal-qé</i>	Lamassutum(?) took.
	2 GÚ A[N.NA] <i>ku-nu-ku</i>	2 talents of tin provided with seals
rev.	<i>ša a-lim^{ki} ša DAM.GÀR</i>	in the City belonging to <i>tamkārum</i> ,
	3 GÚ <i>ku-wa-um</i> 2 <i>šu-uq-lá-a[n]</i>	3 talents belonging to you, 2 packets
	<i>ša Ar-ta-ma : nu-sà-ni-iq-/ší-na-ma</i>	of Artama – we checked them and
25	5 <i>ma-na im-ṭi-a</i>	they proved to contain 5 minas too little.
	[1 š]u-uq-lam <i>ni-ip-ṭur₄-ma</i>	We opened one packet
	[x+ ½ ₂ <i>ma-na</i> 4 GÍN <i>a-na</i>	and balanced [x +] mina 34 shekels to
the		
	DUMU <i>Da-da-nim</i> <i>ù</i> DUMU <i>Ú-ša-ri-a</i>	son of Dadānum and the son of Ušariya
	<i>né-pu-ul : iš-tù</i> AN.NA <i>qà-/tim</i>	after the tin for expenses and the ⅔
30	<i>ù ⅔ ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>ša a-pá-ni-/šu-nu</i>	mina of silver we had sent to meet them
	<i>nu-šé-bi-lu gám-ru</i> 1 <i>šu-uq-lam</i>	had been spent. One packet
	<i>a-šu-mi ni-is-ha-tim</i> É <i>kà-ri-/im</i>	they detained in the colonial office
because		
	<i>ú-kà-lu</i> DUB.ŠAR <i>šu-uq-/la-tim</i>	of the import-tax. The scribe booked you
	<i>wa-at^t(UD)-ra-tim : il₅-pu-ut-kà-ma</i>	for the additional packets, but
35	<i>a-dí-ni a-wa-tum lá gam-ra</i>	the affair has not yet been settled.
	6 <i>šu-uq-lá-tum</i>	Six packets with either our own
	<i>lu ku-nu-ku-ni lu ša a-lim^{ki}</i>	seal or that of the City,
	36 <i>ku-ta-ni</i> 32 <i>šu-ru-tim</i>	36 <i>kutānu</i> - and 32 dark textiles,
	<i>qá-du-um : ša li-wi-tim</i>	including those for wrapping,
40	6 ANŠE.HI.A <i>ša-lá-me : A-šur-i-mi-tí</i>	6 black donkeys Aššur-imittī and
	<i>ù Hu-zi-a : i-ra-dí-ú-ni-/ku-um</i>	Huziya are leading towards you.
u.e.	1 <i>ma-na</i> AN.NA <i>i-šu-uq-lim</i>	1 mina of tin (taken) from a packet (and)
	3 LÁ ¼ GÍN KÙ.B. <i>a-sà-he-er-tim</i>	2¾ shekels of silver for small wares
44	<i>a-na A-šur-i-mi-tí</i>	we gave to Aššur-imittī and Huziya.
le.e	<i>ù Hu-zi-a : ni-dí-in</i> 10 <i>ku-tani</i> 8 <i>šu-ru-tim</i>	10 <i>kutānu</i> - and 8 dark textiles we
	<i>a-ni-kà-sí-kà : ni-dí : i-na šu-uq-lá-tim</i>	deposited on your account. From these
	<i>a-ni-a-tim</i> 2 <i>šu-uq-lá-an : ša š[é]-ep</i>	packets 2 are shipped under the
	<i>A-šur-la₁-ma-[s]</i>	responsibility of Aššur-lamassī.

Notes

13-14. This proves that the “Akkadian textiles” where an (expensive) type of *kutānū*.

17.43. *Sahertum*, “small wares”, worth a few shekels, were probably given along with transporters as a form of concrete money or small change, to be used en route.

19-20. Since *talqe* requires a female subject Lamssatum is the most obvious reading of this damaged line, although the traces are difficult. According to the letter *23:15.20 and the memorandum *46:11f. Elamma’s wife did take textiles and she may also be meant in *85:10f., where “the lady (*awiltum*) took 3 textiles”.

23. 3 GÚ *kuwā’um*, because the logical subject is in the singular, *annukum*, “tin”.

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26-29. The verb *napālum*, “to balance”, indicates that the two transporters were refunded what they had paid out of their own pockets, after the “tin for expenses” and also the silver sent them en route had been spent. What is given to Aššur-imittī and Huziya according to lines 42-45 may have had the same purpose.

28. The son of Dadānum probably is Šu-lštar, cf. *3:17, *15:3 and *202:14f. The son of Ušāriya (also in l. 9) must be Ennam-Aššur, cf. *10:4, *15:2 and *298:17. Ušāriya probably is an abbreviation of Ušur-pī-Aššur, since this is the name of Ennam-Aššur’s father in *175:2 and 9f. Identifying a man as “son of PN” usually happened to prevent confusion, in this case with a namesake who acted as Elamma’s representative in Assur and wrote letters to him.

31-35. Since in Kanesh the import-tax was paid to the local palacc the colony may have intervened because of a claim of the ruler, based on fact that one container had been opened en route, which may have raised the suspicion that this had also happened with other containers.

43. Kt 91/k 483 (1-336-91)**44. Kt 91/k 486 (1-341-91)**

These following two memorandums (here designated as A and B), written in Kanesh, report on the expenses and payments in various towns in connection with a caravan belonging to Iliya (his *awītum*, l. 6) that traveled from Assur to Kanesh. The texts are virtual duplicates until A 32 = B 27 and for this part only the variants of B are given in a note following the transliteration. Differences between A and B in the last part require a full transliteration of B:27-50. The memorandums are included here because they contain data that are normally written in a caravan account.

43 = A

	3 GÚ 15 <i>ma-na</i> AN.NA	3 talents 15 minas of tin under
	<i>ku-nu-ku</i> 4 TÚG <i>šu-ru-tum li-wi-/sú</i>	seals, 4 dark textiles, its wrapping,
	17 TÚG <i>ku-ta-nu</i> 16 $\frac{2}{3}$ <i>ma-na</i>	17 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles, 16 $\frac{2}{3}$ minas of
	AN.NA- <i>ak qá-tim</i> 2 ANŠE	loose tin, 2 black donkeys -
5	<i>ša-lá-mu</i> ŠUNIGIN ₂ 4 GÚ 18 <i>ma-na</i>	in all 4 talents 18 minas of tin the
	AN.NA <i>a-wi-it li-li-a</i>	value of Iliya(’s shipment).
	<i>iš-tù a-lim^{ki} a-di Ka-ni-iš</i>	From the City until Kaniš
	1 GÚ- <i>tám</i> 4 <i>ma-na</i> 6 1/4 GÍN.TA	the toll-and-fees amounted to
	<i>da-tum ik-šu-dam</i>	4 minas 6 1/4 shekels per talent,
10	15 GÍN.TA <i>qá-qá-da-tù-/um</i>	the head-tax to 15 shekels per person.
	17 5/6 <i>ma-na</i> 4 GÍN <i>áš-qúl</i>	I paid 17 minas 54 shekels.
	16 $\frac{2}{3}$ GÍN <i>mu-tá</i> : AN.NA- <i>ak /qá-tim</i>	16 2/3 shekels shortage of hand tin.
	4 <i>ša bi-lá-tim iš-tù</i>	For 4 porters from
	<i>Ti-mi-il₅-ki-a</i> : <i>a-di Hu-ra-ma</i>	Timilkiya until Hurama
15	1/3 <i>ma-na</i> 6 GÍN.TA 1 $\frac{2}{3}$ <i>ma-na</i> /4 GÍN	at 26 shekels each I paid 1 mina 44
	<i>áš-qúl</i> 3 $\frac{2}{3}$ <i>ma-na</i> 5 GÍN	shekels (of tin). 3 $\frac{2}{3}$ minas (of tin) food
	<i>ú-kúl-ti</i> 2 ANŠE <i>ù sá-ri-dim</i>	for 2 donkeys and a donkey-driver
	<i>ù na-ab/p₁-ri-ta-šu-nu</i>	and for the paddock they were put in.
	ANŠE- <i>ri</i> : <i>i-sí-ká-tim</i>	They took the donkeys away during
20	<i>it-ru-ú-ma a-pá-ťá-ri-šu-nu</i>	the campaign and I paid 50 shekels

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	5/6 <i>ma-na</i> AN.NA <i>áš-qúl</i>	of tin to redeem them.
	½ <i>ma-na</i> 6 GÍN AN.NA	36 shekels of tin for
l.e.	<i>a-na</i> 1 TÚG <i>ša Ku-ku-ú</i>	1 textile of Kukû,
24	5 GÍN <i>a-na šé-[n]é-šu</i>	5 shekels for his sandals.
rev.	ŠUNIGIN ₂ °24; <i>ma-na</i> 10 5/6 GÍN <i>iš-tù</i>	In all 24 minas 10 5/6 shekels.
	16 5/6 <i>ma-na</i> AN.NA- <i>ak qá-tim</i>	After the 16 5/6 minas of hand tin
	<i>gám-ru</i> 8½ <i>ma-na</i> ⅔ GÍN	had been spent 8 minas 30⅔ shekels
	AN.NA <i>i-na-pá-al i-na</i>	of tin will be balanced (to him). Of
30	17 TÚG <i>ku-ta-ni-šu</i> 1 TÚG <i>a-na</i>	the 17 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles, they took
	<i>ni-is-ha-tim il₅-qé-ú</i>	1 as excise, they balanced him
	2½ GÍN KÙ.B. <i>i-pu-lu-šu-um</i>	2½ shekels of silver; 1½ textile and
	1½ TÚG ù 1½ GÍN KÙ.B. <i>iš-ra-tù-šu</i>	1½ shekel of silver (balanced) his tithe.
	<i>i-hu-lu-qá-e</i> 1½ GÍN KÙ.B.	His share in the losses amounted to 1½
35	<i>ik-šu-sú ša</i> 2½ TÚG <i>ša É.GAL-Ilúm</i>	shekels of silver. For the 2½ textiles
	<i>il₅-qé-ú</i> ½ <i>ma-na</i> (eras.) KÙ.B.	which the palace took, Aššur-šulūlī
	<i>A-šur-šú-lu-li il₅-qé</i>	received ½ mina of silver.
	<i>a-ha-ma</i> 6 GÍN LÁ 15 ŠE KÙ.B.	Separately, 5 11/12 shekels of silver,
	<i>ša šál-ša-tí-šu A-šur-šú-lu-li/ma</i>	Aššur-šulūlī took as his one-third-share.
40	<i>il₅-qé ší-ti</i> TÚG.HI- <i>tí-šu</i> 12 TÚG	The rest of his textiles, 12 pieces,
	3 GÚ 15 <i>ma-na</i> AN.NA <i>ku-nu-ki-kà</i>	3 talents 15 minas of tin with my seals,
	4 TÚG <i>šu-ru-tum : li-wi-sú</i>	4 dark textiles, its wrapping,
	2 ANŠE.HI.A : <i>ša-lá-me</i>	2 black donkeys with
	ù <i>ú-nu-sú-nu</i>	their harness,
45	<i>a-na A-šur-šú-lu-li</i>	I entrusted to Aššur-šulūlī
	<i>áp-qi-id</i> IGI Šu-Be- <i>lim</i>	in the presence of Šu-Bēlum,
	DUMU A- <i>mur</i> -DINGIR IGI Puzur ₄ -	son of Amur-ilī, of Puzur-Aššur,
	DUMU I- <i>tur</i> ₄ -DINGIR [A-šur	son of Itūr-ilī.

Variants in B to A lines 1- 31

B1//A2 <*ku-nu-ku*>; 2//2: *li-wi-tum*; 3//3: *ku-ta-ni* 17 *ma-n[a]*; 7//7: *Kà-ni-iš^{ki}*; 10f.//11: 17 1/2 (over erasure) *ma-na* 4 GÍN / AN.NA *áš-qúl*; 12//12: AN.NA-*ak qá-tim*; 16//17: <2> ANŠE-*re* <ù> *sá-ri-dim*; 18//20: *a-na [pā]-tá-ri-šu-<nu>*; 19//23: *a-na* TÚG; 20//24: AN.NA *a-šé-né-šu*; 21-24//25-29 missing in B through damage, but note that the PN *Ku-ku-ú* of A is spelled *Ku-ú-ku* in B:39 and 49; 26//32: *i-na-pu-[u-šu-um]*.

44 = B: 27-50 (// A:32-45)

27	[1½] TÚG <i>a-na ší-mi-im [il-qé-ú]</i>	[1½] textile [they took] for sale,
	[1]½ GÍN KÙ.B. <i>hu-lu-q[á-ú] ½ GÍN</i>	[1]½ shekel of silver <balanced>. Losses
	<i>[k-šu-ud ší-im</i> 2½ °TÚG; <i>ku-ta-ni</i>	amounted to 1½ shekel, [½ mina of]
30	[½ <i>ma-na</i> K]Ù.B. <i>A-šur-šú-lu-li</i>	silver, the price of 2½ <i>kutānu</i> -textiles
	<i>a-na Ku-ni-lim : i-di-in</i>	Aššur-šulūlī gave to Kūn-ilum.
	<i>a-ha-ma</i> 6 GÍN LÁ 15 ŠE KÙ.B.	Separately, 5 11/12 shekels of silver
	<i>ša šál-ša-tí-šu A-šur-šú-lu-li</i>	of his one-third-share Aššur-šulūlī took.
	<i>il₅-qé ŠÀ.BA</i> 2 GÚ 10 <i>ma-na</i> AN.NA	Thereof: 2 talents 10 minas of tin under
35	<i>ku-nu-ki ša a-lim^{ki}</i> 4 TÚG <i>šu-ṛ[u-tim]</i>	seals of the City, 4 dark textiles,
	<i>li-wi-sú</i> 12 TÚG <i>ku-t[a-ni]</i>	its wrapping, 12 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles,
	2 ANŠE.HI.A : <i>ša-lá-me</i>	4 black donkeys,

- ## Notes

A 23 // B 39. The man whose name is spelled both *Ku-ku-ú* and *Ku-ú-ku*, as far as I know not attested in other texts, presumably was an Anatolian. The garment and sandals bought and given to him presumably were a gift.

Comment

To fix Iliya's share in the costs of the joint caravan (*ellutum*), the value of his goods, merchandise and donkeys, called *awītum*, is computed in tin. Then it is stated how much was paid per talent tin for tolls-and-fees (*da'atum*), for the "head-tax" per person (A:7-10), for unforeseen additional expenses (A:13-21) and to the transporter (see for the system of the *awītum* now Dercksen 204, ch. 8, and for the issue of the hand tin, *AOATT* ch. XI). Since the transporter had received only 15 2/3 minas of hand tin (A:3) and expenses and shortages amounted to 24 minas and 5/6 shekel (A:25), he will be balanced (*napālum*) 8 minas 2/3 shekels of tin (which he must have advanced out of his own pocket; A: 25-28). Then follows an enumeration of payments made to clear the merchandise imported, including payments made or received (the payment for 2 1/2 textiles bought by the palace in A:34-36 is said to be received by Aššur-šulūlī, and in B:30f. he is said to have given it to Kūn-ilum). A:40ff. state how much

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merchandise is now cleared and that it was entrusted to Aššur-šulūlī. According to B:34-40 one donkey-load of tin, the textiles and the donkeys were shipped on by Ku'uku/Kukû to Hinnāya. The remaining half load (ca. 65 minas of tin), which "I entrusted here" (B:42 to whom?) was apparently retained to be used for various payments (B:43-49) that indeed add up to 1 talent 3 minas and 50 shekels of tin. That for the import-tax fits the norm (2 shekels per *šuqlum*), but the amount of *šaddu'utu*-tax, usually paid to the Assyrian authorities, is unbelievably high (ca. 17%) and might cover older obligations. The renewed payment to Ku'uku of additional 'loose tin' is puzzling; was it for transport inside Anatolia?

45. Kt 91/k 436 (1-289-91)

Memorandum on the shipment of donkeys loaded with merchandise belonging to three different persons (including the anonymous speaker) inside Anatolia by Šamaš-ublam to Ali-ahum.

	1 GÚ LÁ 2 <i>ma-na</i>	58 minas of tin,
	AN.NA 24 <i>ma-ku-hu</i>	24 <i>makūhu</i> -textiles,
	1 TÚG <i>pì-ri-kà-num</i>	1 <i>pirikannu</i> -textiles,
	2 ANŠE <i>ša-lá-mu</i>	2 black donkeys
5	<i>i-a-ú-tum</i>	belonging to me;
	21 <i>ma-ku-hu</i>	21 <i>makūhu</i> -textiles,
	1 ANŠE <i>ša l-dí-a-bi₄-im</i>	1 donkey of Iddin-abum;
	1 <i>na-ru-qám</i>	1 bag with
l.e.	5 <i>ku-ta-nu</i>	5 <i>kuṭānu</i> -textiles
10	<i>ša Šu-Ku-bi₄-im</i>	of Šu-Kūbum;
rev.	6 <i>ma-na</i> 15 GÍN / URUDU	6 minas 15 shekels of copper
	7 GÍN AN.NA	7 shekels of tin
	<i>a-qá-tí^dUT[U]-ub-lá-/am</i>	for his use Šamaš-ublam,
	<i>a-na A-lá-hi-im</i>	brought to
15	<i>ú-bi₄-il₅</i>	Ali-ahum.

Notes

13. The transporter Šamaš-ublam occurs only here, but he could be the same man who transports goods in RA 60 (1966) 120 no. 48:25, and according to the letters TC 3, 74:19-21; Kt 89/k 230:15., 17; and Kt 89/k 260:25.

Comment

The composition of the load indicates that what is shipped, presumably from Kanesh further into Anatolia, are the remains of a larger caravan and the amounts of merchandise is somewhat less than three donkeys can carry. The anonymous speaker could well be Elamma, since the destination of the goods is his brother.

46. Kt 92/k 147 (1-107-92)

Memorandum on 197 imported textiles available in Kanesh, the bulk having "come down" from the local palace, others "brought" by various men, some "taken out of the strong room". After small numbers haven been "taken" (i.a. by Elamma's wife

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Lamassutum) or supplied to transporters as *be'ulātum*, there remain 180 pieces to be traded.

	1 me-at 73 ku-ta-nu	173 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles (that)
	i-na É.GAL-lim ur-du-/nim	came down from the palace,
	7 TÚG ša li-wi-/tim	7 textiles as wrapping,
	1 TÚG ša ik-ri-bi ₄ -a	1 textile of my temple-fund,
5	ša DUMU Šál-mah ub-lá-ni	is what Šallim-ahum's son brought me.
	10 TÚG ša i-ma-ša-ar-tim	I added 10 textiles that I took
	ú-šé-ší-a-ni ú-ra-dí	out of the strong room (and)
	6 TÚG ša A-šur-mu-ta-/pí-il ₅	6 textiles that Aššur-mutappil
	ub-lá-ni (erasures)	brought me.
10	ŠU.NIGIN ₂ me-at 93[+4 TÚG]	In all 19[7 textiles].
i.e.	ŠÀ.BA 7 TÚG ku-[ta-ni]	Thereof: 7 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles
	La-ma-sú- ^o tum ₂	Lamassutum
	ta-al-q[é]	took,
	3 TÚG Šu-Ku-bu-um	3 textiles Šu-Kubum took,
15	il ₅ -qé 3 TÚG ša be-<ú>-lá-at	3 textiles of the working capital
	Puzur ₄ -A-na	of Puzur-Anna,
	3 TÚG ša be-ú-lá-at	3 textiles of the working capital of
	A-šur-ba-ni 2 TÚG A-šur-mu-ta-pi-/il ₅	Aššur-bāni, 2 textiles Aššur-
	il ₅ -qé	mūtappil took.
20	ší-tí TÚG.HI.A	The rest of the textiles:
u.e.	1 me-at 80 TÚG	180 pieces.

Notes

1. Assuming that the normal import-tax and tithe were levied and that the 7 textiles for wrapping had been used for packing the tin, the record deals with a caravan of 9 or 10 donkeys (two of which were loaded with tin) that entered the palace. This would agree with the fact that three harnessers were accompanying it, the two whose working-capital is mentioned in lines 15-17 and Aššur-mutappil, possibly the youngest son of Elamma.

10. The figure is damaged and after 90 three heads of vertical wedges are visible. The figures in lines 11-19 require an original total of 198 textiles, but the addition of the figures of lines 1-6 only 197; *non liquet*.

11-13. See the note on *42:19-29. That Elamma's wife took textiles suggests that our record, like *42, was written in Kanesh, but it is not clear whether Elamma was the writer. That Lamassutum took no less than 7 *kutānu*-textiles suggests that this memo dates from after the death of Elamma (whom she survived several years). But because this is uncertain (that Elamma's son Aššur-mutappil accompanied the caravan is also not decisive) this memo has been included here.

47. Kt 91/k 291 (1-148-91)

What is reported in this letter took place in Anatolia. Its writer, Aššur-imitti, probably wrote from Kanesh (the usual place of the transactions with the colonial office reported in this letter, but a colony in another city is not excluded) to Elamma, who must have been staying elsewhere in Anatolia. The writer must be the same as that of *85, where, together with Aššur-nādā (who also appears in our text), he informs Elamma from

Kanesh (lines 10'-11', the lady who took 3 textiles must be Lamassutum) on the arrival of a caravan and payments made.

	[a-n]a E-lá-ma qí-bi-ma um-ma A-šùr-i-mì-tí-ma 5 ma-na KÙ.B. ku-nu-ki-kà Bu-ur-Sú-in ub-lam-ma	Say to Elamma, thus Aššur-imittī: 5 minas of silver under your seal Būr-Suen delivered and
5	a-na-ku ù A-šur-na-da nu-sà-ni-iq-ma 2 GÍN KÙ.B. im-ṭí 3 ma-na KÙ.B. a-na SÍG.HI ša É kà-ri-im ni-iš-qú-/ul ša ILLAT-at l-na-a	I myself and Aššur-nādā we checked it and it proved to be 2 shekels too little. We paid 3 minas of silver for wool of the colonial office. As for the caravan of Innaya and
10	ú Šu-Nu-nu a-na 10* TÚG.TA bi-it-qá-tum i-bi-ší-a-ma ⅓ ma-na KÙ.B. i-na	Šu-Nunu, there occurred deficits amounting to 10 textiles per (trader?), so that we could not deposit ⅓ mina of silver in the colonial office, but
l.e.	É kà-ri-im lá ni-ta-dí-/ma ⅔ ma-na KÙ.B. <<i-na>>	I paid ⅔ mina of silver from your own silver.
15	i-na KÙ.B.-pì-kà áš-qúl 2 ma-na 6 GÍN KÙ.B. a-na 6 ANŠE (erasure) ni-iš-qú-ul 12 GÍN KÙ.B. ší-im KÙ.B.-pí-kà i-na li-bi-/a	I paid 2 minas 6 shekels of silver for 6 donkeys. 12 shekels of silver, the price of <i>your silver</i> is still due by me.
20	i-ba-ší i-na ^{na4} GÍN.ZA-ku-nu ša ub-lu-ni-ni 5/6 ma-na 3 GÍN a-na iš-ra-tim il ₅ -qé-ú °½ ₂ ma-na 2 GÍN a-na ší-mi-im a-na ša-na-ú-um il ₅ -qé-ú	Of your lapis lazuli, which they brought here, they took 53 shekels as tithe. 32 shekels (of lapis lazuli) they bought at a rate of 2 : 1.
25	ší-im hu-sà-ri-ku-nu °ku-nu ₂ -ki-ni Bu-ur-Sú-in* (erasure) [n]a-áš-a-ku-um i-na *šál-ša-tí [ša] ILLAT l-na-a ú A-šùr-/ta-ak-lá-ku	With the price of your lapis lazuli under our seal Būr-Suen is on his way to you. Of the 'thirds' of the caravan of
le.e.	[x] ma-na 13 GÍN KÙ.B. ta-lá-qé	Innaya and Aššur-taklāku you will receive [x] minas 13 shekels of silver.
30	°iš ₂ -té-en šú-ha-ra-am a-na Lu-hu-sà-dí-a [tū] ₄ -da-ma °e ₂ -ma-ra-am i-lá-qé-ú	Send one servant to Luhusaddiya and let them take the/a donkey.

Notes

6. We meet Būr-Suen as transporter of *tamkārum* in *19:11, cf. 36; in *164:10-12 Lamassutum leaves behind "a tablet of a debt of 66 shekels of silver owed by B." (originally to Elamma?; a debt of him to Elamma also occurs in *70:13).

9-10, 28. See for Innāya, Šu-Nunu and Aššur-taklāku as organizers of collective caravans, OAI 165 (Innāya also in KTS 1, 25a:25f.; Aššur-taklāku also in BIN 4, 19:12, CCT 2, 41a:4, POAT 19:12, Kt c/k a 814:23, Kt c/k 260:30 and 264:32), but our letter contains the only reference to jointly organized ones.

10. The signs *na 10* are written over the erased signs TÚG 1.

11. *Bitqātum* is not "amounts outstanding" (CAD B, 276, 1), for which OA uses *ba'abtum*, but "shortages, deficits", when an amount received, delivered or at hand is less than it should be in number, weight ("underweight", *bitqāt abnim*, EL 278:6; *bitqāt 10 GÍN-tum*, "deficit on a 10 shekel weight", Kt c/k 302:6; *bitqāt mana'im*, AKT 5, 52:16f.) or commercial yield (cf. AKT 3, 45:9, *kīma bitqātuni*; ICK 1, 111:6, *bitqāt 13*

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ṣubātē ṣahhuram; VAS 26, 29:20, *bitqātim ša 5 mana kaspim*). The use of the connecting *-ma* at the end of lines 11 and 13 indicates the logical coherence: the losses prevented the writer from making a full deposit (as participation in a collective trading operation) for Elamma in the colonial office, but he managed to do so by using silver of the latter available to him.

18. The words “silver as price of your silver” must contain a mistake.

20-22. See for the tithe on lapis lazuli levied by the colonial organization AKT 5, 82-85. Note the alternation between a logographic (NA₄.GÍN.ZA; see for the various spellings C. Michel, *Studies Veenhof*, 344) and the syllabic spelling *husārum*.

24. That *šanā’um* is a numerical adverb, “at two (each)”, “at the double of”, referring to the price, is proved by the figures mentioned in Kt c/k 257:25-28 (courtesy of Dercksen), “2 minas 55 shekels of your lapis lazuli we sold at 2 : 1 and we received 5 minas 50 shekels of silver” (*ša-na-um niddin*).

26. *na-āš-a-kum* at the end of l. 26 erased (*a-kum* still visible) and written at beginning of l. 27.

27. *šalšātum*, “third parts”, the technical term for the share in the profit of a joint-stock company due to an investor and of a collective caravan (*ellutum*) due to a participant; see OA/ 169f.

48. Kt 91/k 343 (1-200-91)

The remains of a letter (so on the basis of l. 4’, “your servant”), the bottom of a tablet in small script, still measuring 3.0 x 4.8 cm. It reports on a small lot of merchandise, probably one donkey load of tin (described in the first part) and one of textiles (described in lines 15ff.) presumably part of a bigger caravan.

1'	[x x x x x x x x] *x [x x x x E]n-nam-A-šūr °a-pu-ul-šu-nu ₂ 1 ½ ma-na AN.[NA] a-qá-tí šú-ha-ri-kà	 Ennam-Aššur I paid to them; 1 1/2 mine of tin I gave in the hands of your servant,
5'	a-dí-in 10 GÍN AN.NA a-qá-tí Šu-Sú-in a-dí-in 2 ma-na AN.NA-kà im-ťí	10 shekels of tin in the hands of Šu-Suen. Your tin was 2 minas too little;
l.e.	½ ma-na AN.NA a-na ni-is-°ha ₂ -at AN.NA-ki-im ša ší-im	½ [?] mina for (paying) the import-tax on the tin purchased
10'	l-dí-Sú-in a-pá-ni	by Iddin-Suen, we placed
rev.	[š]u-uq-lim ni-dí-°in ₂ ší-tí AN.NA-ki 53 ⅔ ma-na 7 GÍN AN.NA ku-nu-ki-ni	on top of the packet. The rest of the tin: 53 minas and 47 shekels, of tin under our seal.
15'	i-na 25 TÚG šu-ru-tim 2½ TÚG a-na ni-is-ha-tim il ₅ -qé-ú 1 GÍN KÙ.B. i-pu-lu [x x x x x] li-wi-tum [x x x x x +]2 TÚG ku-ta-nu	Of the 25 dark textiles they took 2½ textiles as import-tax and they balanced 1 shekel of silver [textiles as] wrapping, [+]2 kutānu-textiles

(lacuna)

l.e. 1 °x_c*-ra-am x [
 a-na ZI*-x [
 iš-tí l-]

Notes

8-9. Half a mina of tin as import-tax implies half a packet (*šuqlum*), weighing ca. 16 minas. The tax was added separately to the packet, so that its buyer did not have to pay it from his lot.

15'-17'. A balancing payment (*napālum*, *nipiltum*) to or by the palace (the anonymous "they") resulted from the fact that tax on textiles was paid in natura, but that usually no smaller units than half a textile were acceptable, so that the difference was balanced in silver. A balance payment by the palace ("they") of 1 shekel of silver alongside an import-tax of 2½ textiles is odd in two ways. The import-tax on textiles, called *nishatum*, normally is 5%, while the so-called pre-emption (*ša šīmim*) or "tithe" (*išrātum*) amounts to 10%. But if the latter is meant no balance payment by the palace was necessary, since 2½ textiles = 10%. *Non liquet*. See for balancing payments in connection with the import-tax (*nishatum*) levied by the palace also *121-123, with comments.

Comment

This is part of letter with a report on a small lot of merchandise (perhaps one donkey load of tin and one of textiles), presumably part of a bigger caravan: The first part list the usual expenses and investments for a caravan trip, a balance payment, underweight, "hand tin" for caravan personnel for expenses en route, and an amount kept apart for paying taxes. The second part describes one donkey load of textiles, including those used for wrapping the merchandise.

The writer of this letter (the isolated plural verbal form in l. 11' does not imply that there was more than one) remains unknown and there are several different persons with the names Šu-Suen and Iddin-Suen in the archive, but Elamma is a serious possibility.

D. Joint-caravans (*ellutum*) and "declared value" (*awītum*) (49-53)

The first two records presented below deal with a trader's *awītum*, that is the "declared value" of a caravan or the shares of the traders participating in a joint caravan (*ellutum*). It is a system whereby the value of its load is expressed in tin as single valuta, whereby one textile was valued at 2 minas and one donkey at between 1 1/3 and 2 minas. It served as a basis for sharing and apportioning expenses and losses incurred, especially the road-tax (*da'atum*), and it may also have been used en route to be shown to authorities levying taxes. See for a discussion and analysis of the system *OAI* Ch. 8. Some new "*awītum* lists" were published by C. Günbattu, *ArAn* 5 (2002), 81ff.

The joint caravans, called *ellutum*, are named after one or two traders who lead and organized it. There are many records, such as the ones presented below, that deal with the revenues of its participants (in which the verb *napālum* is used) and mention what they obtain, usually in various stages, whereby the texts distinguish what comes from the "holding", (*mišittum*), presumably a fund stocked in the colonial office, and what accrues to them as share in the profit, called "the one third parts" (*šalšātum*). See the discussion and analysis in *OAI* Ch. 9, who could already use the texts published below.

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49. Kt 91/k 285 (1-142-91)

This un-opened black envelope, contains a record of the “declared value” of the shares of three traders cooperating in a caravan, among whom Elamma, who have impressed their seal on the envelope. It is very unfortunate that lack of access to the tablet deprives us of important information on the size and composition of the “declared value” of the shares in this joint venture of Elamma and his two co-operating partners.

	seal A	
1	KIŠIB <i>E-lá-ma</i> DUMU <i>I-dí-Sú-in</i>	Seal of Elamma, son of Iddin-Suen,
	KIŠIB <i>Sú-sà-a</i> DUMU <i>I-sí-hi-im</i>	seal of Susāya, son of Isihum,
	seal A	
	KIŠIB <i>En-na-Sú-in</i>	seal of Ennam-Suen,
l. e.	seal A	
rev.	DUMU <i>Ku-ku-ra-nim</i>	son of Kukurānum.
	seal B	
5	<i>ṭup-pu-um ša a-wi-it</i>	Tablet of the declared value
	<i>E-lá-ma Sú-sà-a ù</i>	(of the goods) of Elamma,
	<i>En-na-Sú-in</i>	Susaya and Ennam-Suen.
	seal C	
u.e.	seal B	
le.e.	seal B	
r.e.	no seal	

Seals

seal A = CS 1142, and identical to *99 seal C, *120 seal C, BIN 6, 17 (a fragmentary tablet case) = Teissier no.616; the seal of Elamma, son of Iddin-Suen.

seal B = CS 1143

seal C = CS 1144

Notes

2. The same man in AKT 1, 41:11-12 as witness, during eponymy year REL 103

3. This man with this filiation occurs only here.

Comment

Dercksen, having observed that *awītum*, “declared value”, was not only applied to merchandise traveling from Assur to Anatolia, but also to silver shipped back to Assur, suggests in OAI 155, that this is the case in our text, although the valuta of the *awītum* is not mentioned. He assumes that this record in its unopened envelope, sealed by Elamma, was drawn up in Kanesh and preserved there for evidentiary purposes as a record of the “declared value” of the silver of the three named traders that was brought to Assur in a caravan. The sealers acknowledge the correctness of the amounts certainly mentioned on the tablet inside and presumably also assume responsibility for payment of the tax and transport fee. It is regrettable that no permission was given to open the envelope, so that we remain ignorant of the figures and perhaps additional stipulations of this important document.

The only fact we can establish is that the three traders cooperated – perhaps only ad hoc, for a single transport, to make a joint *ellutum* – to their silver to Assur. Of the two traders cooperating with Elamma Susaya, son of Isihum, is not well known; he may be the man mentioned in *326:6, where “I paid 43 shekels of silver to Susaya on behalf

of Āl-tāb”, and he occurs as witness in AKT 1, 41:11, during the year REL 103, and in Kt n/k 518:2, during the year REL year 95 or 99. Various Ennam-Suen's occur in the archive, one even prominently as recipient of letters and owners of textiles (see Ch. XIV), but he is not identified as son of Kukurānum.

50. Kt 91 /k 301 (1-158-91)

Memorandum, meant for an anonymous person addressed as “you” in l. 19, on the expenses (*gamrum*) incurred on a shipment (of tin and textiles) belonging to Elamma, with a “declared value” (*awītum*) of 4 talents of tin. It mentions how the “harnesser” Kunnāya, who apparently had not been given enough “loose tin” to meet them, also after some silver, converted into tin, had been supplied to him en route (lines 19-21), had been compensated for what he must have advanced. It ends (probably the purpose of this memo) by mentioning that there still was a disagreement about some silver and tin taken by the harnesser, which had to be settled.

	<i>a-na 4 GÚ AN.NA</i>	On 4 talents of tin, the declared
	<i>a-wi-it E-lá-ma</i>	value of Elamma('s merchandise),
	<i>4 ma-na 15 GÍN.TA</i>	the road-tax at 4 minas 15 shekels tin
	<i>da-tum 17 ma-na AN.N[A]</i>	per (talent) amounted for him to
5	<i>ik-šu-sú 5 ma-na AN.N[A]</i>	17 minas of tin. 5 minas of tin
	<i>a-na ANŠE¹ me-tim Ku-na-a</i>	Kunnaya charged us
	<i>iš-ku¹-*ni¹-a-tí</i>	for a donkey that had died.
	<i>1/3 ma-na 7 1/2 GÍN</i>	I paid 27 ½ shekels (of tin) as
	<i>a-na ta-ší-a-tim</i>	costs of transport,
10	<i>áš-qúl 2 ma-na</i>	2 minas (of tin) for
	<i>ú-ku-ul-tum</i>	food and fodder, the head-tax
l.e.	<i>15 GÍN qá-qá-dum</i>	amounted for him to 15 shekels.
rev.	<i>ik-šu-sú ta-ší-a-at</i>	As cost of transport of
	<i>10 TÚG.HI.A wa-at-ru-/tim</i>	10 extra textiles
15	<i>1½ ma-na AN.NA</i>	he (the harnesser) took
	<i>il₅-qé ½ ma-[n]a KÙ.B.</i>	1½ mina of tin, ½ mina of
	<i>bé-ú-la-[ù-š]u</i>	silver was his working capital.
	<i>⅓ ma-na KÙ.B. ša a-na</i>	The ⅓ mina of silver
	<i>pá-ni-šu tù-šé-bi₄-lu</i>	you sent to meet him,
20	<i>10 GÍN.°TA a-na AN_z.[NA]</i>	was sold for tin at a rate of
	<i>ta¹(ŠA)-dí-in-ma [mì-ma]</i>	10 to 1 and this is the total
	<i>a-nim ga-am-ru-[um]</i>	of the expenses.
	<i>2½ ma-na AN.NA</i>	We made him a balance payment
	<i>ni-pu-ul-šu-um</i>	of 2½ minas of tin.
u.e.	<i>a-na 5 GÍN KÙ.B.</i>	For the 5 shekels of silver
26	<i>nu-ku-ra-im (ù erased)</i>	that were disputed
le.e	<i>ù 1½ ma-na AN.NA</i>	and the 1½ mina of tin
	<i>ta-ší-a-tim ša il₅-qé-ú</i>	he took as transport costs
	<i>da-ni-tí a-qá-bi₄-šu-um</i>	I will state him my harsh conditions.

Notes

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6. Kunnāya amust be identical to Kunnāya, son of Manana, listed in *113:4 as sealer of a record in which he promises not to raise a claim against Elamma for (compensation of) expenses and losses of Ilī-ālum's caravan; he has to claim it from the (leader of) the caravan.

29. *Dannatam qabā'um*, with the suffix attached to the noun referring to the speaker, means something like issuing an ultimatum to somebody in order to force him, e.g. if he denies (*nakārum*, ICK 2, 145:10, KTS 5a:26) a liability, to promise before witnesses prompt payment or that, if he is refuted and his liability is confirmed (*ka'unum*), he will pay a fine, e.g. the double of what is at stake. See for published examples *254:18-19; AKT 3, 49:13-15; Prag I 442:45-47, 553:16-20, and Veenhof, *Lex.*, s.v.

Comment

"Caravan accounts" contain numerous passages where a transporter is indemnified, receives a "balance payment", if expenses of various kind made during a caravan journey from Assur to Kanesh had required more money than he had been given along in the form of unsealed tin or silver (see AOATT 257ff.) and he had advanced it from his own means. In our case this is done in a record that gives an account of the expenses on the basis of the "declared value" of the shipment. This normally would not have been necessary for the transporter, but was probably done because Elamma had been charged a proportionate share of the total expenses of a caravan which his donkeys had joined on the basis of which his accounts with his transporter were settled. The expenses (excluding the working capital of ½ mina of silver), rated in tin, are those often mentioned in such accounts alongside the road-tax (see AOATT Ch. IX.5) and add up to 29 minas 32 ½ shekels, which lead, after deduction of the contested expense for the transport of extra textiles, to a balance payment of 2 ½ minas, which implies that the transporter had received 26½ minas of unsealed tin at the outset of his journey.

For a contested sum of 5 shekels and the extra costs of transport the writer stated his hard conditions (my *dannutum*), presumably that the transporter had to supply good evidence on penalty of a fine. It is not impossible that this problem is reflected in *113, where the same Kunnāya promises not to claim any expenses and losses incurred during a caravan trip from Elamma, since he has to obtain them from the (leader of) the caravan on the basis of the value of his (Elamma or Kunnāya?) goods (*ana awītišu*).

51. Kt 91/k 300 (1-157-91)

A memo on the accounting of the revenues from the caravan (*ellutum*) of Pilah-lštar, son of Uzua.

34	TÚG <i>ku-ta-n[ī]</i> <i>i-na-pu-lu-nim</i> 3 5/6 <i>ma-na</i> <i>ša mī-šī-tim</i>	For 34 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles they will balance me. 3 5/6 minas of the holding,
5	1 5/6 <i>ma-na</i> 3 ½ GÍN <i>ša šāl-ša-tim</i> <i>i-na pá-nim-ma</i> <i>a-lá-qé</i>	1 mina 53½ shekels of the one-third fund I will take in the first instance.

rev. (1 cm not inscribed)

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	2 TÚG <i>ku-ta-ni</i>	2 <i>kutānu</i> -textiles
10	<i>Pu-šu-ke-en₆</i>	Pūšu-kēn
	<i>i-na-pá-lam</i>	will balance me
	<i>ša ELLAT^{at}</i>	of the caravan
	<i>Pi-lá-ah-lštar</i>	of Pilah-lštar,
	DUMU <i>Ú-zu-a</i>	son of Uzua.

Notes

7-8. *Ina panîmma* could mean “soon”,⁵ but it is more likely that the expression refers to the fact that settling accounts and making payments could take place in stages, perhaps conditioned by the progress of the sale of the merchandise. This is shown by Kt c/k 260:6-7 (courtesy Dercksen), where a trader who has a share (*adāmum*) in the “holding” of a particular caravan states: “I will collect x silver, the two-thirds (*šinepē*), and 5/6 mina (in addition, or from it?) from the first (silver) that becomes available” (lit. “comes out”, *ina panîmma* / [*ša*] *uššianni*). And the largely parallel record Kt c/k 264:7 omits *ša uššianni* and only writes, as our text does, *ina panîmma*. This might refer to what other records describe as “we started by taking ...” (*nušarrima nilqe*), e.g. in Kt a/k 827:2-4, followed in lines 10-11 by “later I collected” (*warkānum alqe*; see *OAI* 176-8).

13-14. Pilah-lštar, son of Uzua, occurs only here as leader of a caravan, but the anonymous writers of *126:4-6 state that they will address him concerning “losses” (presumably during a caravan trip). We know him from several letters written by Imdīlum (in Prag I 541:16-17 he witnesses for a debt claim of Imdī-ilum), and LB 1230:22-23 and ICK 1, 52 (a letter of Imdīlum) mention that he lead a caravan to Assur.

52. Kt 91/k 323 (1-180-91)

Memorandum on a small, oblong tablet on how much the writer has as a share in, is entitled to receive from the result of the caravan of Aššur-karwa and Aššur-imittī.

	1 ½ <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B.	I entitled to a share
	<i>i-na mī-šī-tim</i>	of 1½ mina of silver
	⅔ <i>ma-na</i> 5 GÍN	in the holding (and)
	<i>i-šál-ša-tim</i>	to 45 shekels of
5	<i>ša ELLAT^{at}</i>	in the one-third fund
rev.	<i>A-šur-kār-wa</i>	of the caravan of
	<i>ù A-šur-i-mī-tī</i>	Aššur-karwa
	<i>ad-ma-ku</i>	and Aššur-imittī.

Notes

6-7. Aššur-karwa does not occur elsewhere among the men who organized caravans, which was designated by their name, see *OAI* 165.

53. Kt 91/k 443 (1-296-91)

⁵ Compare the expression to send goods *ina/išti panîmma wāši'im/ālikim*, or *ina panītim harrānim* (always with emphatic *-ma* added to the adjective), where a noun may be omitted, e.g. *kaspam ina panîmma šēbilānim*, ATHE 44:16, and *išti panîmma lillikam*, TC 1, 38:10', etc.

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Memorandum in the first person singular about what the writer is entitled to collect (*laqā'um*) from what the caravan of Ennam-Suen yielded.

	2 $\frac{2}{3}$ <i>ma-na</i> 1 1/6 GÍN	2 minas 41 1/6 shekels of
	KÙ.B. <i>šál-ša-tim</i>	silver as one-third share
	<i>ša</i> ILLAT <i>En-na-Sú-en</i>	of Ennam-Suen caravan
	<i>a-la-qé</i>	I will collect;
5	5 $\frac{1}{3}$ <i>ma-na</i> 2 $\frac{2}{3}$ GÍN	5 minas 22 $\frac{2}{3}$ shekels
l.e.	<i>i-na mi-ší-it</i>	from the holding of
rev.	ILLAT- <i>lá-tim</i>	that caravan
	<i>a-lá-qé</i>	I will collect.

Comment on texts 49-53

The preceding texts belong to the category of short notes that record the claims individual traders have (on the basis of their participation or investment, expressed by the verb *adāmu*, always in the stative) on a share in the fund of a collective caravan (*ellutum*), presumably stocked and administered in the colonial office, discussed in *OAI* 169-170 and 175-176 (on the settlement of accounts). He takes *mišittum*, “what is deposited”, “holding”, as a term for a storeroom, the goods kept there and the value they represent. Our records fit the pattern whereby ca. two-thirds of the claim is on the “holding” (note Kt 86/k 101:14-18, *šinepē ina / mišit ellitimilaqqe*), and one-third on “the one-third fund”, but in *53 the latter is only half the amount of the share in the “holding”, which is also the case Kt 94/k 545 (courtesy Barjamovic), where the writer will take 5 ½ minas of silver from the *mišittum* of the caravan and 2 $\frac{2}{3}$ minas as *šalšātum*.

The mention in *51 of a balancing payment for textiles together with statements about collecting silver from the “holding” (*mišittum*) and the “one-third fund” (*šalšātum*) occurs in several other texts. There are differences in the formulation and the question is whether they are only terminological (use of synonyms, short and abbreviated versions) or refer to different procedures. Full versions can reveal what is going on and for our text Kt a/k 868, (presented in *OAI* 176) is illuminating. It deals with the accounting of a trader’s share in the caravan (*ellutum*) lead by Š. and it is helpfully explicit and gives exact figures. It starts by mentioning that the trader had “deposited” 25 $\frac{2}{3}$ textiles in the colonial office, apparently his share in a large lot (hence the fraction of a textile) shipped by the caravan and sold to the palace that paid for it via the colony (or perhaps, less likely, the lot figured in an enterprise organized by the colony itself). The trader will receive for his textiles 12 shekels of silver apiece and three entries specify how the payment will take place: 1) silver to be received from the “one-third fund” of the caravan; 2) silver he has as his share in the “holding of the caravan”; and 3) silver that will be balanced (*napālum*) by leader of the caravan. This agrees with *51, whose figures for the payments from the “holding” and the “one-third fund” imply a price of ca. 10 shekels per textile, which could rise to 12 shekels if there was also (though not mentioned here) a balancing payment by the leader of the caravan. Similar accounts show that payments by the palace for textiles bought were registered in and probably channeled through the colonial office, so that we read about “the holding of the caravan in the palace” (*mišit ellitim ina ekallim*), which presumably is an abbreviation for what is explicitly formulated in Kt a/k 814:30-33, “I have a share (*admāku*) of x silver in the caravan of PN in the palace; I have been registered (for it)

on the tablet of the colony” (other texts also write “I have been registered (for it) in the palace”).

Depending the situation the words “they will balance me” (*51: 2) apparently can refer to the caravan or have the colony as subject, e.g. in Kt c/k 331 (courtesy Dercksen): “18 textiles the colonial office will balance me”. Further research, which cannot be undertaken here, is needed to distinguish the various modalities and procedures (cf. OAI/176, note 475).

E. Lists of shipments and transporters

1. Large amounts of silver and gold sent to Assur

Many “caravan texts” mention that Elamma sent amount of silver (m = mina, s = shekel; amounts of x minas + y shekels are rendered as x m.y) to Assur to his associates, investors (*ummiānū*) and representatives (*ša kīma* PN = repres), notably his brother Ali-ahum, Aššur-rēšī, Dadiya and Ennam-Aššur. Not included in my table are the many small sums (including those designated as *riksum*, “bundle”, or *šēbultum*, “consignment”, listed below in table 2), meant for business partners, friends and various women.

<i>text</i>	<i>silver</i>	<i>gold</i>	<i>transporter</i>	<i>owner</i>	<i>address and purpose^a</i>
7:1-11	30 m		Šu-Kubum		to my <i>ummiānū</i> [?] , repres, Hinnāya
7:12-27	5¾ m		„	Elamma+Hinnāya	<i>ana pāni ellitim</i> , various persons
8:1-4 ^b	15 m		Karwāya	Elamma	to my <i>ummiānū</i> *
8:6-8 ^b	15 [?] s		Aššur-mutappil	Elamma	to Ennam-Aššur, Dadiya
8:22-24	1 m		Šallim-Aššur		my <i>ummiānū</i>
8:24-26	6 m		Šallim-Aššur	Elamma	Aššur-imitti s. Ikua
8:27-32 ^c	17.8 m		Šallim-Aššur	Elamma and Kurub-Ištar	Ali-ahum, Dadiya (cf. 34:105)
8:32-38	17½ m		Aššur-nādā	Elamma and Kurub-Ištar	Ali-ahum, Dadiya
9:1-5	10 m	-	Aššur-lamassī		my <i>ummiānū</i> , for buying tin
9:6-9	5 m		„	<i>tamkārum</i>	to buy <i>kutānū</i>
10:1-7	30 m		Ennam-Aššur	[Elamma]	E. = son of Ušāriya
10:8-12 ^d	15 m	-	Adad-pilah	[Elamma]	A. = son of Anīnum
10:13-18	30 m	-	Aššur-rē’ī	[Elamma]	A. = son of Iddin-Ištar
10:20-49	ca. 4.20 m		Aššur-rē’ī	[Elamma]	payment to many persons
12:1-6	10 m	-	Šu-Bēlum	<i>tamkārum</i> ,	Iliya and repres of Laqēp
14:1-9	10 m	-	Kudādum		Erra-ilī and Kudādum, for tin; cf. for Kudādum *118:9.
14:10-19	10 m	-	Ali-abum		Ali-abum, Šuli, Erra-ilī
16:5-8 ^e	16⅔ m		Aššur-nādā	[Elamma]	Ali-ahum, Aššur-rēšī,
Ennam-Aššur, //38:6-7					Dadiya, for paying loan or <i>kutānū</i>
18:1-4 ^f	24 m		Dān-Aššur	[Elamma]	Aššur-rēšī, Dadiya, Ennam-Aššur
20:1-8	24.25m	33s	Šu-Kūbum	Elamma	for buying tin or textiles
[27:5-6	30 m		—	Elamma	via Lā-qēp to my <i>ummiānu</i> and respr in Assur (// 37:1-8)
					borrowed for him by Ali-ahum,

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				Aššur-rēšī,	Aššur-ennam,
Dadiya]					
34:1-5	17 m	Šallim-Aššur	Elamma and Kurub-Ištar	Ali-ahum, Dadiya, Dadānum (caravan account) (cf. 8:27-32)	
35:1-5	65 m	—	Elamma	Ennam-Aššur, Dadiya, silver <i>ša</i> Ali-ahim (caravan account)	
[36:1-5	20 m	Ir'am-Aššur	Elamma	Ennam-Aššur, Dadiya, Hinnāya (caravan account)]	
37:1-8	24.24 m	33 s	Aššur-ṭāb	Elamma Ali-ahum, Aššur-rēšī, Dadiya (caravan account) (//	
Ennam-Aššur					
20:1-8)					
39:1-5	4.22½ m		Dān-Aššur	Elamma Iliya, Aššur-rēšī,	
Ennam-Aššur,					
39:9-10	17.4 m	Anīnum	Elamma	Iliya, Aššur-rēšī, Ennam-Aššur,	
and					
40:3-4	30 m	Aššur-rē'ī	Elamma	Dadiya; "notifying message".	
82:4-6	30 m	Ah-šalim	Elamma (l. 24)	Ennam-Aššur and Dadiya the father of Dada and Ēnah-ilī	

^a There is a distinction between a shipment *aššēr* PN, "to the address of PN", and *ana* PN, "for PN"; *ana*

+ infinitive is also used to state the purpose, e.g. "*ana ša'āmim*", "to buy".

^b Both shipments also mentioned in 17:1-7; in 8:4 *ūbil*, in 17: 4 *naš'akkunūti*.

^c The same shipment in 34:1-5, where it is said to be 17 minas (rounded off?). In 8:32-36 another ship-

ment is transported by Aššur-nādā, this time 17½ minas of silver.

^d This shipment is the subject of the "transport contract" 11.

^e The same shipment mentioned in 38:6-7 (*ublam*).

^f The same shipment is mentioned in 38:4-5 (*ublam*).

Transport of silver and gold inside Anatolia

19:4-5	7.12 m	Iddin-Ištar	[Elamma]	most of it spent on payments
20:27-28	5 m	Šamaš-bāni	Elamma	to Lā-qēp (inside Anatolia)
21:3f.	40 m	2 m	Aššur-ṭāb	Hinnāya Elamma (in Kanesh)

If we add the amounts of silver shipped to Assur, ignoring double mentions (above notes b-d), the loan mentioned in *27:5-6, and references to transports inside Anatolia (although some may have dealt with silver meant to be shipped on to Assur), but including the silver and gold of *20:1-8, to be brought to Assur, we arrive at a total of at least 6 to 7 talents of silver. We do not know which period the records cover, but perhaps not too many years, considering the fact that *8 alone mentions a total of more than 70 minas of silver and *10 even 75 minas (in both texts shipped by three different transporters). The at least three letters that refer to the loan of 30 minas of silver contracted for Elamma to make purchases in Assur (see the note on *16:9-13) cannot be separated very much in time and they mention, apart from this loan, the shipment of in all ca. 1 talent of silver.

2. Small amounts of silver and gold sent to Assur

Many smaller amounts to be delivered to particular persons are specified by their weight or called *riksum* (= *ri*), "bundle, small packet", *šēbultum* (= *šeb*), "consignment,

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gift" (esp. for women), or *ikribū*, "votive gift" or silver derived from temple funds. This silver often is the yield of textiles they had made and sent off, entrusting them to trader as "free loan" (*tadmiqtum*) a term that also denotes their yield (cf. *AOATT* 111). The silver sent can be designated simply as *ša* 'PN, but also as *šēbultum ša* or *šēbultaša ša* 'PN (with a double genitive). In many cases this seems to mean "shipment for 'PN", but it can also designate its owner, who sends it to Assur, which must be the case if the women (persons) mentioned are known to have lived in Kanesh.

<i>text</i>	<i>silver, etc.</i>	<i>transporter</i>	<i>owner/sender</i>	<i>for / addressee</i>
7:12-22	2 m	Šu-Kūbum	Elamma	<i>ana pāni elltim</i>
	1 m	„	Hinnāya	„
	1½ m	„	Elamma	Ummi-lšhara,,
	15 s gold	„	Lamassutum + Aššuriš-tikal	thereof 35 s. si <i>ša</i> Lam. 25 s si <i>ša ikrib</i> [...]]
8:9-21	2/3 m	Karwaya	Elamma	Aššur-taklāku
	5 s <i>šeb</i>	Aššur-mutappil	Elamma	Ummi-lšhara
	4 s	„	Lamassutum	Ummi-lšhara
	1 s	„ „	Bušu'a	
	6 s	—	Sāsiya, Lāqēp	Ummi-lšhara
	1 m		Elamma	my <i>ummiānū</i>
8:35	2 s	Aššur-nādā	Elamma	Ummi-lšhara
9:10-20	1 <i>ri</i> for 2 text	Aššur-lamassī	Elamma?	Hatiya
	35 s <i>ri</i> for 1 text	„ „	Iliya	
	20 s <i>ri</i>	„ „	Ner'amtum	
	20 s <i>ri</i>	„ „	Šīmat-lštar	
	13 s	„ „	Kurub-lštar	
10:25-50	42 s	Aššur-rē'ī (l. 50)		— En[nam-Aššur]
	10 s	„	—	Pilah-lštar
	27 s for 2 text	„	—	Dadiya
	27 s for 2 text	„	—	Ennam-Aššur
	52 s for 4 text	„	—	Aššur-rēšī
	25 s <i>ri</i>	„	—	Aššur-kašid, Šu-Suen,
Aššur-iddin				
	19 s	„	—	Aššur-rē'ī
	30 s	Aššur-rē'ī	Lamassutum	 <i>ša ikribī ša</i> [.....]
	10 s <i>šeb</i> , 4 s <i>ša</i> [...], „			— Ummi-lšhara
	x s	„	—	Ilī-ušranni
	1 2/3 s	„	Lamassutum	Ummi-lšhara
	1 s	„	—	Bēlulu
	1 s	„	—	Nar'amtum
	1 s	—	—	Bušu
	1/2 s	—	—	ME-labrat

3. Merchandise bought for or shipped to Elamma in Assur

Notifying messages and caravan accounts list tin (in talents and minas; sealed and loose together), various textiles (te; *kutānum* = *ku*; *šūrum* = *šu*, a dark textile, also used for wrapping the tin; *li* = *liwītum*, textile for wrapping), including those "for wrapping" (the tin) and those "of the harnessers" (*kaššārū*). Transporter or "harnesser" is the man who is subject of the verbal forms *ublam*, *naš'akkum*, or *iraddeakkum* (rare: *irdeakkum*). A few times we find instructions to buy tin or textiles; in *9:1-5 to buy tin, in *9:6-9 to buy *kutānū*, in *18:8-12 *kutānū* if tin is too expensive. Some reports only mention what merchandise is on its way or has just arrived, without stating how much

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silver was spent in Assur to buy it and for equipping the caravan. I have reconstructed the amounts of silver spent on the basis of standard or average prizes, 15 shekels of tin for 1 shekel of silver and 5 shekels of silver for the purchase of 1 *kutānu*-textile. These averages yield reliable results, but some textiles are somewhat cheaper or more expensive (e.g. “Akkadian ones”, in *42). The prices for the tin fluctuated considerably (see Veenhof 1988, 250ff.) and there is also some difference between the (generally slightly cheaper and much) smaller quantities of *annak qātim*, “tin for in the hand” (not sealed, to be used for expenses; *šq* in what follows) and the sealed tin shipped in packets (*šūqlum*). We find tin at: 12 ½:1 in *35:19, 13:1 in *38:20 (both *šq*), 13:1 in *34:22, 13 2/3:1 in *28:12 (called “expensive”), 14 ¼:1 in *40:8, 14 1/3:1 in *36:8, 15:1 in *18:8 (acceptable price) and *39:19 (*šq*), 15 5/12:1 in *39:16, and 17¼:1 in *37:19. A variation of up to 30% in substantial high prices could induce traders to buy textiles instead of tin (see below note a on *18 and *82:7-13). We are not informed about the reasons for these fluctuations and also cannot date them.

<i>text</i>	<i>silver spent</i>	<i>tin bought</i>	<i>textiles</i>	<i>donkeys</i>	<i>transporter</i>	<i>text/other data</i>
15	(ca. 45 m) ^b	300 m	105 <i>ku</i> 13 <i>li</i>	6	Lā-qēpum	transport contract
18	24 m	130 m	(50?) fine te	(4)	Dān-Aššur	purchase depends on price ^a
24	(ca. 20+x m) ^b	240 m	[x] te	?	<i>ellat</i> Lā-qēp	
26	(ca. 10 m)	-	108 <i>ku</i>	[3?]	Azu	letter by recipient, Hinnāya
28a	(ca. 35 m) ^b	290 m	72 <i>ku</i>	4	Ēnah-ilī	letter by transporter
28b	(ca. 35 m) ^b	--	160 <i>ku</i>	7	„	„
29	(ca. 45 m) ^b	260 m	121 te	(7)	Aššur-rē'ī	letter by transporter
30	(ca. 30 m) ^b	150 m	91 <i>ku</i> + <i>šū</i>	4	Ennam-Aššur	letter Elamma from Assur [?]
31	(ca. 15 m) ^b	130 m	50 <i>ku</i>	3		
32	(ca. 5 m) ^b	--	50 <i>ku</i>	2	Iddin-Aššur	“Ēnah-ilī entrusted to me”
34	16.10 m	20 m	126 <i>ku</i>	4	Aššur-mūtappil	export tax 8¼ sh si
35	ca. 11 2/3 m	19 m	96 te + 2	4	Aššur-lamassī	
36	20 m	145 m	36 te + <i>li</i>	2	Šu-Kūbum	Ir'am-Aššur brought silver
37	26.9 m	290 m	36 <i>ku</i> 33 <i>šū</i>	5	Uzua, Šumi-abiya	export tax 12½ sh si
38	8⅔ m	15 m	76 <i>ku</i> 7 te	3	Aššur-nādā	export tax 4⅓ sh si
39	20.25 m	280 m	10 <i>ku</i> 8 <i>šū</i>	2	Dān-Aššur	export tax 10⅓ s si
40	30 m	175 m	85 + 5 te	4	Aššur-rē'ī	
42	(ca. 45 m) ^b	360 m	226 <i>ku</i> ^c	7 [?]	<i>šēp</i> 3 persons. ^d	
43	(ca. 16 m)	210 m	17 <i>ku</i> + 4 <i>li</i>	[3?]		4 t 18 m <i>awīt</i> Iliya
44	(ca. 11 m)	130	16 te	2	Ku'uku	delivered to Hinnāya
[85]	(ca. 30 m)	260	102 <i>ku</i>	6	Aššur-mūtappil	letter to Elamma]

^a For 11⅓ minas of silver an unspecified number (presumably ca. 50) of fine textiles, *lubūšū* and *šilipktū* must be bought; if tin is not available or too expensive, for the 8 minas of silver reserved for it ca. 80-100 *kutānu* have to be bought.

^b Amount of silver not mentioned, but calculated.

^c Among the *kutānū* are 25 expensive Akkadian ones.

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^d Under the responsibility of Aššur-mūtappil, Ennam-Aššur son of Ušāriya, and Aššur-lamassī. The bulk

of them were “led” to Elamma, elsewhere in Anatolia, by Zikur-Adad. The tin – lines 21ff.; 2 packets of which are *šēp* Aššur-lamassī - and 68 textiles = 6 donkey loads, “will be led to you” by Aššur-imittī and Huziya. Aššur-imittī could be the man with a service contract and working capital, who occurs in *67:1-4, see the table in § 4.

Total amounts: silver spent in Assur: ca. 10 talents
tin bought: ca. 46 talents
textiles bought: ca. 1350 pieces

4. Data on “harnessers” (*kaššārum*) and other transporters

Insight in the status of transporters, apart from the names listed in the tables of § 1 and 3, is supplied by references to the “working capital” (*be’ulātum* = *be*) supplied by contract to “harnessers” (*kaššārum* = *ka*), who thereby enter the service of the creditor/employer, by payments to other transporters not qualified as such (in *19 also designated as “*rādi luqūtim* of PN”), and by references to small numbers of textiles belonging to them that are taken along by the caravan (general statements that a shipment of textiles includes an unspecified number of “textiles of the harnessers” are not listed). *Ka* behind a name means that he is identified as *kaššārum*, (*ka*) that he must be one, since his “working capital” (*be*) is mentioned. Amounts of 25 to 30 shekels of silver given to transporters (also when these amounts are simply listed as a man’s debt in memoranda) in many cases probably are to be interpreted as “working capital”, also when the term *be’ulātum* itself is not used.

<i>Text</i>	<i>transporter</i>	<i>amount</i>	<i>textiles</i>	<i>other data</i>
10:4-5	Ennam-Aššur	-	-	
10:10	Adad-pilah	-	-	
10:20, 50	Aššur-rē’ī	[(<i>ka</i>)]	25 sh [<i>be</i> ²]	-
15:10	[2 <i>ka</i>]	-	4 <i>ša ka</i>	
18:17-19	Bēlum-bāni (<i>ka</i>)	30 sh <i>be</i>	-	cf. 38:27, “2 sh. B. took”, and 31
19:10	son of Ahatum	-	-	<i>rādi luqūtim</i> . of Kūn-ilum
19:11-12	Būr-Suen	-	-	<i>rādi luqūtim</i> of <i>tamkārum</i> cf. 47:4
19:14-15	Aššur-dān	-	-	- <i>rādi luqūtim</i> . of Hinnāya
19:17-18	Iddin-Suen <i>ka</i>	-	-	<i>ka</i> of Karway, cf. 19:45-46
19:24-29	<i>ka</i> of Hinnāya	?	3	“H. paid us 3 textiles for his <i>be</i> ”
19:40-41	Ištar-pilah	-	-	- <i>rādi luqūtim</i> of Hinnāya
19:45-46	Iddin-Suen	-	-	<i>rādi luqūtim</i> of Hinnāya
25:16-18	Bēlum-bāni <i>ka</i>	-	2	“the <i>ka</i> took his 2 textiles”; cf 18.
23:25-29	Uzua (<i>ka</i>)	-	30 sh	“30 sh silver his <i>be</i> ”
26:2-6	Azu <i>ka</i>	-	-	I. 6, “The <i>ka</i> said ...”.
30:18-20	Mannu-kī-iliya (<i>ka</i>)	-	2	“2 <i>kutānū ša be M.</i> ”
	Ennam-Aššur (<i>ka</i>)	-	2	“2 <i>kutānū ša be E.</i> ”
34:5.18-20	Šallim-Aššur (<i>ka</i>)	54 sh	-	<i>be</i> of 2 <i>ka</i>
	+Aššur-mūtappil (<i>ka</i>)			
35:22-24	Aššur-lamassī (<i>ka</i>)	30 sh	2	I. 31-32: 2 text. <i>be</i> A <i>darkū</i> ; cf. for A. *3:11 and *42:10.48 (<i>šēp</i> A.)
36:16-19	Šallim-Aššur <i>ka</i>	22 sh	3	I. 24: 3 text. <i>ša ka</i>
37:9	Aššur-ṭāb	-	-	- brought gold to Assur, cf.
20:10-14	s. Aššur-karwa			entrust it to an “affiliated trader”

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37:31-32	Uzua (<i>ka</i>)		30 sh	-	"60 sh <i>be</i> U. and Š"; cf.
23:25-29	Šumi-abiya (<i>ka</i>)	30 sh	-		cf. *56, Š. owes Elamma 30 sh.
39:26-27	Maši-ilī (<i>ka</i>)	30 sh	-		"30 sh <i>be</i> M."
40:22	Kurub-lštar (<i>ka</i>)	20 sh	3		"20 sh silver <i>be</i> K."; cf. 130:12f.?
46:15-18	Puzur-Anna (<i>ka</i>)	-	3		3 text. <i>ša be</i> P.
	Aššur-bāni (<i>ka</i>)	-	3		3 text. <i>ša be</i> A.
50:16-17	Kunnāya (<i>ka</i>)	30 sh	-		"½ mina of silver his <i>be</i> "
65:4-7	Puzur-lštar (<i>ka</i>)	25 sh	-		<i>be</i> -contract
66:3-6	Kitāya (<i>ka</i>)	30 sh	-		<i>be</i> -contract, cf. *74:3-4, *111:2
67:1-4	Aššur-imittī (<i>ka</i>)	63 ½ sh	-		<i>be</i> -contract, cf. 70:3-4
71:29-31	Aššur-rē'ī (<i>ka</i>)		40 sh <i>be</i>	-	cf. l. 12-13, "30 sh <i>išti</i> A."
75:21-22	Galdāya (<i>ka</i>)	25 sh <i>be</i>	-		cf. *70:5-6
76:21-22	Uršiši (<i>ka</i>)	30 sh <i>be</i>	-		

There is an overlap with the names in §§ 1 and 3, but several men, attested as transporters, are not identifiable as *kaššārū*.⁶ Some may have worked under an existing contract, so that the (earlier) payment of a working capital is not mentioned. Others, such as Aššur-nādā, the son of Aššur-idī, in *38:6-7, and Dān-Aššur, the son of Šalim-ahum, in *38:4-5, both delivering amounts of silver, are young traders, who in other texts too ship goods and lead caravans, not on the basis of a service contract that bound them to a particular employer, but by accepting "transport commissions" from several traders. Others may have had a similar status, but that is difficult to prove. Aššur-nādā, Baṭṭu-šar and Hanānum, listed in memorandums (*72:1f, *69:36f. and *70:32) as owing 30 shekels of silver to Elamma, may well have received that silver as "working capital" (as we know from other sources of Aššur-rē'ī and Šumi-abiya, who are listed in the same way) and accordingly have been harnessers.

⁶ Others do not occur in this list, but are mentioned in letters as having shipped merchandise to Elamma. In *3 the men in Assur tell Elamma that purchases made were "sent" (*šēbulum*) to him by Kunnāya (l. 7), "forwarded" (*šēru'um*) by Aššur-lamassī (l. 11; cf. for him *35:22-24), "exported" (*šēšu'um*) or "brought" (*wabālum*) to him by Ennam-Aššur and Šu-lštar (lines 16-17, 22-23), men also attested as transporters in *10:4-5 and *42:9, 28 and together as witnesses in the transport contract *15:2-3.